AN IDEOLOGICAL OFFENSIVE FOR THE FREE WORLD

An Ideological Offensive *for the* Free World

by

Colonel John J. Fischer
United States Air Force

An Individual Research Paper
THE NATIONAL WAR COLLEGE
Washington, D. C. · 1 March 1957

FAMILY EDITION · 2026

An Ideological Offensive for the Free World
by Colonel John J. Fischer, United States Air Force

Written as an Individual Research Paper at The National War College, Washington, D. C., and dated 1 March 1957.

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[DRAFT]

For the children, grandchildren and great-grandchildren
of John J. Fischer,
[placeholder dedication]

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Foreword

[DRAFT — PLACEHOLDER TEXT]

[In 1957] Colonel John J. Fischer of the United States Air Force was a student at The National War College in Washington. [A few paragraphs from the family will go here: who he was, his service, how the typescript came down through the family, and why it has been set in type now.]

[Second paragraph: the world of 1957 — Sputnik was months away, the Hungarian revolution only just crushed — and what this paper shows of the man who wrote it.]

[Closing paragraph and acknowledgments.]

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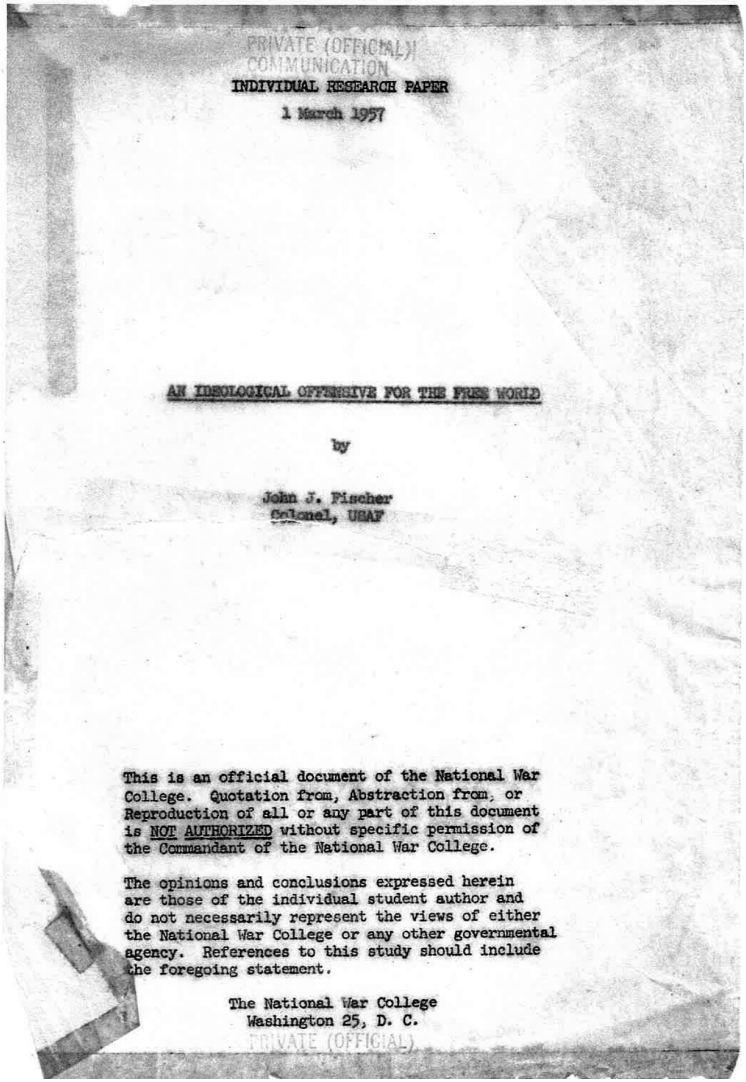
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THIS EDITION reproduces the text of the original typescript of March 1957, 121 pages, from a careful transcription checked line by line against images of every page. The author's wording, spelling and punctuation have been kept, including the usages of his day (*indorsed*, *thru*, *benefitted*). Words divided at the ends of typed lines have been closed up, and the few letters blurred on the old paper have been read from context; otherwise the text stands as it was typed.

The typescript gathered its 142 notes at the end of the paper, keyed to the text by numbers in the form "1/". Here they are set as footnotes at the foot of the page. They are numbered consecutively; in Chapter IV three notes were typed out of sequence (59, 60, 61), and they are numbered here in reading order, each still attached to its original reference. The notes to the sections on Adam Smith and on Malthus and Ricardo were keyed to those headings in the typescript, and are so placed here.

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PRIVATE (OFFICIAL)
COMMUNICATION

INDIVIDUAL RESEARCH PAPER

1 March 1957

AN IDEOLOGICAL OFFENSIVE FOR THE FREE WORLD

by

John J. Fischer
Colonel, USAF

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The National War College
Washington 25, D. C.

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The title page of the original typescript, 1957.

Preface

The possibility of an ideological offensive against communism resulted from some innocent reflections on the consummate zeal with which our ingenious scientists develop awesome weapons then hurry to counter their own devices. Why, I asked myself, doesn't someone assemble the appropriate experts on Soviet Russia, direct them to determine its strengths and weaknesses and to prepare effective ideological, economic and psychological measures calculated to neutralize her without firing a shot?

The opportunity provided by the curriculum for further insights into Marxist-Leninist ideas coupled with the requirement for constructive research caused the selection of this topic. It is not wishful thinking to explore every avenue of attack short of armed force if the possibility of future conflict is not eliminated. With the advent of nuclear plenty and ICBMs, the competitive coexistence between communism and the Free World may last for a long time. But whether or not a stalemate is reached, time remains for improving our ideological position and weakening that of the enemy.

It cannot be denied at the outset that the revolts in Poland and Hungary tended to weaken the resolve to be done with peripheral areas; to concentrate the attack on the main conflagration from whence fly the sparks which ignite discontented peoples everywhere. However, the Soviet Union is the base of an ideological machine controlling expanding military, subversive and propaganda forces. Its intention is to impose its system on the world and utterly destroy the will of any enemy to resist. Russian communism ebbs and flows; but despite recessions and some defeats, the advance has continued in war and peace with a glacier-like sureness that is earthshaking.

Short of atomic warfare, I believe that the only effective defeat communism can suffer is not through false "peaceful coexistence" but through the inspiration of positive human action guided by spiritual ideals. Bullets can kill Communists; they can never conquer the idea and the ideals of communism. In this paper I attempt to explore the question: Can the ideology of communism be conquered by a superior revolutionary and democratic philosophy founded on universal principles capable of awakening the active moral support and allegiance of free men all over the world?

CHAPTER I

Introduction

MOST PEOPLE look upon philosophy as a pastime for the dilettante, a time-consuming preoccupation which is beneath the notice of the man of action. They do not realize that the history of philosophy is the history of ideas which have so frequently developed into a system of living. The idea conceived in the ivory tower of a philosopher will find its way to the market place through novels and sermons, through schoolroom lectures and political speeches. It has an influence, once in the arena of life, on our whole way of living. As the great economist Lord Keynes said:[1]

> "The ideas of economists and political philosophers, both when they are right and when they are wrong, are more powerful than is commonly understood. Indeed the world is ruled by little else. Practical men, who believe themselves to be quite exempt from any intellectual influences, are usually the slaves of some defunct economist. Madmen in authority, who hear voices in the air, are distilling their frenzy from some academic scribbler of a few years back. I am sure that the power of vested interests is vastly exaggerated compared with the gradual encroachment of ideas."

The validity of an idea is one condition of its permanent effectiveness. To be valid, an idea must correctly read its whole social and natural environment, must be cognizant of its own origin, direction and ultimate aim, and must be applied in action. If it fulfills these requirements, a rational program has an excellent chance of conquering its opposite or

1. Robert L. Heilbroner, *The Worldly Philosophers*, (New York: Simon and Schuster, 1953), p. 4.

irrational ideology which is condemned by its intrinsic contradictions to reformulate its aims with each passing wind. In the process, the indubitable advantage that the rational has over the irrational is that it can understand the irrational, draw a circle around it and learn to control it, whereas the irrational cannot understand the rational except in its most superficial manifestations. Reason can comprehend both itself and its opposite; the irrational can comprehend neither.

Communism versus democratic capitalism—which is rational, which is irrational? As both systems attempt to close the gap between the real and the ideal; between "is" and "ought to be" an unbridgeable chasm is exposed. The one completely subordinates the individual to the collective state which has absolute power over all economic, political, social, and cultural activities; the other proclaims the equality of men endowed by their Creator with inalienable rights secured by governments deriving their just powers from the consent of the governed.

Marxism as a system of thought has made the greatest impression in the world in the form of a theory of history. The question of how to explain the movement of life through time in the direction in which it does move opens up the problem of social causation in its most naked form. The materialist interpretation of history encompasses the whole of Marxian sociology, including basically its economic theory, its theory of social classes and its theory of the state. One of the principal elements in this approach to history is the postulation of historical determinism or inevitability. While economists generally concede that Marx's "Das Kapital" is a penetrating and dispassionate appraisal of the capitalist system (albeit predicting its eventual doom),[2] historians abhor the translation of a pattern and a sequence in history to inevitability in history.[3] Nevertheless, the "Spectre" which Marx and Engels claimed was haunting Europe in 1848, is today haunting the world. Our response has been a compound of terror, hysteria and fear. Such a reaction is dangerous for democracies which wish to survive the Communist challenge because frightened people are not capable of making intelligent decisions and adopting stern and consistent policies. We know that communism is not an invisible ghostly power; we

2. *Ibid.*, p. 160.

3. Max Lerner, *Ideas are Weapons*, (New York: Viking Press, 1939), p. 400.

know that it is an ideological movement created by men, operated by men, and subject to the same frailties and limitations as all other man-made movements.

What then is the principal tenet of the Communist theory of history that is their *strongest* weapon and hence the one which should command our greatest attention? It is the idea that communism will inevitably win out in the struggle for the souls of men. Marx himself declared:

> "What the bourgeoisie ... produces, above all, is its own grave-diggers. Its fall and the victory of the proletariat are equally inevitable."[4]

Throughout the corpus of Marxist writings the heavy stress on the inevitability of the victory of Karl Marx's theories have been given the force of a Messianic prophecy. This Messianic and seemingly inevitable victory has been strongly proclaimed by the Communist parties of the world.[5] Continual propaganda hailing the alleged inevitability of the triumph of socialist thought and the triumph of world communism coupled with the naked fact that since the handful of Bolsheviks accomplished a coup d'etat in 1917, communism has spread at a tremendous rate, is one of the strongest appeals of communism. Nothing succeeds like success! The dogma of the absolute inevitability of communism is one of the truly great appeals to intellectuals drawn within the Communist intellectual orbit.[6] Who does not want to be part of the great historical movement for the emancipation of all humanity? This then is the key tenet and the key appeal of communism.

There is no evidence that the new leaders of the Soviet Union have abandoned long-range Communist objectives. As John J. McCloy says in his foreword to *Russia and America*.[7]

> "I do believe that some very radical and important changes have taken place in Soviet methods. However, Khrushchev's opening speech last February

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4. *The Manifesto of the Communist Party*, 1888 English edition; (Moscow: Foreign Languages Publishing House, 1949 edition), p. 63.
5. G. A. Almond, *The Appeals of Communism*, (Princeton, N. J.: Princeton University Press, 1954), p. 55.
6. David Sarnoff, "Program for a Political Offensive Against World Communism," *Soviet Total War*, U. S. 84th Congress, 2nd Session, Vol. I, p. 255.
7. Henry L. Roberts, *Russia and America*, (New York: Harper and Brothers, 1956), p. ix.

> before the Twentieth Congress of the Soviet Communist Party should put us on guard against illusions...Khrushchev did not renounce the objective of one Communist world. He gave no indication that he was discarding a parochial belief in the mid-nineteenth century concepts of capitalism which Marx nurtured. Moreover, he did not renounce force. He merely gave a more elastic definition to the old Lenin-Stalin doctrine of the 'inevitable transition to Socialism.' "

In the past, the Soviets have demonstrated that where physical, and above all military, strength opposes them, an attack on the moral fiber of the wielders of this power is the best strategy. But so far as the Free World is concerned, Gerhart Niemeyer complains:[8]

> "It seems almost as if we had been unable to muster sufficient confidence and courage to attack Soviet morale at its core: Marx-Leninist doctrine. Those who have put their faith in that doctrine are immunized to the blandishments of free men's ideas. But precisely because they are dedicated men, they are vulnerable through the many and deep conflicts of reason into which they are involved. They have degraded reason into a mere tool of inhuman ends."

It cannot be denied that strong opposition is voiced from many sides against identifying the enemy of the West as the ideology of World Communism. Rather, it is said, we are confronted simply with the latest version of an expansionist and aggressive Russia. This argument receives strong support from the view that communism as an ideology would not be the major menace that it is if the support of the U.S.S.R. could be eliminated.[9] It is further supported by the Editor of the *British Political Quarterly Review* who points out:

> "The Cold War is a struggle for power between the governments of the U.S.S.R. and the U.S.A., initiated by the Soviet government. It is a struggle between governments, not between ideologies. The West is not defending itself against communism, but against the threat of force by the Soviet Government ..."[10]

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8. Gerhardt Niemeyer, "Why You Can't Trust the Soviet Mind," *U. S. News & World Report*, (16 March 1956), p. 14.
9. Edward Crankshaw, *Cracks in the Kremlin Wall*, (New York: The Viking Press, 1951) Chapter I. See also, W. W. Rostow, *The Dynamics of Soviet Society*, (New York: W. W. Norton & Company, 1953), p. 86.
10. Notes and Comments, *Political Quarterly Review*, (January-March 1954), p. 5.

This vexing point of the significance of ideologies has been admirably analyzed by Palmer and Perkins as depending on the depth of the urge to universalism as well as the price tag of realization. They point out:[11]

> "Ideological universalism is in itself no threat to the proponents of any particular ideology, for it may remain an unimplemented aspiration; but it becomes a threat when it is supported by aggressive designs and great military power. With certain qualifications, democracy is an unaggressive ideology, although those who urge preventive war would make it aggressive. Fascism, on the other hand, whether of the German, the Italian, or the Japanese variety, was patently aggressive, and its suppression required the all-out combined efforts of the supporters of two irreconcilable ideologies. And the central issue in world politics today is whether the survivors can get along together—whether, in particular the rulers of Communist Russia will be content with an ideology without universalism."

It is apparent that if the Communists were willing to settle for a permanently divided world, each half pledged not to interfere with the other, they could easily arrange it. But they do not desire a stalemate—under their ideology and by means of a world-wide apparatus they must drive relentlessly toward world domination, the ultimate objective. In the words of David Sarnoff:[12]

> "We must realize that world communism is *not* a tool in the hands of Russia—Russia is a tool in the hands of world communism. Repeatedly Moscow has sacrificed national interests in deference to world revolutionary needs."

Since the universalist doctrines of Marx, Engels, Lenin, and Stalin have constituted the very basis upon which the Communist movement was founded throughout the world and form the very basis upon which it operates to overthrow governments by force and violence,[13] it is essential to study, analyze, dissect and refute them as a preliminary step to formulating

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11. Palmer and Perkins, *International Relations*, (Cambridge, Mass.: The Riverside Press, 1953), p. 1199.

12. David Sarnoff, *op. cit.*, p. 262. See also, Frederick C. Barghorn, *The Threat of Soviet Imperialism*, (Maryland: 1954), p. 82.

13. U. S. 80th Congress, 2d Sess. House Committee on Un-American Activities, The Communist Party of the United States as an Advocate of Overthrow of Government by Force and Violence, (Washington: U. S. Govt. Print. Off., 1948), p. 9.

an ideological offensive for the Free World. This project is a partial, in fact minute, effort in that direction. The process of research entailed a review of the basic theories of Marx the founder, Engels the collaborator, Lenin the applier and Stalin the continuer, with particular emphasis on the theme of "inevitability." Comparison with other historians followed to evaluate the deterministic theory of history and finally identification of the principal hallmarks of Western civilization which conflict with the Marxian concept of capitalism predestined to be replaced by communism.

CHAPTER II

Sources of the Communist Doctrine of Inevitability

> "The Communists have made outstanding and amazing gains to date in large measure because they know what they believe, why they believe it, and can explain it to people anywhere in understandable terms. By dialectics they make plausible the historical advent and development of communism, its inevitable triumph as the wave of the future, and the wisdom of joining the winning team."[14]

The philosophy of communism was born, not in Russia, but in the Western world of the last century. It is Western in origin; its philosophy is German, its sociology, French and its economics, English. Communism has been called a potpourri, a hodgepodge of all the rationalistic, utopian, pragmatic, atheistic thinking of the Eighteenth Century.[15] Marx and Engels, its founders, were avid students of all the economic philosophers and political scientists of their time. Hence there are two keys of the Communist view of history which unlock the secret of capitalism's inevitable overthrow. One is the interpretation of Hegel's philosophical framework and the other is the influence of French sociologists and English economists. An analysis of the theories of these men will provide a necessary background to an understanding of the Communist belief that it is the inevitable wave of the future.

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14. John C. Broger, *Militant Liberty*, U. S. Department of Defense, (2 November 1955), p. 1.

15. Fulton J. Sheen, *Communism and the Conscience of the West*, (New York: The Country Life Press, 1948), p. 52.

To Hegel (1770–1831), Spirit is the whole of reality, the only reality. The primary being, which he called Idea or Spirit, is all that truly is. This Idea knows all things whatsoever, but only potentially. It is capable of coming to the knowledge of all things, but does not in fact, at the beginning of the world-process, know anything. Starting with this unlimited capacity, the Idea gradually progresses, by an unconscious law of its essence, toward its goal of knowing all that is. History is then the process by which the Idea passes from knowing nothing to the full knowledge of itself. In the process the Idea must experiment with all possible concepts and activities, which are like masks that the Idea tries on and takes off. Each mask helps the Idea in understanding its being and helps it towards full knowledge of itself, the only true being. Consequently, everything in history is necessary but experimental and destined to be transcended as the Idea progresses to its final, inevitable goal.[16]

The principle of the unconscious law of evolution of the Idea from one state of things to another is the principle of the dialectic. Analyzing this we find that every being less than the Whole (i.e., every being except the Idea which has reached its goal) contains not only itself but also its opposite. Every being is to be understood not only by what it is, but by what it is not. In abstract form this concept provides the Hegelian "triad;" there is "being" and "non-being" or position and opposition which he treats as Thesis and Antithesis. The interaction of the Thesis "being" and the Antithesis "non-being" produces the Synthesis of "becoming" or composition. Every synthesis is a conquered or overcome contradiction to which the dialectical law again applies. Its turn as a thesis begets a new antithesis and then becomes a new synthesis. Hegel thus makes contradiction the fundamental law of thought. We know from our experience that things are at one and the same time Something and not Some Other Thing: that change is possible. Things cease to be what they were and become one of the things they weren't. The principle of contradiction means that every being whatsoever, except the Idea, contains its opposite; that the tension between the two produces a third thing in which both the previous things are somehow continued.[17] For example, a seed is planted in the ground

16. Francis J. Sheed, *Communism and Man*, (New York: Sheed and Ward, 1947), p. 3–6.
17. *Ibid.*, p. 6–7.

and germinates. The seed disappears, it is negated, but in its place appears a plant, the negation of the negated. This plant grows, ripens and dies. By virtue of this negation of the negation a progeny of 10, 20 or 30 seeds are left where one seed was before. Thus we see that the synthesis is always of a higher order than the old thesis. In mathematics, negate quantity a, and we get -a; negate this negation, i. e., multiply it by itself, and the result is a^2; behold the original quantity but in a higher synthesis.[18]

While admittedly this process is heavy going we must remember that Lenin himself said that it is impossible to understand Marx without having studied Hegel.[19] These two philosophical principles—the Idea enroute to self-knowledge, and the Dialectic as the law of inevitable change—produce Hegel's framework of universal history.

> "The History of the world begins with the general aim only implicitly present, a force within the Idea of which the Idea itself was unconscious ... an energy enabling it to realize itself—to make itself actually that which it is potentially."[20]

The unconscious meandering to a rational end is postulated because the Idea is Reason and whatever happens in Reason cannot help being reasonable. "Reason is the sovereign of the world; the history of the world therefore presents us with a rational process."[21] A classical example of Hegel's application of his principles to history was his Theory of the State. Applying the dialectic, he begins with Oriental Despotism which did not know that man is free. The orientals believed that only one was free, namely the ruler. Next came the Greeks and Romans who thought that some were free but decreed slavery for the great majority. The thesis, Greek Liberty and its antithesis, Oriental Despotism fight it out, embodied in human wills and appetites. There are tremendous struggles designed by the World Spirit, and out of these struggles finally comes the synthesis,

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18. Mandel M. Bober, *Karl Marx's Interpretation of History*, (Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 1948), p. 33.
19. Lenin, Philosophical Notes, published posthumously: "Without Hegel, Marx's Kapital is unintelligible."
20. Sheed, *op. cit.*, p. 9.
21. *Ibid.*, p. 10.

German-disciplined liberty.[22] For Hegel freedom is absolutely bound up with truth because ignorance and error are enslavements; only when the mind is in full possession of the truth can it be free. As against Rousseau who taught that man is born free and that the State exists as the result of a contract among men by which each gives up just so much of his freedom as is necessary for the good of the whole, Hegel taught that man is born totally in subjection, and that he attains freedom—from his own errors and impulses—in the State. For only the whole is free and the State by its collectivity is closest to the whole and further from the individual. The result is the naked maxim that the will of the State is morality. Because the people do not know what their common will is, it must be interpreted to them by world historic individuals who express the otherwise unrealized will of the people.

> "Julius Caesar writes—Hegel fought and conquered his rivals not merely for his private gain but to unify the Roman Empire for which the time was ripe."[23]

From time to time the dialectical progress of the Idea requires these profoundly revolutionary deeds against which irrelevant moral claims must not be brought because the deeds are necessary to the Idea.

> "The litany of private virtues—modesty, humility, philanthropy and forbearance—must not be brought in collision with world-historical deeds. Whatever the Idea needs is right and whatever happens happens because the idea needs it; therefore whatever happens is right."[24]

In summary then, History according to Hegel is simply the process by which the Idea, which alone truly is, arrives at its goal, which is the perfect knowledge of itself; on the way to this goal, by a necessity of its nature, it assumes successive forms which it successively transcends because every form is subject to the dialectical principle that it contains its own opposite and the tension between the two produces a new form in which both are somehow continued.

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22. Crane Brinton, *The Shaping of the Modern Mind*, (New York: Prentice Hall, Inc., 1953), p. 157.
23. Edmund Wilson, *To the Finland Station*, (New York: Harcourt, Brace & Co., 1940), p. 142.
24. Sheed, *op. cit.*, p. 13.

Karl Marx, who was born 13 years before Hegel died in 1831, and who as a student debated such daring questions as atheism and theoretical communism with a group of young intellectuals known as Young Hegelians, joined with another young revolutionary thinker, Engels, in 1844. From that time until the death of Marx forty years later, the life of each was the life of both.

Everything they thought and wrote, whosoever might be the signatory, was in the deepest sense a common product. Together they fashioned a conception of history and philosophy, an analysis of their contemporary world, a logic and strategy of revolution. As a student, Marx had been tremendously impressed with the dialectical side of Hegel which denied any truth is permanent, or any principle immutable; in fact his doctoral thesis presented at the University of Jena in 1841, was so dialectical in character that the second sentence contradicted the first and the third united the two.[25]

The year Marx received his doctorate there appeared the most violent attack on religion that had been delivered in Germany up to that time. Ludwig Feuerbach in his *Essence of Christianity* attempted to destroy it with a full-fledged materialistic philosophy. Feuerbach contended that a man who does not have consciousness of his own supreme nature attributes the qualities which he lacks, such as goodness, to a being outside himself, and thus the idea of God is born. Every act of love of God is begotten of want of self-love and exaltation of the Divine is built on self-debasement. Each man must make the choice between himself and God: "I deny God" means, "I deny the denial of myself" wrote Feuerbach, as anthropology took the place of theology.[26] Previously, David Strauss and Bruno Bauer (the latter a fellow member with Marx in the Young Hegelian movement) had attacked the authenticity of the gospels. Feuerbach, denying thought, ideas, mind and spirit, and by affirming that matter is the basic reality said:[27]

> "Let us forget about the absolute Idea; let us investigate man and the world as we find them."

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25. Sheen, *op. cit.*, p. 59.
26. *Ibid.*, p. 68.
27. Wilson, *op. cit.*, p. 126.

He killed the idealism of Hegel and destroyed all religion for Marx by showing that it is an illusion projected by the brain of man. With the gods dethroned, Marx took the dialectical method which Hegel applied to ideas and applied it to matter and to history. Uniting the dialectics of Hegel with the materialism of Feuerbach produced dialectical materialism which Marx and Engels adopted as the philosophy of communism. By application of the dialectic, Engels, in his Anti-Duhring, cured Feuerbach's error of taking a too mechanistic view of the universe and left room for process. Matter itself is endowed with motion—it develops by shocks, clashes, struggles and catastrophes. Thesis, antithesis, synthesis would be description not of the unfolding of spirit, but stages in the revolution of reality which would inevitably produce a Communist society.

Although Marx contradicted Hegel on the one principle that Hegel held to be fundamental (Reality is the physical world, not ideas), the imitation is so close that much that would be obscure if we had only the writings of Marx to guide us becomes clear. For Hegel:[28]

> "1. Reality is Spirit.
>
> "2. The highest activity of Spirit is knowledge.
>
> "3. The uttermost achievement of knowledge is knowledge of the whole of Reality—therefore the highest achievement of Spirit is knowledge of itself, for it is the whole of Reality.
>
> "4. Because this is the highest achievement it is the goal of Reality and Reality must inevitably attain it."

Marx follows this logical process very closely:

> "1. Reality is 'Matter,' i. e., whatever we find in the universe.
>
> "2. The highest activity of Reality is human activity; ...not the activity of individual man but of collective man ...
>
> "3. The highest achievement of Reality is therefore some form of human society, perfect, functioning as it ought, sufficient for itself, beyond which its members need not look.
>
> "4. And Marx's Reality will attain this goal as inevitably as Hegel's Reality will attain its goal."

The inevitable attainment of perfection by Reality will be in a perfect human society but nowhere is it proved that it is inevitable any more

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28. Sheed, *op. cit.*, p. 20.

than Hegel proves the inevitability of his. Certainly, it would have been remarkable if by automatically reversing Hegel you got a true picture of the universe; for if one philosophy is false, the opposite is not necessarily true. Suffice it to say that the dialectic is considered by Marx and Engels a sufficient theory of evolution in animate or inanimate nature and in society. In inanimate nature, indwelling contradictions develop by a sort of cosmic law. In the animal and plant kingdoms the contradictions may be bred by a changing environment or by a mutation within the plant or animal (following Darwin). In society, human beings in a given economic and social setting act in strains and stresses developing cumulatively. Then comes the negation of negation or an accumulation of quantitative changes which at a certain climactic stage emerge as new forms with new qualities. The negation is impersonal in animate or inanimate nature, but in social life it expresses human conservatism and progress, antagonisms in interests and classes, clashes and revolutions, all fostered by the mode of production.

But we get ahead of ourselves—what of the sociologists who contributed ideas to the founders of communism? One historian observes:[29]

> "Engels states that political science arose in the minds of a few geniuses of the seventeenth century but is essentially the product of the eighteenth because of the physiocrats and Adam Smith ... Marx speaks of Ricardo in high terms but regards him as the most stoical adversary of the proletariat... Elsewhere he implies that Adam Smith is an original thinker... Again Engels states that every real advance in England on behalf of the workers links itself to the name of Robert Owen. He introduced as transition measures to the complete communistic organization of society, co-operative societies..."

Adam Smith[30]

Early in the Eighteenth Century England was absorbed by the problem of what to do with the unprofitable poor—a million and a half of them out of a total population of twelve million. It was generally believed that unless the poor were poor, they could not be counted upon to do an honest day's

29. Bober, *op. cit.*, p. 84 and footnote p. 85.

30. Heilbroner, *op. cit.*, 33–66.

toil without asking for exorbitant wages. Hence the air was full of schemes for their disposition—despairing schemes, mostly, until 1776 when Adam Smith's philosophy that "No society can surely be flourishing and happy, of which by far the greater part are poor and miserable," was announced in his book, *The Wealth of Nations*. A professor of Moral Philosophy at the University of Glasgow, Scotland, Smith had travelled widely in England and France and had sounded a long line of observers in understanding his world: Locke, Stewart, Mandeville, Petty, Cantillon, Quesnay and Hume. Smith was concerned with promoting the wealth of the entire nation, with expounding a doctrine which would assist in running an empire. Two great problems absorbed his attention, first the mechanism by which society hangs together—to answer the question, "How is it possible for a community in which everyone is busily following his self-interest not to fly apart from sheer centrifugal force?" Secondly, to isolate the forces which impel society along its path, to discover the shape of things to come. What he sought was "the invisible hand which leads the private interests and passions of men in the direction which is most agreeable to the interest of the whole society." In response to these questions Smith formulated three laws: Market Accumulation and Population. The first tells us that the drive of individual self-interest in an environment of similarly motivated individuals will result in competition and demonstrates how competition will result in the provision of those goods that society wants, in the quantities that society desires and at the price it is prepared to pay. In a word, Smith found in the mechanism of free competition a self-regulating system which provides for society's orderly provision. Like the laws which explain how a spinning top stays upright, the laws of the market show how the selfish motives of men are transmuted by interaction to yield the most unexpected result, social harmony. But will the top, by virtue of its spinning be moved along? Adam Smith's world went slowly but more or less inevitably toward a more wonderful world. He saw deep-seated laws of motion which propel the market system in an ascending spiral of productivity. The second law is that of Accumulation. The Industrial Revolution provided a veritable grab bag of riches for whoever was shrewd enough to ride the current of expanding industry. The great majority of rising capitalists accumulated their savings, but Smith did not approve of accumulation for its own sake. Rather in the accumulation of capital Smith saw a vast benefit to society in capital, which, if put to use in

machinery, provided just that wonderful division of labor which multiplies man's productive energy. Accumulate and the world will benefit. But this would soon lead to more machinery and more machinery meant more demand for workmen which would in turn lead to higher wages until profits, the source of accumulation, were eaten away. This hurdle is overcome by the third law: The Law of Population. Smith believed that if wages were high, the number of workers would multiply; if wages fell, their numbers would decrease. Hence, the first effect of accumulation is to raise the wages of workers and this in turn brings about an increase in their numbers. But now the market mechanism takes over. Just as higher prices on the market will bring about a larger production of gloves and the larger number of gloves in turn press down the higher prices of gloves, so higher wages will bring about a larger number of workers which will set up a reverse pressure on the level of their wages. Society is thus seen as an organism whose life is an endless chain. As regularly and as inevitably as a series of interlocked mathematical propositions, society is started on an upward march. From its starting point accumulation of wealth takes place and this accumulation results in increased facilities for production and in a greater division of labor. But accumulation will also raise wages as capitalists bid for workers to man the new factories. As wages rise further accumulation begins to look unprofitable. But meanwhile workmen have used their higher wages to rear their children with fewer mortalities and hence increase the supply of workmen. As population swells, competition between workmen again press down on wages. And so accumulation continues in another spiral ascent of society. In the long run, beyond the horizon, lay a strange paradise. The natural level of wages would have risen; the landlord has fared well because of the increased population; the capitalist alone would have suffered a trying fate since his riches have multiplied tremendously and he realizes only the wages of management.

The question Smith raised in his Theory of Moral Sentiments:

> "To what purpose is all the toil and bustle of this world, what is the end of avarice and ambition of the pursuit of wealth, of power, and preeminence?"

He answered in The Wealth of Nations: all the grubby scrabbling for wealth and glory has its ultimate justification in the welfare of the common man. But because he saw the market as a wonderful social machine, *if it*

were left alone, his admonition that the "mean rapacity, the monopolizing spirit of the merchants and manufacturers," should exclude them from being the rulers of mankind was ignored in favor of the free and unfettered market wherein the rising industrialists found justification in blocking the first government attempts to remedy scandalous conditions in the factories.

Malthus and Ricardo[31]

In the fifty years that followed the Wealth of Nations, England had divided into two hostile camps: the rising industrialists, busy with factories, parliamentary representation and social prestige, and the great landowners, a rich, powerful and entrenched aristocracy who looked resentfully at the nouveaux riches. What had happened was that the England which in the time of Adam Smith was a grain exporting nation, was now being forced to buy foodstuffs from abroad. The capitalists complained that the price of grain was too high and as it soared higher, enterprising merchants began to buy wheat and corn abroad and bring them to England much to the dismay of the landlords. One of the factors was the actual growth of population which had caused it to exceed the supply and had quadrupled the price of a bushel of wheat. Interest turned naturally enough to the matter of population. Amateur statisticians such as Price and King, a mapmaker, estimated a gently rising population—five and a half million now, to double in all probability in about six hundred years and treble by the year of Our Lord 3500. All this was to the good since all agreed that a growing population was a national source of wealth. No one summed up this optimistic outlook so completely as William Godwin who in 1793 published *Political Justice*, which damned the present but gave promise of a distant future where there would no longer be a handful of rich and a multitude of poor, no war, crime, government, disease, anguish, melancholy or resentment. Of course it called for complete equality and for the most thoroughgoing anarchic communism. This idea was much discussed, particularly by Daniel Malthus and his son, the Rev. Thomas Malthus. The elder Malthus felt sympathetically inclined toward Godwin's Utopia

31. *Ibid.*, p. 67–95.

but young Malthus saw an insurmountable barrier between society as it was and as forecasted by Godwin. In 1798 Parson Malthus published an anonymous treatise of fifty thousand words entitled "An Essay on the Principle of Population as It Affects the Future Improvement of Society" which pulled the rug from under the feet of the complacent thinkers and offered them a dreary and chilling prospect. For his essay established that there was a tendency for population to outstrip all means of subsistence. Against the assumption that the human animal would tend to double his numbers in twenty five years Malthus opposed the fact that land, unlike people cannot be multiplied—unlike population, land does not breed it must be added to laboriously. Hence while the number of mouths grows geometrically, the amount of cultivable land grows only arithmetically. Nothing could rescue mankind from the threat of drowning under its own weight but the frail reed of "moral restraint."

Anyone not sufficiently depressed by Malthus had only to turn to David Ricardo, his friend and stock broker who described the universe in his *Principles of Political Economy* published in 1817. Possessing all the characteristics of a drama, his protagonists are not people, they are prototypes who follow "laws of behavior." First are the workers whose only human aspect is "the delights of domestic society." Enjoyment of these delights results in an increase in population with every rise in wages. The workers get their dry crust for without it they could not perpetuate themselves, but over the long run they are condemned by their own weakness to a life at the margin of subsistence. Next are the capitalists, not Adam Smith's conniving merchants, but economic machines interested only in self-aggrandizement. Their entire purpose is to accumulate profits and to reinvest them by hiring still more men to work for them. But their lot is not an easy one—for one thing, by competing among themselves, they quickly erase any undue profits, for another, their profits depend largely on the wages they have to pay, and this leads them into difficulties. (So far right down the line with Adam Smith). The key to Ricardo's theory however is the landlord, whom he saw as the unique beneficiary in organized society. The worker worked for which he received a wage; the capitalist ran the show, for which he gained a profit but the landlord benefited from the powers of the soil, and his income—rent—was not held in line by either competition or by the power of population. In Ricardo's expanding economic world the capitalists built new shops and

factories as they accumulated profits. Therefore, the demand for laborers increased which boosted wages, at least temporarily, for better pay would soon tempt the incorrigible workers to avail themselves of those delights of domestic society and flood the market with still more workers. So as the growing population caused more and more land to be put into use, the cost of grain would rise. Hence the rents of the well-situated landlords would rise. Not only rents, but wages too, for as grain became more expensive to produce (on the newly added second-rate fields) the laborers would have to be paid more, just to permit him to buy his dry crust. As the landlord's share in society's fruits increases, there is only one class who can get pushed aside to make room—the capitalist. This was a different picture from Adam Smith's great pageant of progress where everybody gradually became better off as the division of labor increased and made the community more wealthy. In Ricardo's theory, only the landlord stood to gain when the pressure of mouths on insufficient cropland stalled the upward motion of capitalist society.

We know now that the dire implications of increasing rental returns never came to pass because the industrialists finally broke the power of the landlords through repeal of the Corn Laws, thereby securing the importation of cheap food. Equally important, the fate which Malthus predicted for the Western World never befell. Something (we still do not fully understand the reasons) happened in England, France, the Continent, and the United States to slow down the flood of new mouths. In 1860, 63% of the couples in Great Britain had four or more children; in 1925 only 20% had more than four. Over the same period, the number of families with one or two children increased from 10% to 50%. In 1949 only one American family out of seven had three or more children. Birth control played a part, it is true, although Malthus disapproved the practice. The process of industrialization itself appears to have a tempering influence on the size of the family—marriages take place later (the moral restraint advocated by Malthus)—women were elevated from mere childbearers to working members of society—competing pleasures make a large family seem less desirable than in a simpler way of life.

As with Adam Smith's doctrine of laissez faire, the landlord's domination over the economy is a textbook curiosity and the population question is no longer of immediate concern in the Far East. But between them, Malthus and Ricardo, the last of a generation which put its faith in reason,

and progress, changed the world from an optimistic to a pessimistic one. It was no small achievement for two men to convince the world that it was living in a fool's paradise. But they did; and so convincing was their proof that men sought a way out for society, not within the framework of the supposed natural laws, but in defiance of them. Malthus and Ricardo had shown that, left to itself, society would proceed to a kind of living hell. No wonder that reformers said, we will put our efforts to fighting against the natural tendencies of society, so the Utopian Socialists broke away from the faithful trust in the essential rightness of the world as it was.

Utopians

The Utopia-builders have existed since Plato, but it was not until the French Revolution that they began to react to economic as well as political injustice. Since it was early capitalism which provided the chamber of horrors against which they revolted, they not unnaturally turned their backs on private property and the struggle for private wealth. Few of them thought of reform within the system—in their time watered-down factory legislation were largely honored in the breach—rather they wanted something better than reform, a new society in which Love Thy Neighbor could somehow be made to take priority over the mean gouging of each for himself. In the communality of property, in the warmth of common ownership, was to be found the secret of human progress.

Saint-Simon (1760–1825)[32] in his New Christianity called for a society based on the principle of human brotherhood. Impressed with the productive powers of the new industry, he appealed to the mind and conscience of his day, proposing that it be socialized under the state with the workers sharing according to the quality and quantity of their work.

Charles Fourier (1768–1830)[33] was an experienced businessman who advocated sharing profits with employees and who looked upon soldiers, philosophers, stock brokers and middlemen as "parasitic" and "unproductive." His solution was to reorganize society into small communities,

32. Wilson, *op. cit.*, p. 84.

33. *Ibid.*, p. 87–90.

self-contained societies inside the larger society. His communities were to be dependent on private capital and were not to aim at complete equality—there would be differences of income and a hierarchy in which the capitalists would not stand at the top. In the distribution of income by dividend, capital was to get only four-twelfths while five-twelfths went to labor and three-twelfths to talent. Disagreeable work was to be paid for at a higher rate than work not pleasant and necessary work was to rank higher than merely useful work. There was something that everybody liked to do, so there was no reason why everything should not get done.

Robert Owen (1771–1858)[34] was a textile manufacturer in England where he put his theories into practice in his own cotton industry in New Lanark. His whole career was one long reiteration of the principle that men had been made what they were by education and early influences over which they had no control. If only the right things instead of the wrong could be taught during their formative years, they could be rendered, as he put it, with "mathematical precision" universally happy and good. His actual exploits sound fantastic today. When he first took possession of the mills at New Lanark, they were operated by a crew of dirty and drunken, extremely unreliable men and women and by children between five and ten shipped in from the orphan asylums. Out of the material of this wretched population, he was able to create in a quarter of a century a community with a high standard of living and a considerable degree of education. At Lanark were neat rows of workers' homes with two rooms in every house; here were streets with garbage neatly piled up awaiting disposal instead of being strewn in filthy disarray. In the factories a still more unusual sight greeted the visitor. Over each employee hung a little cube of wood with a different color painted on each side: black, blue, yellow, and white. From darkest to lightest, the colors stood for different grades of deportment; white was excellent; yellow, good; blue, indifferent; black, bad. At a glance the manager could see how his work force was faring. It was mainly yellow and white. There were no children in the factories, at least none under ten or eleven, and they toiled only a short ten and three-quarter hour day. Furthermore they were never punished. Most remarkable were the little children. Instead of running wild through the

34. *Ibid.*, p. 92–98.

streets, they worked and played in a large schoolhouse. Over all, the door of the factory manager stood open and anyone could and did present his objections to any regulation or appeal his deportment as shown by the colored monitor over his machine. The final irrefutable fact was that New Lanark was profitable. But despite the evidence it cannot be denied that Robert Owen played the role of a benevolent but omnipotent God in his factory. He never realized that he had created this moral universe himself and was always surprised that his communities failed to prosper when left to the direction of others as did his thirty thousand acre community of New Harmony, Indiana, established in 1826 and sold as a failure three years later. The combination of the existing attitude among industrialists that if the masses became well-off and independent the governing classes no longer control them, and his advocacy of socialization of property, family and abolition of religion, brought his theories into disrepute.

Finally we reach the last phase in the development of Marxist philosophy, the influence of French sociology. In addition to thoroughly studying the history of the French Revolution, Marx had made the acquaintance of P. J. Proudhon in the summer of 1844 after reading his book *What Is Property?* in which he had given the answer "Property is theft," Marx had felt considerable respect for Proudhon and in long nocturnal sessions had expounded to him the doctrine of Hegel. One night at the Paris lodgings of the famous Russian revolutionist Bakunin, Marx discussed with Proudhon Hegel's emphasis on the state. Proudhon maintained that the big problem was economic, not political or social, and if he, Marx, wanted to keep his dialectics, he should apply it in some way to property. This Proudhon did by suggesting that perhaps capital was the affirmative side of dialectics, which in turn begot its contradiction, which was labor. Somewhere there ought to be a synthesis which would involve changes of property. Where the Frenchman led, the German followed, and when Marx left the garret of Bakunin that night the complete philosophy of communism was born. Proudhon became the inspiration of the main cog in Marxist communism. Dialectical materialism applied to economics became economic determinism and applied to history became historical materialism. In addition, Marx had read the French Communist Dezamy who was sure that the proletariat, among whom he included the peasants, must unite and liberate itself, echoing Babeuf's defense during the French Revolution that:

> "the mass of the expropriated proletarians agreed to be frightful constituting now the majority of a nation totally rotten."[35]

Marx and Engels had by this time taken stock of their predecessors and, with their own sharp and realistic minds, lopped off the sentimentality and fantasy which had surrounded the utopians. From Saint-Simon they accepted as valid his discovery that modern politics was simply the science of regulating production; from Fourier, his arraignment of the bourgeois and his consciousness of the spirit of all-devouring commercialism; from Owen, the realization that the factory system must be the root of the social revolution. But they saw the mistake of the socialists in imagining that socialism was to be imposed upon society from above by disinterested members of the upper classes. Marx and Engels believed that the bourgeoisie as a whole could not be induced to go against its own interests, and they threw away all the idealism, the justice, humanity and brotherhood of their predecessors.

But Proudhon was the main catalyst; Proudhon who had produced, out of the Hegelian theory of development, a new kind of utopian socialism which did not require for its realization a genuine Hegelian emergence of the working class as the new force that was to overthrow the old, but which was an affair merely of succoring the poor under the existing system of property relations. Marx now saw that the axiom "Property is theft," (as applied by Proudhon to the Eighteenth Century abstraction of a universal man endowed with a fundamental right to own property) itself presupposed real rights in property and incorporated new conditions into the old system. And here we encounter what Marx himself claimed to be one of his only original contributions to the system that afterwards was known as Marxism.[36] It was the theory that all history was a succession of struggles between an exploiting and an exploited class. These struggles were thus the results of the methods of production which prevailed during the various periods—that is, the methods by which people succeeded in providing themselves with food, clothing and other requirements. Such apparently inspired and independent phenomena as politics, philosophy

35. *Ibid.*, p. 145.

36. *Ibid.*, p. 146.

and religion arose in reality from the social phenomena. The current struggle between the exploiters and the exploited had reached a point at which the exploited, the proletariat, had been robbed of all its human rights and had so come to stand for the primary rights of humanity, and at which the class that owned and controlled the industrial machine was becoming increasingly unable to distribute its products—so that the victory of the workers over the owners, the taking over by the former of the machine, would mean the end of class society altogether and the liberation of the spirit of man.

CHAPTER III

The Marx-Engels Doctrine of Inevitability

We have reviewed some of the early Nineteenth Century thought as representative of social situations which Marx and Engels were drawing upon. Behind the conspicuous figures who gave currency to socialist ideas were other less well-known or obscure sources, agitators, politicians, pamphleteers, and the newspaper writers. In addition Engels performed a most important service for Marx in filling in the blank face and figure of Marx's abstract proletarian and in placing him in a real factory. For Engels brought back from England the materials for his book on *The Condition of the Working Class in England in 1844*, which provided the social background, the cycles of industrial prosperity and depressions due to blind appetites of competing manufacturers, which would make Marx's vision authentic.

These ideas reached the world in 1848 when the *Communist Manifesto* was published jointly by Marx and Engels for the international Communist League. It compresses with terrific vigor into fifty pages a general theory of history, an analysis of society and a program for revolutionary action. Recall the explosive, historically drenched, logical phrases:[37]

37. *The Communist Manifesto*, U. S. 80th Congress, 2d sess. Committee on Foreign Affairs, *The Strategy and Tactics of World Communism*, Sub-committee No. 5, p. 5–27.

A. The Communist Manifesto

(Marginal note: All previous history was characterized by class struggles)

"The history of all hitherto existing society is the history of class struggles

Freeman and slave, patrician and plebeian, lord and serf, guildmaster and journeyman, in a word, oppressor and oppressed, stood in constant opposition to one another, carried on an uninterrupted, now hidden, now open fight, a fight that each time ended, either in a revolutionary re-constitution of society at large, or in the common ruin of the contending classes ...

"The modern bourgeois Society that has sprouted from the ruins of feudal society, has not done away with class antagonisms. It has but established new classes, new conditions of oppression, new forms of struggle in place of the old ones.

(Marginal note: Now reduced to conflict between two classes)

"Our epoch, the epoch of the bourgeoisie... has simplified the class antagonisms. Society is ... more and more splitting up into two great hostile camps, ... directly facing each other: Bourgeoisie and Proletariat ... the modern bourgeoisie is itself the product of a long course of development, of a series of revolutions in the modes of production... Each step was accompanied by a corresponding political advance of that class ... (until) at last, since the establishment of Modern Industry and of the world-market, conquered for itself, in the modern representative State, exclusive political sway ... It has pitilessly torn asunder the motley feudal ties that bound man to his 'natural superiors,' and has left remaining no other nexus between man and man than naked self-interest, than callous 'cash payment.' .. It has resolved personal worth into exchange value, and in place of the numberless ... chartered freedoms, has set up that single, unconscionable freedom-Free Trade. In one word, for exploitation, veiled by religious and political illusions, it has substituted naked, shameless, direct brutal exploitation...

(Marginal note: Bourgeois society condemned)

"...Constant revolutionizing of production, uninterrupted disturbance of all social conditions, everlasting uncertainty and agitation distinguish the bourgeois epoch from all earlier ones...

(Marginal note: How bourgeois developed)

"...The need of a constantly expanding market for its products chases the bourgeois over the whole surface of the globe ... All old-established national industries have been destroyed ... In place of the old local and national seclusion and self-sufficiency, we have intercourse in every direction, universal interdependence of nations.

"...It compels all nations, on pain of extinction, to adopt the bourgeois mode of production; it compels them to introduce what it calls civilization into their midst, i.e., to become bourgeois themselves. In a word it creates a world after its own image...

"...Just as it has made the country dependent on the towns, so it has made barbarian countries dependent on the civilized ones ...

"...It has agglomerated population, centralized means of production, and has concentrated property in a few hands...

(Marginal note: Mode of Production is basis of all society)

"...For many a decade past the history of industry and commerce is but the history of revolt of modern productive forces against modern conditions of production, against the property relations ...It is enough to mention the commercial crises that by their periodical return put on its trial, each time more threateningly, the existence of the entire bourgeois society. In these crises a great part not only of the existing products, but also of the previously created productive forces, are periodically destroyed. In these crises there breaks out an epidemic that, in all earlier epochs, would have seemed an absurdity—the epidemic of overproduction ... And how does the bourgeoisie get over these crises? On the one hand by enforced destruction of a mass of productive forces; on the other, by the conquest of new markets, and by the more thorough exploitation of the old ones. That is to say by paving the way for more extensive and more destructive crises, and by diminishing the means whereby crises are prevented ...

(Marginal notes: Crises occur; Greater crises predicted)

"...But not only has the bourgeoisie forged the weapons that bring death to itself; it has also called into existence the men who are to wield those weapons—the modern working-class—the proletarians.

(Marginal note: How proletariat developed)

"In proportion as the bourgeoisie, i.e., capital, is developed, in the same proportion is the proletariat, the modern working class, developed, a class of laborers, who live only so long as they find work, and who find work only so long as their labor increases capital. These laborers ... are a commodity ... and are ... exposed .. to all the fluctuations of the market...

(Marginal note: As machinery increases lot of workers debased)

"...He becomes an appendage of the machine, and it is only the most simple, most monotonous and most easily acquired knack that is required of him. Hence, the cost of production of a workman is restricted ... to the means

of subsistence ... But the price of a commodity, and also of labor, is equal to its cost of production. In proportion, therefore, as the repulsiveness of the work increases, the wage decreases. Nay more, in proportion as the use of machinery and division of labor increases, in the same proportion the burden of toil also increases, whether by prolongation of the working hours, ... or by increased speed of the machinery, etc...

"...The less the skill and exertion ...the more is the labor of men superseded by that of women...

"...No sooner is the exploitation of the laborer by the manufacturer...at an end... than he is set upon by the other portions of the bourgeoisie, the landlord, the shopkeeper, the pawnbroker, etc.

(Marginal note: Proletariat swelled)

"The lower strata of the middle class—the small trades people, shopkeepers, ... the handicraftsmen and peasants—all these sink gradually into the proletariat, partly because ..(it) is swamped in competition with the large capitalists, partly because (its) specialized skill is rendered worthless by new methods of production. Thus the proletariat is recruited from all classes of the population.

(Marginal note: Band together)

"The proletariat goes through various stages of development. With its birth it begins to struggle with the bourgeoisie. At first the contest is carried on by individual laborers, then by the workpeople of a factory, then by the operatives of one trade, in one locality ... They direct their attacks not against the bourgeois conditions of production, but against the instruments of production themselves; they destroy imported wares that compete with their labor, they smash to pieces machinery, they set factories ablaze, they seek to restore by force the vanished status of the workman of the Middle Ages.

(Marginal note: Smash instruments of production)

"At this stage the laborers still form an incoherent mass scattered over the whole country, and broken up by their mutual competition. If anywhere they unite to form more compact bodies, this is not yet the consequence of their own active union, but of the union of the bourgeoisie, which class, in order to attain its own political ends, is compelled to set the whole proletariat in motion...At this stage ...the proletarians do not fight their enemies, but the enemies of their enemies, the remnants of absolute monarchy, the landowners, the nonindustrial bourgeoisie. Thus the whole historical movement is concentrated in the hands of the bourgeoisie; every victory so obtained is a victory for the bourgeoisie.

(Marginal note: Bourgeois Revolution)

"But with the development of industry the proletariat not only increases in number, it becomes concentrated in greater masses ... and nearly everywhere becomes equalized, as machinery obliterated all distinctions of labor and ... reduces wages to the same low level. The growing competition among the bourgeois, and the resulting commercial crises, makes the wages of the workers ever more fluctuating. The unceasing improvement of machinery, ever more rapidly developing, makes their livelihood more and more precarious; the collisions between...workmen and bourgeois take more and more the character of collisions between two classes...

(Marginal note: Class Struggle)

"...This organization (Union) of the proletarians into a class and consequently into a political party, is continually being upset again by the competition between the workers themselves. But it ever rises up again, stronger, firmer, mightier ...

(Marginal note: Unions)

"...Finally, in times when the class-struggle nears the decisive hour, the process of dissolution going on within the ruling class, in fact, within the whole range of old society, assumes such a violent, glaring character, that a small section of the ruling class cuts itself adrift, and joins the revolutionary class, the class that holds the future in its hands...

(Marginal note: Joined by Vanguard of Intelligentsia)

"All the preceding classes that got the upper hand, sought to fortify their already acquired status by subjecting society at large to the conditions of appropriation. The proletarian cannot become master of the productive forces of society, except by abolishing their own previous mode of appropriation. They have nothing of their own to secure and to fortify; their mission is to destroy all previous securities for, and insurances of, individual property.

(Marginal note: Proletariat has nothing to lose)

"All previous historical movements were movements of minorities...The proletarian movement is the self-conscious, independent movement of the immense majority, in the interest of the immense majority ...

(Marginal note: and is Majority Movement)

"...Hitherto, every form of society had been based ...on the antagonism of oppressing and oppressed classes...The serf, in the period of serfdom, raised himself to membership in the commune, just as the petty bourgeois

under the yoke of feudal absolutism, managed to develop into a bourgeois. The modern laborer, on the contrary, instead of rising with the progress of industry, sinks deeper and deeper below the conditions of existence of his own class. He becomes a pauper, and pauperism develops more rapidly than population and wealth. And here it becomes evident, that the bourgeoisie is unfit any longer to be the ruling class in society...It is unfit to rule because it is incompetent to assure an existence to its slave within his slavery, because it cannot help letting him sink into such a state that it has to feed him, instead of being fed by him. Society can no longer live under this bourgeoisie, in other words, its existence is no longer compatible with society.

(Marginal notes: Unlike previous oppressed, modern labor has no hope; Bourgeois unfit to exist)

"The essential condition for the existence, and for the sway of the bourgeois class, is the formation and augmentation of capital; the condition for capital is wage-labor. Wage-labor rests exclusively on competition between the laborers. The advance of industry, whose involuntary promoter is the bourgeoisie, replaces the isolation of the laborers. ... The development of Modern Industry, therefore, cuts from under its feet the very foundation of which the bourgeoisie produces...What the bourgeoisie therefore produces, above all, are its own grave-diggers. Its fall and the victory of the proletariat are equally inevitable...

(Marginal note: End of capitalism)

"The charges against communism made from a religious, a philosophical and...from an ideological standpoint, are not deserving of a serious examination...What else does the history of ideas prove, than that intellectual production changes in character in proportion as material production is changed? The ruling ideas of each age have ever been the ideas of its ruling class ...

(Marginal notes: Religion? Philosophy?; Class determines Philosophy)

"...'Undoubtedly,' it will be said, 'religious, moral, philosophical and juridical ideas have been modified in the course of historical development. But religion, morality, philosophy, political science and law constantly survived this change.

"There are besides, eternal truths, such as Freedom, Justice, etc. But communism abolishes eternal truths, ...all religion, and all morality, instead of constituting them on a new basis; it therefore acts in contradiction to all past historical experience.

(Marginal note: Communism ignorant of History?)

"What does this accusation reduce itself to? The history of all past society has consisted in the development of class antagonisms, antagonisms that assumed different forms at different epochs.

"But whatever form they may have taken, one fact is common to all past ages, viz., the exploitation of one part of society by the other. No wonder, then, that the social consciousness of past ages, despite all the multiplicity and variety it displays, moves within certain common forms, or general ideas, which cannot completely vanish except with the total disappearance of class antagonisms.

(Marginal note: History shows that all common ideas and religions are based on class antagonisms)

"The Communist revolution is the most radical rupture with traditional property-relations; no wonder that its development involves the most radical rupture with traditional ideas.

(Marginal note: Communism cures defect)

"But let us have done with the bourgeois objections to communism.

"When, in the course of development, class distinctions have disappeared and all production has been concentrated in the hands of a vast association of the whole nation, the public power will lose its political character. Political power, properly so-called, is merely the organized power of one class for oppressing another. If the proletariat during its contest with bourgeoisie is compelled, by the force of circumstances to organize itself as a class, if, by means of a revolution, it makes itself the ruling class, and, as such, sweeps away by force the old conditions of production, then it will, along with these conditions, have swept away the conditions for the existence of class antagonisms, and of classes generally, and will thereby have abolished its own supremacy as a class.

(Marginal note: Future under Communism free of all defects.)

"In place of the old bourgeois society, with its classes and class antagonisms, we shall have an association, in which the free development of each is the condition for the free development of all."

Marx and Engels had assimilated with remarkable rapidity the social and historical thinking of their time and produced a complete and coherent theory which cleared up past mysteries, simplified present complexities and opened for the future a practical course of action. But more important

they introduced a "dynamic principle" from Hegel which got the whole system going along a path clearly evident in history and which not only attracted one's interest in the great drama but forced one to recognize that one was part of its noble or ignoble roles.

There are two doctrines chiefly associated with Marx; the materialist conception of history and the theory of surplus value. The *Communist Manifesto* is primarily an application of the former while his chief work, Das Kapital, expounds the latter. According to the Encyclopaedia Britannica [38] Marx's only general account of the Materialist Conception of History is found in a few pages of the Preface and Introduction to his Critique of Political Economy, the germ of his larger work, Capital. Since this study has singled out the dogma of history's inevitable movement toward a Communist future, Marx's materialist conception of history should be examined. As Gerhart Niemeyer observes in his 1956 *An Inquiry into Soviet Mentality*[39]

> "...Certain parts (of Marx's theory) have remained untouched, an inviolate dogma. Significantly, this residue is precisely the irrational element, the 'intuition of the future.' This vision, temptingly dressed up as a fool-proof 'scientific' theory, has taken a deep and almost subconscious hold on those who have embraced it in the way of a pseudo-religion. It supplies them with a hope, a task, a notion of life's meaning, a criterion of the elect...Communists have never sought to reinterpret, adapt, or distort the dogma of history's inexorable movement involving an end of all non-Communist societies ...The mind of a Marxist is emotionally anchored in a future that he considers exclusively and assuredly his own, and is thereby rendered largely insensitive to the correcting effects of present experience."

B. The Materialist Conception of History

The materialist conception of history is far from being merely the doctrine that economic forces are predominant in the history of society; still less is the doctrine that individual men act only from material motives.

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38. Encyclopaedia Britannica, *Karl Heinrich Marx*, Vol. 14, (Chicago: University of Chicago, 1946), p. 997.

39. Gerhart Niemeyer, *An Inquiry Into Soviet Mentality*, (New York: Frederick A. Praeger, 1956), p. 26–27.

In essence, Marx contended that there exist, in any society, certain material "forces of production" and a certain knowledge of their use in man's service. These form the "conditions of production," and for their employment there is required an arrangement of society, including a certain relationship among the members, and the establishment of social institutions. If the "forces of production" are to be fully exploited, certain forms of private property must be recognized and secured, and certain members of society given authority over the means of production and over other members of society who must accept a subordinate role. This recognition and authority necessitate a power able to enforce them, i.e., the State which takes its special form from the character of the economic institutions it must uphold. Political and social institutions thus depend upon and derive their special forms from the underlying economic circumstances of the society in which they exist. Because of changes both in the forces of production and the knowledge of their use, these underlying conditions are flexible. It follows that the superstructure, i. e., the arrangement of social classes and political institutions which maintain the existing order, must also change as the conditions of production are modified. However, the institutions, both the State and social classes, once established are highly resistant to change. Hence they tend to lag behind the progress of the economic system, until the accumulated disharmony causes a class struggle and forces drastic readjustment through revolution. Then the entire superstructure is brought crashing down, and a new arrangement of classes, and a new set of institutions arise which are in harmony with the new economic order. This conception of the method of social and political change underlies the fierce invective we saw in the *Communist Manifesto* and, in fact, all Marx's writings on the strategy of socialism and revolution.

From the *Manifesto*, *Das Kapital* and some of Engels' writings one can construct an account of the succession of productive orders which have prevailed since the dawn of history to present day. Up to now the dialectic has evolved four distinct productive regimes, and Marx divides history into four epochs: Primitive Communism, Ancient Slavery, Medieval Feudalism and Capitalism. All these are "prehistoric" eras, mere preludes to the future epoch, the socialistic.

The first economic order prevailed in the infancy of human development. This mode of production was characterized by communal property

and directly associated labor. Agriculture and crafts were the chief occupations. The land was held and tilled in common by the members of the tribe, and the harvest divided among the producers. Other needs were supplied by each family through handicraft labor, e.g., spinning, and weaving. Trading was carried on to a limited extent, chiefly between neighboring tribes, who made different articles according to their natural resources. This was the origin of exchange. According to Marx:[40]

> "Those ancient social organisms of production are, as compared with bourgeois society, extremely simple and transparent. But they are founded on the immature development of man individually, who has not yet severed the umbilical cord that unites him with his fellow men in a primitive tribal community ... They can arise and exist only when the development of the productive power of labor has not risen beyond a low stage, and when, therefore, the social relations within the sphere of material life, between man and man, and between man and Nature, are correspondingly narrow."

Soon an ominous phenomenon appears that deals a death blow to the communal order. The advent of private property in herds of cattle and articles of luxury led to an exchange between individuals, to a metamorphosis of products into commodities. Just why private property sprang into existence remains unexplained, except that "the herds drifted into the hands of private individuals."[41] During the last period of primitive communities, progress became more rapid and less interrupted. Agriculture developed and yielded new products, like oil and wine; production improved to such a degree that a worker produced more than he required to sustain himself. Towns developed and are more and more divided from the country. Wealth was sought; production for exchange increased; tribes gave up peaceful pursuits to plunder and piracy. Labor power became desirable and since the communal system had no surplus laborers except prisoners of war, captives were no longer killed but retained as slaves. Primitive Communism was dying and the second economic stage, the era of classical slavery arrives.

At the dawn of civilization we come to the era of slaves whose forced labor formed the basis on which the whole superstructure of society was

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40. Karl Marx, *Capital*, Vol. I, p. 100.

41. Bober, *op. cit.*, p. 48.

reared. Slaves abound in the shops and although labor by free citizens is despised, there are many free artisans who earn a living in competition with slave labor. In Athens at the height of her power there were 90,000 free citizens and 365,000 slaves. The surplus produced by the slaves stimulates trade, commerce, and navigation and creates a new figure, the merchant, who becomes the central figure in society. He does not engage in production, but merely connects producers to new markets. He exploits the producers, amasses wealth, gains prestige, and struggles with the old nobility for supremacy, employing a new weapon, money, which comes into existence to facilitate exchange. The farmer contracts monetary debts, mortgages his land, and unable to pay the usurious rates, forfeits his property and is sold into slavery. Soon exploitation shifts from between rich and poor to that between master and slave so that in the end the Athenian state is an instrument of the rich against the poor and of the master against the slave. The poverty of the masses contributes to the decline in traffic and decay of the towns while shrinking markets restrict production. In Rome the immense estates where slaves engage in large scale agriculture are no longer remunerative and are parceled out to colonists who pay a fixed sum annually but who can be transferred by sale along with their lots. The independent farmers place themselves under the protection of a man of power to avoid the oppression of officials and usurers, but their patrons take advantage of their plight and impose harsh conditions leading to servitude. The settlement of barbarian invaders does not alter conditions. When they triumph over Rome and take the reins of government they find their primitive communal organization inadequate to solve the new problems. Roman methods are adopted and in the Ninth Century we see the same social and economic conditions which prevailed four hundred years before. Serfdom spreads on an increasing scale. As in the case of transition from primitive communal society to slavery it is not exactly clear how the dialectic manages to achieve a metamorphosis of the slave mode of production into a feudal mode. What are the productive forces liberated by slavery that unavoidably create a higher order? Feudalism is ushered in by agencies not inherently bred by a slave regime—the decay of markets that renders slavery unprofitable—the insecurity of the independent farmer resulting from oppressive government and causing him to seek protection—the force of external historical events that injects the fresh vigor of the barbarians who introduce a mild form of servitude.

The crucial question: does a slave mode of production inevitably produce feudalism? We find no answer.[42]

Under Medieval Feudalism, peasant agriculture on a small scale and independent handicrafts form the mode of production. In the country, the serf possesses the land by hereditary right although absolute ownership is vested in the lord. In addition to farming, the peasant and his family engage in domestic industry to provide for other needs but in both pursuits he owns the means of production and controls the product, utilizing it for his own consumption or a very narrow market. Initially, rent may be in the form of labor done on the lord's estate, (an unmistakable form of surplus-value) whereas later rent in kind appears and the serf surrenders a definite amount of agricultural and handicraft products. When money comes into greater use the serf pays his rent with it and in selling the surplus above his needs can accumulate wealth. In the town the artisan is engaged in handicraft industry. He owns the raw material and other means of production as well as the completed product and is familiar with the market for which he produces. Here too the direct producer controls his product. Into the idyllic scene of the master with his small garden and the apprentice working more for education than for his pay in board and lodging there intrude the sinister figure of the usurer of old and the merchant who facilitates exchange between town and country. The dominant forms of capital are the usurer's and the merchant's which cannot turn into industrial capital because of the feudal restrictions in the country and the guild regulations in the town. "Everywhere the towns exploit the land by its monopoly prices, taxation, guild organisation and usury."[43] Slowly new elements develop—serfdom is eliminated—the semi-independent peasant can buy himself free—artisans begin to employ labor and become capitalists—the merchant increases production by hiring and exploiting labor as new markets are developed. But the new productive forces and rising bourgeoisie are handicapped at each step by the old mode of production and social relations. The worker possesses the means of production and works for himself and labor for hire is scarce because of guild impediments. This snail's pace must give way to stronger forces before the capitalistic system of production arrives.

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42. *Ibid.*, p. 54.

43. Karl Marx, *Capital*, Vol. III., p. 930.

The prime causes of the upheaval are the great geographical discoveries at the end of the Fifteenth Century. Overseas trade is extended and faraway markets grow, increasing the demand for commodities which the old mode of production is inadequate to meet. But before capitalistic production can be established the two possessors of different kinds of commodities, owners of money and means of production and masses of workers, dispossessed from the means of production must be brought together. This realization is achieved by a process that Marx terms "original accumulation" because it forms the prehistoric stage, the starting-point of capitalism.[44] The impoverished feudal nobility disband the numerous retainers from house and castle and simultaneously turn arable land into sheep-walks so that whole populations of independent peasants are torn from the soil and cast adrift in complete ruin. Armies of homeless, enraged vagabonds roam the countryside taking to robbery. Legislation is enacted which inflicts severe punishment for idleness and forces them to sell their labor at any price. "Thus" says Marx, "were the agricultural people first forcibly expropriated from the soil, driven from their homes, turned into vagabonds, and then whipped, branded, tortured by laws grotesquely terrible, into the discipline necessary for the wage system."[45] At the same time the bourgeoisie is being formed to play their part in the "original accumulation." America floods Europe with gold and silver resulting in a tremendous rise in prices and bringing ruin to the landlord and laboring class through depreciation of rent and wages but simultaneously increasing the bourgeoisie profits. The state employs various means to hasten the "original accumulation" in both its phases. It presses the newly formed proletariat into workshops by laws against idleness, by forcing down his wage and prolonging his workday while at the same time it launches national debts and public credit which instill into money the power of breeding and turning into capital. Financiers, merchants and manufacturers accumulate wealth and foster joint-stock companies, stock exchange and banks. The loans require taxation and a system of protection to permit exploitation of labor and abbreviates transition from the medieval to the modern mode of production. This whole era of production is based on the town handicrafts and rural domestic industries but

44. Marx, *op. cit.*, Vol. I, p. 784, 786.

45. *Ibid.*, p. 808–809.

is incapable of satisfying the demands of an ever-expanding market. The machine appears when manual labor no longer satisfies the needs of the market. With machinery the dominant characteristic, the final phase of production is called by Marx and Engels "modern industry" and its outstanding feature is the factory.[46] The finale is familiar from the Manifesto which portrays the enslavement of man to the machine, the remorseless grinding of surplus-value out of the wage slaves, their increasing misery and the crises and panics ending with the fall of capitalism and victory of the proletariat.

The Future According to Marx and Engels

We have reviewed the materialist conception of history and found that economics determines all things historical, including man's consciousness and conduct. It determines all ethics and explains the origin and function of the state. Capitalism is organized greed; economic man amassing great wealth through technical mastery and the exploitation of the helpless proletariat. But it begets its own negation, for the workers, growing ever more miserable rise in revolution and forcibly seize the power of the state. Hence, applied to history the dialectic becomes economic determinism and involves progress and a final goal. What is the future according to dialectic materialism as interpreted by Marx and Engels? It is the inevitable but temporary dictatorship of the proletariat, coming as a consequence of the rottenness and contradiction of Capitalism, and its infallibly predictable sequel, universal communism wherein classes, class antagonism and the state itself are abolished.

After the failures of the French and German parliaments in 1848, Marx added a new feature to his body of doctrine contained in the *Communist Manifesto*, which he claimed to be another of his original contributions to socialist political theory: the dictatorship of the proletariat. It appeared to him that it would not be enough for the proletariat to seize political power; it would be necessary to destroy bourgeois institutions and start socialism with a clean slate. It would be necessary for the proletariat to beat down

46. *Ibid.*, p. 430, 520.

all those forces which would inevitably keep working to restore the capitalistic state. The government which Marx recommended for the welfare and elevation of mankind was an exclusive and relentless class despotism directed by intelligentsia, such as Engels and himself, who had been able to rise above the classes. Beyond the dictatorship of the proletariat would be, as pronounced in the Manifesto [47] "an association in which the free development of each will lead to the free development of all." Marx never did explain how this condition was to be arrived at after the dictatorship had been clamped down, but he threw out, in the "Critique of the Gotha Program," some intimations of how socialist society would look in the initial stages:[48]

> "The classes will have been abolished; but inequalities will still exist. There will not yet be any such thing as an equal right to pay and what it purchases...Since there will still persist differences in ability, physical and intellectual, produced by the society of the past, so that there will be differences in the extent or intensity of the work that different men will be able to perform, and since value is created by labor, the workers of the socialist society will have unequal, not equal, rights... It will be only in a higher phase of Communist society, after the enslaving subordination of individuals subjected to the division of labor shall have been done away with, and thereby also the antithesis between physical and intellectual work, after labor has ceased to be merely a means to live but has become itself the prime necessity of life, after the forces of production have also increased with the all-around development of the individual and all the springs of co-operative wealth are more abundantly flowing that the narrow horizon of bourgeois rights can finally be quite overpassed and society inscribe on its banners: 'From each according to his ability, to each according to his needs!' "

In summary, first comes the period of radical change—capitalist strongholds are razed and new institutions are introduced but the many complicated capitalistic mechanisms and processes of production, finance and exchange are only partly replaced by new devices. The dictatorship of the proletariat which is a democracy to proletarians but a dictatorship to the bourgeoisie, is established. Next comes socialism or the first phase of

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47. *The Communist Manifesto*, *op. cit.*, p. 19.

48. Wilson, *op. cit.*, p. 331–332.

communism. The new institutions are strengthened, and new outlooks and values are working on human minds. But there are still lingering parts of bourgeois viewpoints and suspicion of sabotage or even revolt. Hence the dictatorship continues until the second phase of communism, or genuine communism, arrives with a new race of men with new ideas. Gone is the mastery of man over man, society pools its assets in labor, natural wealth, capital and science; plans the diverse needs of its members and apportions the resources among the many industries to insure an uninterrupted and rich flow of products for every want. Along with social production is social enjoyment of the income. After the necessary deductions for public purposes, the social storehouse is shared by all, not according to their contributions, but in the light of a principle which transcends the capitalistic idea of equitable distribution.

> "The government of persons," Engels says "is replaced by the administration of things, and by conduct of the processes of production. The state is not 'abolished'; it dies out."[49]

Because Marx did not discourse at length on the question, it is not certain if socialism occurs simultaneously with the proletarian victory over capitalism or with the gradual dissolution of capitalism under dictatorship. Nor is it certain the dictatorship of the proletariat is confined to the first stage or extends through the second stage; whether, that is, the bourgeois have completely disappeared in the socialist era and therefore, the state is extinguished, or if this occurs only in the final stage, complete communism.

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49. Bober, *op. cit.*, p. 268–277.

CHAPTER IV

Lenin the Applier and Stalin the Continuer

NEITHER MARX nor Engels had considered Russia as the proper site for their proletarian revolution because of its agrarian culture. Although Marx learned Russian because, as he told Engels [50] "one of us at least should know ...the languages...history...literature...and social institutions with which...we shall be...coming into conflict," and although a translation of *Das Kapital* into Russian had been printed in St. Petersburg, he never seems to have succeeded in deciding what he thought about Russia. But two years before his death in 1883, Marx replied to the Russian Marxist, Zasulich's question whether *Das Kapital* implied that agrarian Russia would be obliged to pass through all the stages of capitalist industrial exploitation before it could hope for revolution. Marx said in *Das Kapital* he meant that Western European countries would have to evolve through the capitalist exploitation and that he had spoken only of "private property based on individual labor" turning into capitalist private property—so that the primitive communal economy of an Eastern European country would not necessarily be meant.[51] In the foreword by Marx and Engels to the second translation of the *Communist Manifesto*, published in 1882, they said that the Western Revolution which could facilitate the development of a general collectivization in Russia might be set off by an uprising against the Tsar.

50. Wilson, *op. cit.*, p. 349.

51. *Ibid.*, p. 350.

In the meantime, the industrial development of Russia, though still far behind that of the Western countries, had been going ahead at a pace which made it seem unlikely that the Russians would be able to make a short cut straight from the peasant commune to the socialism of a mechanized society. In the twenty years between 1877 and 1897, the production of textiles doubled and the production of metals trebled; in the ten years between 1887 and 1897, the three hundred thousand textile workers doubled and the hundred thousand metal workers increased to a hundred and fifty thousand. The eighties had been a period of desperate strikes which had been repressed with the utmost brutality, but which had inspired some rudimentary industrial legislation such as factory inspection, abolition of child labor, and regular payment in cash of wages which had been dribbled out twice a year. Hence the Marxist view seemed realistic; it was the only theory which could make sense in the Russian situation. And its spokesman, Nikolai Lenin, endowed with a combative nature, a penchant for harsh and caustic criticism, a sparkling intellect and deep emotions combined with detachment, made deeply sympathetic to Marx.

Born in 1870 at Simbirsk on the Volga, Nikolai Lenin, whose real name was Vladimir Ilyitch Ulyanov, began his revolutionary activity when he still quite young in the same manner as his brother, Alexander, also a Marxist, who was hanged when Lenin was 17 years old, for plotting to kill the Tsar. Unlike Alexander, who was reserved, reflective and melancholy, Nikolai was energetic, aggressive, with the high cheekbones and slanting eyes of the Tartars of Astrakhan. After Alexander's execution he became hardened, reserved and unsociable. Nikolai studies the first volume of *Das Kapital* in the little extra room fitted up as a study and his sister, Anna, describes how;

> "sitting on the stove, which was strewn with the back numbers of newspapers, and making violent gesticulations, he would tell me with burning enthusiasm about the principles of Marxist theory and the new horizons it was opening to him. There emanated from him a cheerful faith that communicated itself to the people with whom he was talking."[52]

Lenin, in his speeches and writings, aimed always at accomplishing an immediate purpose. Even his longest and most ambitious work, The

52. *Ibid.*, p. 365.

Development of Capitalism in Russia, intended as a sort of supplement to Marx, has no literary, no purely intellectual, side as has *Das Kapital*. Lenin simply assembles the statistics and indicates the processes they represent. To appreciate fully the distinction of Lenin's intellectual equipment one had to hear him speak. Gorky tells us that Lenin's speeches always made upon him the impression of "the cold glitter of steel shavings," from which "there rose, with amazing simplicity, the perfectly fashioned figure of truth."[53] On the other hand his writing is impersonal, plain and hard-hitting with a gift for striking off his meaning in epithets and slogans that stick. But he is, in a sense, without intellectual curiosity, even in the field of Marxism, he is at no time very deeply interested in the fundamentals of Marxist thought. It is enough for him to feel that he has refuted a philosophical theory if he can produce a text from Marx or Engels that controverted it. That something has been "confirmed by Marx and Engels hundreds of times" is all the assurance he needs. Lenin believes firmly in the dialectic and teaches that our knowledge of the world is relative but is always approaching an absolute. This process is guaranteed by the progress of the dialectic. The dialectic is the "only conception that offers the key to the understanding of the 'self-movement' of everything in existence; it alone offers the key to the understanding of 'leaps' to the 'transformation' into the opposite, to the destruction of the old and the appearance of the new."[54] To Lenin the dialectic is vital, for just as the destructibility of the atom, its inexhaustibility, and the mutability of all forms of matter with the variation of its motion, so in the social sciences the dialectic is exemplified by the processes of the class struggle. He describes Marxism as a "solid block of steel" from which not even one basic assumption can be eliminated without forsaking objective truth.

As a critic of history, his Development of Capitalism in Russia differs from Marx in its limited applicability and emphasis on the Russian scene. As a politician he has none of the reservations of Marx and Engels who agreed "they must try to avoid becoming involved in the whirlpool of actual revolution because of its demoralizing effect on critical thinkers such as themselves." Lenin could not imagine losing anything worth-while

53. *Ibid.*, p. 385.

54. *Ibid.*, p. 387.

by becoming involved in action. His actions are based on an instinctive, unquestioning and irresistible reliance on Marxist doctrine to serve his purpose. His whole object is to build a party and whip it into shape. He sees and adopts his tactics without regard for theoretical positions then supports it with Marxist texts. Yet in all the ready shifting, the zigging and zagging, his single purpose was to create a revolution which would be not merely Russian but Marxist.

He first had to contend with a whole series of heresies; the Populists who insisted that the revolutionary potentialities of the peasantry was great. Lenin analyzed the improvements since the Emancipation and showed that the various strata could not be depended on to act in unison; the economists who advocated no political action but preferred to work exclusively in the economic field through trusting that the workers would reach socialism by themselves through a kind of Trade Unionism—Lenin called this movement a delusion and denied that the processes of history will automatically do the Marxist's work without his direct intervention; the Reformers and Opportunists who questioned Marx's credo because the parliamentary successes of the German Social Democratic Party had so strengthened the middle classes that Edward Bernstein advocated a higher standard of morality in co-operating with those regarded by Marxists as irreconcilable antagonists thus avoiding class violence and gradually benefiting society as a whole. Lenin denounced this damnable heresy as an attempt to bury Marx the fighter and quoted in "What is to be Done?" Kautsky's statement that, "the proletariat, left to itself, can never arrive at socialism, socialism must be brought from above... by bourgeois intelligentsia."[55]

Lenin's insistence on a tight group of highly disciplined revolutionaries to lead the proletariat brought about the Menshevik-Bolshevik split at the Second Congress of the Social Democrats in 1903 at Brussels. Lenin had contended that under a despotism like Russia's there could not be broad principles of democracy in the revolutionary party. The crisis occurred over a mere clause in the program for the party which Plekhanov and Lenin had prepared and to which Martov wanted to admit all the liberals who might think themselves in sympathy; Lenin insisted on restricting it

55. *Ibid.*, p. 395.

to persons who would work actively and submit to discipline. In a speech to the Congress Lenin said:[56]

> "The root of the mistakes made by those who are supporting Martov's formula lies in the fact that they not only ignore one of the main evils of our party life, but actually sanctify it. That evil lies in the fact that in an atmosphere of almost universal political discontent, in conditions which require complete secrecy in our work, in conditions where most of our activity is concentrated in narrow underground circles... it is to the last degree difficult, almost impossible, for us to distinguish talkers from workers."

In the vote that followed Lenin carried a majority for his program although he lost all but the toughest and most determined. His adherents were known thereafter as the Bolsheviki or members of the majority and his adversaries as the Mensheviki or members of the minority. But the victory of the majority was short-lived. The Central Committee, unlike the local committees which accepted Lenin's principles of party discipline, were afraid to lose such famous leaders as Martov and Plekhanov, and finally demoted Lenin and prohibited him from publishing anything without its consent. He resigned from the Central Committee and published, in defense of his position, *One Step Forward, Two Steps Back*, basing his role in the struggle on the dialectic. As he viewed it, the minority of Lenin's group before the Second Congress turned into the majority of the Bolsheviks, and subsequently the majority had turned into the minority thus negating the negation. But the true antithesis is the revolutionary, not the opportunistic wing of the party.

> "It would be criminal cowardice to doubt for a moment the inevitable and complete triumph of the principles of revolutionary Social Democracy proletarian organization and party discipline."[57]

After resigning from the Central Committee, Lenin returned to agitating and writing in Switzerland. Russia struggled in the throes of the war with Japan and the abortive revolution of 1905. This tremor reached its climax in the general strike at St. Petersburg and the nation-wide railroad strike which brought the country to a standstill. Soviets, consisting of

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56. *Ibid.*, p. 400.

57. *Ibid.*, p. 404.

thirty picked members of the revolutionary parties, were formed in various cities, with the St. Petersburg Soviet, where the Menshevik Trotsky was the most dynamic personality, assuming the revolutionary authority. However, the imperial manifesto of October 17 reconstituted the government and promised popular elections to the duma which would approve all new laws and grant full civil liberties to all. This shrewd device separated the liberal bourgeois from the vanguard of revolution and broke the tactical alliance of socialist groups which could no longer spearhead the bourgeois revolution. The end of the St. Petersburg Soviet came on December 5, at the barricades raised by Lenin (who had returned in haste) in the workers' quarters in Moscow. The suppression took an entire week and cost more than a thousand lives. It severed all links between the revolutionary parties and the liberals and signalled the restoration of law and order throughout Russia.

The First World War in 1914 brought an abrupt halt to the constructive achievements of the duma and reversed the tide of revolution which had been fast running out. At the outbreak of the war the peasant masses enjoyed equal civil rights and owned three-quarters of all the arable land in European Russia while the industrial workers also had made notable gains in wage levels, health and accident insurance and education.[58] The revolutionary parties seemed almost to have faded away. Their leaders, Social-Revolutionary and Social-Democrat alike, were in prison or Siberian exile or in exile abroad where they engaged in virulent controversy with one another. The most vicious factionalism was that inspired by Lenin. At a congress in Prague in 1912, Lenin conferred upon his Bolshevik following the title of the true, the only, the whole Russian Social-Democratic Party. But the military disasters of the War plus the economic strain following the enemy blockade brought political breakdown. Fuel was short and food shortages magnified the effect of inflation so that on March 8, 1917, strikes broke out everywhere in the country and the movement became irresistible. March 12th was the crucial day when two regiments of Guards in Petrograd came over to the side of the demonstrators, the arsenal was seized, weapons distributed, and prisons opened—it was revolution, elemental and unorganized.

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58. R. D. Charques, *A Short History of Russia*, (New York: E. P. Dutton and Company, 1956), p. 231–232.

Throughout the war Lenin had waited in impatience in Switzerland. He had taken a characteristic stand against the blood lust of imperialism, raging against the heathen socialist parties which supported their governments and urging all true Communists in belligerent countries to transform the war into civil war against their own government—revolution in any one country would be the signal for revolution elsewhere. So certain was Lenin of the portent of events in Russia that on the very eve of the revolution (1917) he wrote a pamphlet entitled "State and Revolution" in which the stated purpose was that "...of elucidating to the masses what they will have to do for their liberation from the yoke of capitalism in the very near future."[59] In describing the goals and stages of the Communist revolution, he relied entirely on a synthesis of the Marx-Engels text including Engels' Origins of the Family, Private Property and the State, Anti-Duhring and Marx's Poverty of Philosophy and the Manifesto of the Communist Party. By citations from these texts, Lenin developed the following familiar thesis. Before the Communist revolution, the state is to be understood as a simple apparatus for the suppression of the proletariat by the bourgeoisie. The function of the dictatorship of the proletariat is to smash the oppressive state apparatus; that is to say, the state will continue to exist as repressive force against the oppressors. Having fulfilled this function, it will cease to exist. Lenin in effect equated the dictatorship of the proletariat with the dictatorship of the party. There was no elaboration of the means required to move from a party coup d'etat to the broadly shared "democratic" proletarian dictatorship. Nor was there any description of the move from the proletarian dictatorship to the ultimate equalitarian society. This peculiar blind spot in such a detailed plan on the eve of execution forecasts what was in Lenin's mind. As Leonard Schapiro, in *The Origin of the Communist Autocracy* points out:[60]

> "It was Lenin who at the Tenth Congress in 1921 made the fateful decision of proposing the outlawry of factions which laid the basis for the ultimate rule by the one man who, thru control of the party, could ensure both a majority at the top and obedience to central orders throughout the country. In so doing, Lenin missed the chance of burying past enmities and of

59. N. Lenin, *State and Revolution*, (New York: International Publishers, 1932), p. 6.

60. Leonard Schapiro, *The Origin of the Communist Autocracy*, (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1955).

> carrying the vast majority of the country with him in an attempt to build up ruined Russia on the basis of co-operation and legal order, and not of the dictatorship of unpopular minority."

Thus the failure to legalize opposition sounded the death knell of proletarian democracy in the U.S.S.R.

The news from Russia in March 1917 worked like a fever upon Lenin and since there was no other way to enter Russia, the Germans provided a sealed train which bore him and 30 other revolutionaries through Germany, as unknown but evidently dangerous agitators who might aid the German cause there. Even before Lenin's arrival the dilemma of the provisional government was apparent. Consisting of predominantly Mensheviks and Socialist-Revolutionaries with a mere handful of Bolsheviks, the government knew that the deep longing of the Russian people for peace could not be obtained by capitulation and occupation by Germany. Yet in continuing the war in the midst of revolution, how could the provisional government re-establish order, restore the shattered economy and satisfy the immediate demands of the revolutionary masses?

When Lenin arrived at the Finland station in Petrograd on April 16, 1917, he had been preceded by Stalin and followed by Trotsky. He had come, he said, to bring not unity but division, not the tactical support of bourgeois revolution, but the immediate promise of proletarian revolution. Until Lenin's arrival socialists of every brand had supposed that the second stage of revolution was still distant, and that a coalition of forces to aid the first stage was essential. Instead, Lenin insisted on the breakup of the provisional government and transfer of power to the Soviets. The goal he announced was "Peace, Bread and Freedom" to be gained by giving all power to the Soviets. The first objective was addressed to the army, the second to the peasants and the third to the class-conscious industrial proletariat and all three were addressed to the country at large. This truly revolutionary program did not at once win acceptance, but the force of Lenin's will and argument prevailed and from the moment his strategy of war against the provisional government had been endorsed, the drama of 1917 unfolded at dizzy speed. The Bolsheviks seizure of power by diverting to their own ends the mass impulse of revolution whose roots stretched deep into Russian history can in no measure be said to follow the Marxist theory. Marx had predicted the establishment of a broad industrial base

in which conflicts would give rise to proletarian revolution and eventual socialism. But in Russia the proletarian revolution had come first and the industrial base on which to build socialism had still to follow. Lenin thus imposed on Russia a form of Marxism turned upside down, a peculiarly Russian brand of communism known as Marxism-Leninism. It was a revolution "from above" which denied the basic concept of political liberty implied in the *Communist Manifesto*, "to raise the proletariat to the position of the ruling class, to win the *battle of democracy*"[61] It did not assume that character at once but while Lenin and his followers represented a minority of extremists, Bolshevism was carried to victory on the tide of a revolution from below. A month after the seizure of power a second congress of Soviets of peasants' deputies, overwhelmingly Socialist-Revolutionary in character, united with the earlier congress of November 7, 1917 in demanding representation in the central executive committee. Six weeks later the long deferred constituent assembly met and while the Bolsheviks captured only 175 seats out of 707, Lenin's plans had been well laid. When the constituent assembly met the following day, the members were removed by the Bolshevik guards and the assembly dissolved. In the Bolshevik reckoning, there was no place in revolutionary Russia for parliamentary illusions. The secret of the Bolshevik's success lay in the all pervading Communist Party which infiltrated with "cells" or "fractions" every unit of the machinery of state and society, so that all means of authority were closely interlocked with the party. Just as Lenin had outlined in his "State and Revolution" the dictatorship of the party took precedence over the proletariat.

In grappling with the problem of bringing the imperialist war to an end, the Bolsheviks had proclaimed the right of self-determination of the border nationalities—Poles, Finns, Baltic peoples, Ukrainians, Transcaucasians all of whom had sought an armistice. Negotiations with the central powers opened in December at Brest Litovsk, where the German terms outraged even the Bolshevik sensibilities. Negotiations were suspended, Trotsky fell back upon the desperate expedient of "no peace, no war" and at the end of the armistice the German armies were ordered to advance. The danger of power slipping from his hands convinced Lenin certainly

61. *The Communist Manifesto*, *op. cit.*, p. 18.

that a social revolution in Germany was in sight, to argue the tactical necessity of accepting the German terms. These staggering terms were, among other complex and tangled causes, the principal basis for the civil war which followed. As described by one historian:[62]

> "Though admittedly it cost Russia fewer lives than the imperialist war, the Russian civil war was a chapter of unspeakable horror. It produced a chaos of competitive savagery on many fronts and inflicted a recurring ordeal of revenge and reprisals upon innocent sections of the population. Perhaps there were good reasons why this was so. The revolution itself, the product of ages of class antagonism, had been all but bloodless; only in an extremity of violence could the antagonism now find an outlet. The cruelty was in no way redeemed by the idealism on both sides which now and then shone through it and no romantic view of proletarian revolution can conceal the inhumanity of those years. The most hideous excesses occurred in the Ukraine, where Reds and Whites and anarchist peasant guerrillas met in almost purposeless cruelty and the Jewish population experienced mass pogroms."

By the time victory had been won, the Red Army created by Trotsky, Lenin's Commissar for War, was a formidable fighting force and the centralized apparatus of Bolshevik power was proof against all external shocks. But the Bolshevik Government faced unrelieved disaster on all sides due to the complete destruction of Russian economy. For the normal party member it seemed simple enough to proceed with the economic transformation of society through nationalization of banks, state monopoly on foreign trade, socialization of industry, eight-hour day and implementing the principle of workers' control. But Lenin had to introduce "war communism" with its ruthless system of confiscation, of universal labor, food priorities and suppression of a growing black market in an economy where money had lost all value. At this point, March 1921, no propagandist distortion could conceal the disenchantment with Bolshevik rule which the Kronstadt naval base mutiny exemplified. The mutiny was violently suppressed, and with it almost the last flicker of opposition to Communist dictatorship died out. But it alerted Lenin to the fact that the fruits of the October revolution were in jeopardy and hence he announced the New Economic Policy which permitted peasants to sell their surpluses and this

62. Charques, *op. cit.*, p. 254.

in turn revived private trade, industry and capital. The New Economic Policy demonstrated in fact a sudden reversion to capitalism and the usages of capitalist society. The immediate need was to increase the volume of production since the disastrous famine of 1922 caused the death of between four and five million people despite generous relief by American and other foreign agencies.

One of Lenin's significant accomplishments during the civil war was the formation in Moscow in March 1919, of the Communist International (Comintern) designed to assist the proletariat of all lands in the overthrow of world capitalism. While his faith in world revolution had so far failed him (he waited expectantly by the phone during the October revolution for word from Germany) yet he put his trust in the dialectic of history and the Comintern helped to sustain it. In discoursing on the feasibility of spreading the revolution through non-Communist organizations in capitalist countries, Lenin published his most vigorous work in 1920 entitled *Left-Wing Communism, An Infantile Disorder* wherein he demonstrates that the ends justify the means. Since this document has become the guide to tactics in all non-Communist countries it should be examined:[63]

> "The first months after the conquest of political power by the proletariat in Russia...might make it appear that the tremendous difference between backward Russia and the advanced countries of western Europe will cause the proletarian revolution in these latter countries to have very little resemblance to ours. Now we already have very considerable international experience which very definitely establishes the fact that some of the fundamental features of our revolution have a significance which is not local, not peculiarly national, not Russian only but international...
>
> "...But at the present historical moment the situation is precisely that the Russian model reveals to *all* countries something that is very essential in their near and inevitable future...
>
> "...The German 'Lefts' consider the reply to this question (Should Revolutionaries work in reactionary trade unions?) to be decidedly in the negative so far as they are concerned. In their opinion... it is unnecessary and impermissible for revolutionaries and Communists to work in yellow, social-chauvinist, compromising, counter-revolutionary trade unions...

63. N. Lenin, Left-Wing Communism, An Infantile Disorder, 80th Congress, 2d sess., Committee on Foreign Affairs, *The Strategy and Tactics of World Communism*, (Washington: U. S. Govt. Print. Off., 1948), pp. 34–65.

> "...These tactics are in fact fundamentally wrong ... In Russia...the dictatorship is exercised by the proletariat, which is organized in the Soviets and is led by the Communist Party...Not a single important political or organizational question is decided by any state institution in our republic without the guiding instructions of the Central Committee of the Party.
>
> "In its work the Party relies directly on the *trade unions*...which formally are *non-party*...Thus, on the whole, we have a formally non-Communist, flexible, relatively wide, and very powerful proletarian apparatus, by means of which the Party is closely linked up with the *class* and with the *masses*, and by means of which, under the leadership of the Party, the *dictatorship of the class is* effected...
>
> "...Capitalism inevitably leaves to Socialism a heritage of old trade and craft distinctions among the workers, distinctions created in the course of centuries; and it leaves trade unions which only very slowly and in the course of years can, and will, develop into broader, industrial unions... Later, these industrial unions will, in their turn, lead to the abolition of division of labour among people, to the education, training and preparation of people who will have *versatile development, and versatile* training, people who *will be able to do everything*. Communism is marching, must march, towards this goal; and it will *reach it* but only after very many years.
>
> "Surely the German Lefts cannot but know that the whole history of Bolshevism, both before and after the October Revolution, is *full* of instances of maneuvering, temporizing, and compromising with other parties, bourgeois parties included! ...
>
> "It is possible to conquer the more powerful enemy, only by exerting the utmost effort, and by *necessarily*, thoroughly, carefully, attentively and skillfully taking advantage of every, even the smallest 'fissure' among the enemies, of every antagonism of interest...by taking advantage of every, even the smallest opportunity of gaining a mass ally, even though this ally be temporary, vacillating...unreliable and conditional... Those who do not understand this fail to understand even a grain of Marxism...Our theory is not a dogma but a *guide to action*, said Marx and Engels..."

Lenin concluded his popular essay on the strategy and tactics of communism by admonishing his fellow revolutionaries to:[64]

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64. *Ibid.*, p. 63.

> "Let the bourgeoisie rave, work itself into a frenzy, overdo things, take vengeance on the Bolsheviks... Acting thus (they) act as all classes doomed by history have acted. Communists should know that *in all events the future belongs to them*."

In other words, since history is inevitably bringing the end of capitalism and the victory of communism we must help speed up the process by doing anything which will weaken capitalism.

There developed an ideological issue in the years before Lenin's death which raised serious question of how the future of the revolution was to be assured and by what practical stages was the transition to socialism to be made effective. On the one hand, the encircling enemy front of world capitalism was not yet broken; on the other, within Russia itself the growing class division in the villages threatened every principle of the socialist organization of society. The town or the country, more revolution, or less, world-wide socialism or socialism in a single country, (the U.S.S.R.) were in substance the questions. Two strong personalities, Trotsky and Stalin differed on both propositions which were to be decided in terms of applying Marxist doctrines to Soviet policy. In May 1922, Lenin suffered the first of the two seizures which disabled him from leadership. Stalin was appointed general secretary in recognition of his exceptional abilities as an organizer, but the appointment in no way was intended to distinguish him from the other members of the Politbureau, among whom after Lenin, Trotsky held first place. Yet within an astonishingly short time Stalin had won control of the party apparatus and although Lenin expressed his concern in his will for his "too crude" secretary, no action had been taken when Lenin died on January 21, 1924.

With Lenin's death the forms of democracy hitherto reserved for internal party debate crumbled. While leadership was shared by a triumvirate consisting of Stalin, Zinoviev and Kamenev, Stalin established personal supremacy in the party. Zinoviev and then Trotsky were expelled and a year later Kamenev's expulsion followed. The main dispute centered around Stalin's decision to proceed with the five-year plan for the transformation of the economy from agrarian to industrial. The goal laid down—to overtake and surpass, by her own unaided energies, the most advanced countries of the capitalist west—seemed fantastic; the means proposed—the regulated adjustment of every aspect of life to an over-all economic

plan—the height of megalomania. The methods adopted to enforce it went beyond the most despotic authoritarianism of Peter the Great and the fearful cost, because of faulty planning on the one hand and the army of unskilled peasant labor on the other, cannot be estimated either in lives or in human suffering. Stalin reduced notoriously low standards of living to the barest level of subsistence. The manufacture of consumer goods almost ceased and with the shift of heavy industry eastward for strategic reasons, men and women worked, starved and froze in the vast new factory encampments beyond the Urals. Labor discipline was maintained by stringent penalties because the drive was merciless and the pace killing. The five-year plan, formally begun in October, 1928, was completed in four years, despite the pessimism of most observers, including an American businessman who said:[65]

> "Not only do (the Russians) ignore the lack of training of the workers, but they overlook the time factor. Time is the essence of social change. A skyscraper could not be erected in a month, regardless of how many workers were employed. The greater the haste the greater the waste. The Russians think of social change in terms of years of a man's life rather than of generations of a nation's history. 'The Five-Year Plan in Fifty' is probably a truer statement of the prospects than 'The Five-Year Plan in Four.' "

The basic tasks of socialist construction were achieved then by the blood, toil and tears of peasant labor diverted to industry but that was not the end. The vast reserves of unskilled labor for sinking new mines, erection of blast furnaces and steel mills, and the digging of canals required collectivization of agriculture. To overcome the "political backwardness" of the peasants the class war was renewed by the order to liquidate the kulaks as a class. The horrors of collectivization accompanying this second and much greater Bolshevik revolution, which was waged with implacable cruelty and resisted with the extremes of desperation were unbelievable. The Kulaks—and not them only but millions of peasants who owned a couple of horses or cows—were wiped out as a class. Since they killed their stock rather than see them fall into the hands of the Bolsheviki, there resulted a "man-made" famine causing millions of deaths from starvation and an irreparable blow on Russian agriculture for two decades afterward.

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65. Elisha M. Friedman, *Russia in Transition*, (New York: The Viking Press, 1932), p. 14.

We could go on to the melodrama of the Moscow treason trials of the 1930's when the entire Bolshevik Old Guard was liquidated—but let Khrushchev tell us in his Report to the 20th Congress:[66]

> "You will recall V. I. Lenin's fight with the Socialist Revolutionary organizers of the anti-Soviet uprising with the counterrevolutionary kulaks in 1918 and with others, when Lenin without hesitation used the most extreme measures...
>
> "Stalin, on the other hand, used extreme methods and mass repressions at a time when the Revolution was already victorious, when the Soviet state was strengthened, when the exploiting classes were already liquidated and socialist relations were rooted solidly in all phases of national economy..."

Note that the complaint by the new rulers of Russia include only Stalin's crimes against his Communist associates whereas the infinitely greater crimes of both Lenin and Stalin against the Russian people were applauded in the name of "socialist construction."

In brief, the socialist state established by Lenin in Russia in the October revolution and continued by Stalin completely discredited Marxian dialectic. If Marx was right, the political structure established by Lenin in Russia must be the reflection of economic conditions existing at the time of the October revolution. This was not the case and as Max Eastman says:[67] "Never did a reflection put forth such gigantic efforts to produce its likeness in the object reflected." Marx also predicted that after victorious revolution and establishment of the dictatorship of the proletariat the state would eventually wither away but the dictatorship of the proletariat became state capitalism under Stalin. As described by Trotsky:[68]

> "The realities of Soviet life today can indeed be hardly reconciled even with the shreds of old theory. Workers are bound to the factories, peasants are bound to the collective farms... The freedom of movement has been completely restricted... The frontiers are guarded by an impenetrable wall... The gist of the Soviet constitution, the 'most Democratic in the world,' amounts to this, that every citizen is required at an appointed time to

66. Nikita S. Khrushchev, "The Crimes of the Stalin Era," (New York: *The New Leader*, 1956), p. 817.

67. Jack B. Tenney, *Red Fascism*, (Los Angeles, Calif.: Federal Printing Company, 1947), p. 47.

68. *Ibid.*, p. 48.

> cast his ballot for the one and only candidate hand-picked by Stalin or his agents. The press, the radio, all the organs of propaganda, agitation and national education are completely in the hands of the ruling clique... undoubtedly hundreds of thousands of party members have shared the fate of millions of non-party people. It would be extremely difficult to instill in the minds of these millions, their families, relatives and friends, the idea that the Stalinist state is withering away. It is strangling others, but gives no sign of withering. It has instead arrived at a pitch of wild intensity unprecedented in the history of mankind."

But Stalin had an answer to that criticism, first admitting that certain of the general propositions in the Marxist doctrine of the state were incompletely worked out and inadequate, by quoting Lenin:[69]

> "We do not regard Marxist theory as something completed and inviolable... We think that an *independent* elaboration of the Marxist theory is especially essential for Russian Socialists, for this theory provides only general *guiding* principles, which, *in particular*, are applied in England differently from France, etc..." he gave the answer:
>
> "Yes, the state will wither away IF we assume that Socialism is already victorious in all countries...that there is no more danger of foreign attack, and there is no more need to strengthen the army and the state."[70]

Compared to Lenin's reign of less than seven years, Stalin ruled for twenty-six years continuing Lenin's role as correct interpreter of history in Marxist terms. Although Stalin's solutions to the problems he faced have a highly eclectic character, as Dr. Moore says:

> "His borrowings were all drafts upon the treasury of Marxist intellectual tradition...They were variants upon a single theme..."

Three principal developments occurred under Stalin which are gravely significant. The first was the virtual deification of Stalin in his own lifetime and the elaboration of a definite cult for his worship and praise. It reflected a further shift from Lenin's Party rule which itself was removed from Marx's rule of the proletariat to the absolute rule of a single will. Education

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69. Josef Stalin, Some Questions of Theory, 80th Congress, 2d sess., Committee on Foreign Affairs, *The Strategy and Tactics of World Communism*, (Washington: U. S. Govt. Print. Off., 1948), p. 154.

70. *Ibid.*, p. 154.

was aimed not at the communication of truth but to the glorification of communism and Stalin. *Pravda*, the official newspaper of the Communist Party in Russia published (23/5/35) this hymn to Stalin by Ayak Bergen:[71]

> "He commands the sun of the enemies to set. He spoke, and the East for friends became a great glow. Should he say that coal turn white, It will be as Stalin wills... The master of the entire world - remember - is now Stalin."

The second development was the increased emphasis placed on creating class struggles in the international arena to further the dream of a single world order, consisting of interlocked, interdependent Socialist Republics in every region of the globe, all Communist in bent and direction, all looking to the Kremlin as the fountainhead of truth and power, all marching together to the final goal of universal peace and classless brotherhood.

The third development was the revival of Russian nationalism and imperialism. Russia is now in a position to become in time, if things go well with the basic plan of ever greater industrialization and productivity, the richest and most favored nation in the world. But to those observers who believe that nationalism is the real essence of Soviet communism, Dr. Charles W. Lowry repeats the theme of this paper:[72]

> "Nationalism is a dynamic force; it may become virtually a religion. It is an important factor in the new Russia. But it is insufficient to account for either Soviet psychology or behavior. Just as racialism was the really demonic element in German National Socialism, so Marxism *with its Messianic exaltation of the proletariat and its* faith in history *remains the heart and nerve center of Soviet expansionism*." (underscoring supplied) (Italics-Lowry's)

71. Sheen, *op. cit.*, p. 154.

72. Charles W. Lowry, *Communism and Christ*, (New York: Morehouse-Gorham Company, 1953), p. 33.

CHAPTER V

Evaluation of the Materialistic Conception of History

"Marxism has derived an enormous accretion of strength from the belief that the realization of its predictions is historically inevitable. To have history on one's side is the modern equivalent of being on the side of the angels."

Guide to Philosophies of History

Man's history has largely disappeared from memory. Only through investigation and research does it become accessible—and then only to a small extent. The long obscurity of prehistory, the foundation of all that follows, is scarcely pierced by the dim light which we can cast upon it. Between a prehistory hundreds of times as long as an immeasurable future lie the six thousand years of history visible to us, a minute fraction of the unpredictable duration of man's life on earth. This history is open towards prehistory as well as towards the future which is undecided, a boundless realm of possibilities.

In his attempt to reconstruct the past, the historian is confronted with a mass of materials with which he must somehow come to terms. He cannot simply reproduce these materials in all their chaos and confusion but through selection, arrangement and generalization, he must discern some order within them. To do so requires a series of choices, conscious or unconscious, which impart, the subjective element into any historian's analysis and synthesis. Although some historians, such as Ranke and Schlosser,

tried to "banish themselves from their books" the historian cannot escape himself and his prepossessions in interpreting a multitude of facts of history. Even if a time machine could carry the historian back through the past at will, he would confront, on stepping off the machine, the very problems of interpretation he thought he had left behind. Hence, theories of interpretations are dependent on the needs and values of the age which produces them.

In the most primitive stages, historical interpretation was characterized by the myth-making compulsions of the early tribes. In the Middle Ages, under the influence of Augustine's *De Civitate Dei*, history served to record the process of revelation running through the whole course of history, from the creation of the world and fall of man to the end of the world and last judgment. Over the last thousand years successive theories of interpretation have reflected the quickening pace of social and intellectual change. The Enlightenment separated history from theology, encouraged the idea of the disinterested pursuit of knowledge as an end in itself, and developed techniques for the critical use of historical materials. It thus established the study of the past for its own sake as an independent field. The results of these years of historical meditation and scholarship, epitomized by Hegel in his philosophy of history and by Ranke in the realm of historical practice, laid the foundations for modern historical theory. According to the *Harvard Guide to American History* there have developed, since Hegel and Ranke, six methods of historical interpretation:[73]

> "1. Interpretations assuming a plurality of separate civilizations and dealing with the reasons for their cyclical rise and decline, such as those of Toynbee and Spengler;
>
> "2. Interpretations setting forth, in systematic rules, the general principles of continuous historical change applicable to all civilizations such as those of Hegel and Marx;
>
> "3. Interpretations which emphasize neglected factors in historical development of a civilization, without claiming that those factors explain its whole development;
>
> "4. Interpretations which deny the need for interpretation, asserting that objectivity is an attainable ideal, that the facts 'speak for themselves' and

73. Oscar Handlin, *Harvard Guide to American History*, (Cambridge, Mass.: The Belknap Press, 1954), pp. 15–16.

that history is ultimately 'scientific' (Ranke, though not a member of this school, was its hero);

"5. Interpretations...which assert that objectivity is an unattainable ideal and rest on the frank belief that all history is contemporary history;

"6. Interpretations which concede that perfect objectivity is unattainable but remain hostile to rigid or dogmatic historical theories."

The Harvard Study proceeds to discuss the essence of each theory of interpretation and the progressive refinements which succeeding theories brought to its predecessors. The first type, universal cyclical histories, were discarded because they were not useful for detailed historical inquiry. The second type with which we are primarily concerned—systematic doctrines of continuous historical change—are analyzed at great length because of their profound influence on the writing of American history. Hegel's idea that the historian must not only record the events but by penetrating through the events to the ideas behind them, establish a higher logic of history, had a broad and deep impact on American theories of historical interpretation. In later decades, however, the idealistic conception of history lost its influence, partly because it did not prove an especially usable instrument for the investigation of concrete episodes, partly because it omitted or obscured essential social changes. Karl Marx, by inverting the Hegelian system, revived and strengthened the dialectic making it the engine of a materialistic rather than an idealistic interpretation. As we have seen, for Marx the dialectical process finally reduced the warring classes in society to two—the bourgeoisie and the proletariat, and prophesized the triumph of the working class in a classless society. By providing a systematic formulation of the economic interpretation of history and by charging that formulation with Messianic zeal, Marx made it increasingly difficult for historians to ignore the role of economic factors.

Nevertheless, the American historian's preoccupation with concrete and practical events became hostile to monolithic theories, tending to convert dogmatic interpretations of historical change into partial and provisional ones. In turn pragmatism was overtaken by "scientific history" which conceived itself capable of an objectivity which, like laboratory experiments ultimately leading to scientific generalizations, would guarantee historical generalizations with certainty. But "scientific history" rested on a false analogy with science, for while the adoption of a hypothesis might be a neutral act with the scientist, when assumptions were made

by historians, the Pandora's box of subjectivism which had been scientific history's aim to shut, flew open. The resulting dilemma between scientific positivism and naive relativism of complete subjectivity was resolved by the pragmatic instinct of our current American theory which agrees with the relativists that interpretation is inescapable and with the scientific historians that objectivity, even if unattainable must be the ideal. The result is today's method of subjecting all single-valued or dogmatic theories of history to the perpetual countercheck of facts. In fine, interpretations which can hold in suspension the largest number of diverse facts are those most likely to do justice to the interpretation of a complex past which can never be fully recovered. Above all, in the judgment of this pragmatic and pluralistic school, "theories of historical interpretation are to be used by men, and not men by theories."[74]

Hegel

Since Marx was greatly influenced by Hegel's use of the dialectic we must pause to evaluate it. The concept has been reduced by Professor Mayo to the following syllogism:[75]

"1. Ideas develop by the dialectical process;
"2. The external world is merely an embodiment of ideas;
"3. Therefore the external world develops dialectically."

With reference to the first premise, or major, while our ideas may develop, become more comprehensive, they do so at times without dialectical debate although one may say that truth is reached by stages through the constant pressure of criticism. But to Hegel, the dialectic was the self-movement of ideas according to a fixed triadic pattern, ever spiraling upward; this is something more than compromise, criticism or development by stages. The theory that some driving force inherent in contradiction itself gives ideas self-movement to generate their own opposites and synthesis is untrue since in practice we revise our ideas not because of any

74. *Ibid.*, p. 20.

75. H. B. Mayo, *Democracy and Marxism*, (New York: Oxford University Press, 1955), p. 11.

mysterious quality in them but because our minds are critically trying to avoid illogical meanings. Especially, do we change our ideas when they do not harmonize with experience and the facts. Most important, no necessary dialectical pattern brings ideas and facts into harmony or higher unity. It is not the dialectic which has given us our solid stock of knowledge about nature; it is the painstaking methods of laboratory science supplemented by mathematics and logical inference. Hegel replaced the principle of the old logic:

"Everything is identical with itself, nothing contradicts itself"

by the new principle:

"Nothing is identical with itself and everything contradicts itself."

Now examine the second premise of Hegel's syllogism: that the external world is a mere embodiment of ideas. This is pure assumption without the slightest shred of evidence in its favor. It follows that if the major and minor of the syllogism are invalid, then the conclusion that the external world is dialectical is without foundation. To say that we need not examine the external world by careful methods of science to obtain accurate information about it; that a mere mental exercise in dialectics will provide the answer is ridiculous. So were some of Hegel's conclusions derived in this manner. For instance, by the dialectic Hegel "proved" that there were seven planets, four elements and three continents. His predictions included the organic theory of the State with its own personality and higher morality, in which war is glorified, freedom of thought is both perverse and subversive and the citizens' chief virtue is obedience.

In the field of mathematics it has not been difficult for critics of Engels—who took some of his examples of the dialectic straight from Hegel's logic—to show that he strains the truth when he asserts that the "negation of the negation" can be demonstrated by the fact that the negation of the negation of "a" was "$+a^2$." Actually the negation of -a is not a^2, but a; and if you want to get a^2, you do not have to negate at all: you can simply multiply a plus by a plus. Although Engels did admit that one has to construct the first negative so that the second remains or becomes possible, it is clear that the dialectical materialist has always to provide his own conditions in order to arrive at dialectical results. What then becomes of his claim that the dialectic is inherent in all the processes of nature?

Dr. Einstein, the discoverer of the Theory of Relativity, has gone on record that the writings of Engels did not have "any special interest either from the point of view of present-day Physics or from that of the history of Physics."[76] In another case often cited by adherents to the dialectic, the Freudian theory of repressed desires, the dialectical cycle is certainly far from inevitable. The instinct is the thesis; the repression is the antithesis; the sublimation is the synthesis: good! But suppose the patient goes insane instead of being able to sublimate; suppose he kills himself. Where is the reconciliation of opposites in the synthesis. Where is the progression from the lower to the higher?

Neither as a method of proof for what is already known nor as a method of investigating reality to find new truth will the Hegelian dialectic stand scrutiny.

Karl Marx

While there is little dispute as to the value of the dialectic, there has been violent disagreement as to the importance and value of Marx's materialistic conception of history. Professor Carr in evaluating the significance of Soviet experience for western civilization wrote:[77]

> "Marx, for all his belief in the historical process and in the scientific quality of his predictions, made no pretense of being neutral... Though the victory of the proletariat was scientifically inevitable, Marx implicitly encouraged men to work for it on the ground that it was morally right. The moral undertones, which are never far beneath the surface on Marx, became overtones in the current Soviet ideology. The change is significant for the evolution of Bolshevism from a destructive and revolutionary force into a positive and constructive force... The absolute value which Marxist and Soviet ideology have to offer and to which all else is subordinated is the emancipation of the proletariat, the establishment of its supremacy at the expense of other classes and the ultimate attainment of classless society...It is a stroke of insight which enabled Marx to perceive that the industrial worker...was the characteristic 'proletarian' of the industrial age, and must

76. Wilson, *op. cit.*, p. 192.

77. Edward H. Carr, *The Soviet Impact on the Western World*, (New York: The Macmillan Company, 1949), pp. 95–96.

> be the...hero of the next revolution... The contemporary western ideology of the 'common man'...owes its revival and current popularity largely to the impact of Marxism and of the Soviet Union."

In similar vein, Max Lerner, while recognizing that the Marxian theory of history implies the whole of the Marxian sociology, including basically its economic theory, its theory of social classes, and theory of the state, chose to evaluate the materialist interpretation of history as based on the assumption that history has a rationale and a sequence and is not merely whimsical:[78]

> "In Marxian terminology, the conditions of production determine the relations of production. They determine the class structure of a society—in short, its social order... One of the charges that has been most persistently made against the materialist theory of history is the charge that it somehow degrades the human spirit because it irons free will out of the scheme of things and lets necessity reign alone. Scrupulously examined, the charge is absurd. The great value of the materialist theory is that it sets the framework within which human effort CAN be effective.
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> "Its whole emphasis is that men do make their history. But with three necessary qualifications. It is not the great men who make it, as part of the accident of their genius, but whole classes of men under the leadership of great men, and as a consequence of their class position...Second, men's efforts are exercised not arbitrarily... but within the limits set by the changes in the material conditions of life...Third, and this is related to the preceding, the materialist interpretation is therefore no philosophy of voluntarism... the will can be socially effective only when it flows with rather than against the stream of history...There is room for *change and contingency* within the framework...To hold that they play no part in history would be to hold to a fatalistic mechanism by which everything that happened was predetermined from the very beginning. obviously this is not so.
>
> "How valid is such a theory of history? ... A theory of history is valid not in any absolute sense but if it serves as a useful instrument for clarifying and illuminating the processes and events of history... (if) it is a useable theory of history... I think it can safely be said that, at least for the history of the western world since the Greek city-states, the materialist theory has been the most useable theory we have discovered thus far... none of the principal schools of historical theory that have developed... has shown itself

78. Lerner, *op. cit.*, pp. 396–405.

> to be as useable in its approach to the problems that agitate us today, ... none explains as well the forces that have led us into the present state of our culture and social organization, and none indicates as well the lines of future development... By projecting the lines of force from the past into the future, it gives a basis for prediction which, while never infallible or exact, nevertheless furnishes a starting-point for action."

Finally, Robert Heilbroner, in evaluating the lives, times and ideas of great economic thinkers describes the *Communist Manifesto* as "a philosophy of history in which a Communist revolution was not only desirable but demonstrably inevitable" and assigns it a secure place "in the great line of economic viewpoints which have successively clarified, illuminated and interpreted the world for us."[79]

Despite the foregoing favorable comments on Marx's materialist conception of history it can be elucidated that it is principally his method which is applauded. Before proceeding to a review of those historians who condemn the dogmatic, deterministic theory of history it would be useful to subject his theory to "the perpetual countercheck of facts" recommended by the Harvard Study. At the outset it must be admitted that for one to criticize a theory of history which touches on every phase of human knowledge including anthropology, biology, economics, history, sociology, psychology, philosophy, literature and art, including the nature of forces that determine the progress of civilization, he would have to be omniscient. Since the writer is an expert in none of these fields only a few obvious criticisms are offered. In all humility it must be said that fairly persistent research uncovered only two treatises on Marx's materialist conception of history, namely, Mandel Bober's *Karl Marx's Interpretation of History*, awarded the David A. Wells Prize for the year 1925–26, and H. B. Mayo's *Democracy and Marxism*. There are innumerable critical analyses of Marx's philosophy, his sociology, his economics, even his religio-scientific nuances, but like the six blind men who variously described the elephant as a snake, wall and pillar, etc., because they touched only its trunk, side and leg, a study of segments of the whole materialist conception of history tend to leave the impression that this or that portion is crucial and if it falls the whole structure collapses. This is almost Marxian in its simplicity and quite foreign to American historical practice such

79. Heilbroner, *op. cit.*, p. 129–131.

as exemplified in Robert E. Brown's analysis of *Charles Beard and the Constitution* wherein the evaluator retraced the ground covered by Beard on an almost line-by-line and footnote-by-footnote basis.[80] This systematic appraisal of the Marxist version of history has been lacking amid a plethora of histories of mankind such as Arnold Toynbee's *A Study of History*. The concomitant need for a valid theory of society is acutely recognized by Professor W. W. Rostow in probing into the propensities of interacting relationships as they affect economic growth, when he wrote:[81]

> "Economic determinism is avoided by the complex nature of the forces...setting in motion a sustained economic process, by the recognition of the power in the value systems and the institutions of a society, quite apart from the current techniques of production and composition of the working force...It does not follow that the Industrial Revolution, having been accepted by societies of different very long-run heritage, has destroyed or even dominated that heritage and yielded societies of identical social structure, value systems, institutions or propensities. Thus the Marxist analysis is not a valid theory of society but simply furnishes a part of the mechanism for a theory of society. *Such a theory does not now exist*. We know enough to assert with confidence, however, that it must exhibit, at least, the following two characteristics: it must take account of the multiple motivations of human beings; and it must be a theory, dynamically interacting over time, in which economic forces at once help determine other aspects of the society and are partially determined by them." (underscoring supplied)

When the vast panorama of history and the immense realm of social developments are the object of inquiry the historian undertakes a synthesis of overpowering dimensions and awe-inspiring complexity. However, once the attack is mounted the task must be reduced in scale and simplified in conception. One or two factors will be selected to bear the burden of explaining inaccessible details; deceptive plausibilities will be treated as objective certainties and opaque generalizations, supported by little more than vague intuitions, will follow one another. Marx did not escape this fate. He made institutions, ideas, and values little more than the tail of

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80. Robert E. Brown, *Charles Beard and the Constitution*, (Princeton, N. J.: Princeton University Press, 1956), as reviewed by Harold C. Syrett, *Political Science Quarterly*, (December 1956), pp. 608–609.

81. W. W. Rostow, *The Process of Economic Growth*, (New York: W. W. Norton & Company, 1952), p. 54.

the economic dog and left out baffling phases of human nature while abstracting from the multi-sided factors which come into play in historical processes. If the experts who approve his method of approach mean that Marx provided a working hypothesis in postulating the system of production and the class structure as the "be all and end all" of phenomena, the question logically follows, would it not throw more light if it explored as well such areas as politics, religion, science, literature and leading personalities? One example from recent history proves the inadequacy of focussing upon one factor in causation. In our lifetime we have seen the emergence of communism in Russia and of fascism, short-lived, in Germany and Italy. The startling fact is that the modes of production in these three countries, as well as in capitalist America and England, are essentially alike. Except for some being more advanced than others, these countries use the same machines, factories, large-scale operations and engineers, i.e., the same modes of production. Yet Marx's fundamental thesis asserts that the same mode of production is correlated with the same institutional arrangement. Did these countries with similar economic bases exhibit identical governmental institutions, ideas, laws, religions or patterns of behavior. Obviously not.

But let us, with Mandel Bober go back to the beginning. Marx and Engels claim that institutions owe their first beginnings to the primitive mode of production but even today treatises on anthropology offer varieties of hypotheses. What happened ten thousand years ago cannot be recaptured, and definite conclusions are therefore out of the question. Since Marx and Engels were no anthropologists, their idea of the economic origin of institutions must have been based on a priori deductions from the truism that man must eat before he can become philosophical. But to inject a necessary condition into an all-inclusive cause is not the scientific method of building the cornerstone to a social philosophy. To write a book, one needs paper, pen, and ink; but paper, pen and ink do not explain what is in the book. Because Marx and Engels refused to stress adequately the non-economic factors attendant on a mode of production, they falter in explaining the transition of modes of production into one another. There is no reason, for instance, for the emergence of incurable contradictions and class strife in a primitive communal society. How people living under communism happen to come upon the concept of private property in the absence of other evidence, and why they go to the extreme of slavery, is

not clear. Marxians attempt to explain the appearance of private property on the ground that the productive forces were too weak for communism to survive. But if developed productive forces are indispensable to the continuance of communism, one wonders how communism succeeded in arising in the first place, and at a time when the productive forces were still more primitive.

Marxists do not explain by what inherent processes a slave society grows into a feudal society. They introduce Deus ex Machinas such as wars and barbarian invasions but these are not the peculiar result of a slave system. Similarly, capitalism does not arrive without the aid of fortuitous happenings such as geographical discoveries, the exploitation of new colonies and discovery of metals. Without this outside causation, apparently the epoch of medieval feudalism would not inevitably disintegrate to pave the way to capitalism. In turn, capitalism is declared as the necessary preliminary to communism because of its function in sharpening the class conflicts but we saw how Marx advised Zasulich (p. 31) that under certain favorable conditions Russia might "escape" the capitalist epoch and proceed straightway to communism. These irregularities in the transition of economic epochs clash head on with basic tenets of Marx's theory of history, because a given mode of production is supposed to breed contradictions giving rise to a particular new mode. The contending classes of a society beget their ideas, interests and impulses from the realities in their social structure, and not from alien cultures unless the dialectic neglects its order of sequence and hops, skips and jumps all over the place. According to Bober,[82] the whole question of the linear succession of gens, slavery, feudalism, and capitalism is open to doubt. Anthropological investigations demonstrate that communism is not typical of primitive peoples, and that no one general rule can be laid down respecting primitive social organization. Regarding the transition from feudalism to capitalism, the evidence Marx himself presents, indicates that there is no close parallel between the decline of feudalism and the expected decline of capitalism. In feudalism we have a realistic picture of the bourgeois class growing in numbers, power and confidence, feeling itself hampered by the old order, and overthrowing the social, legislative barriers which stood in its way,

82. Bober, *op. cit.*, p. 329.

until by the Nineteenth Century, it had become the dominant class. On the other hand, capitalism's proletariat grows more numerous but weaker and more poverty stricken yet we are asked to believe that somehow this depressed class is to become revolutionary, and sufficiently strong to overthrow all the machinery of the law and the state. Obviously, the dialectic and the class struggle are not working the same way in the two cases.

The brief review of Marx's basic outline of history is a mere preamble to his wider view of history which predicts the overthrow of capitalism, wherein the dialectic in its purest form, two hostile camps—bourgeois and proletariat—rigidly evolves from thesis and antithesis to synthesis; the eventual overthrow of the bourgeoisie and the victory of the proletariat. The facts show, however, that capitalist society has become less polarized into classes; in England and elsewhere.

It is true that handicraft industries, small-scale manufacturing and peasant farming have declined in Western countries with the spread of modern technology. More important, the rise of a new 'petty bourgeoisie' of white-collar workers in the ever-expanding service industries, professions, technical trades, civil service, and so forth, combined with the declining numbers of unskilled workers provide irrefutable arguments against Marx's theory of polarization. Today the structure of society is less and less on a 'class' basis; there is great fluidity, and circulation of people in and out of occupational groups, so that even Marx would have difficulty in drawing any sharp class distinctions. The revolutionary class struggle, far from being a characteristic feature of the advanced industrialised countries, with their rising productivity, social services, piece-meal social and economic planning, is rarely observable in these countries and on the contrary usually makes its appearance in less well-developed areas, where there are no large middle classes to give stability to the social structure.

There were other predictions which failed to materialize. In 1848 Marx predicted a revolution with each war and each economic crisis which were to become progressively more severe. Two revolutions have occurred, one in Russia during World War I and one in China after World War II, but in each case they were engineered by a tightly knit, well-disciplined group of revolutionaries from above, not as foreseen by Marx, from below. Despite the prolonged depression of the 1930's there has been no trend of successive crises during the past century. His forecasts of displacement of men by machines and expansion of the idle labor reserve have become instead

a growing working population and greater employment. Poorer working conditions induced by the greed of capitalists have also failed to materialize and the trend of improvement in working conditions shows no sign of faltering. Similarly, the picture of increased oppressiveness of the capitalist state over the masses is replaced by one of the rising power, leadership and dignity of the workers. So much so that a former Communist, Max Eastman, advised organized labor in the United States.[83]

> "Don't kill the goose that lays the golden eggs. Capitalism is something of a goose from the standpoint of abstract reason and the ideal of perfection... But she's the only creature on this earth that ever laid golden eggs, and in my humble but mature opinion she's the only one that ever will..."

It is obvious then that in the United States, particularly, capitalism has evolved untouched by the dead hand of aristocratic lineage and age-old class attitudes. We have faced up to the economic problems of capitalism with social attitudes that sprung a less hardened heritage: attitudes of experiment and adaptation, a healthy disrespect for too much power, public or private, and a social flexibility that has prevented the development of brittle and die-hard class structures. This flexibility is apparent in the challenge and response to the one prediction of Marx' that seems to be substantiated, increasing monopoly. Economists were alarmed when the year 1932 saw one half of all corporate enterprise in the hands of two hundred companies.[84] Worse yet, at the rate at which the two hundred giants were growing, compared with the three million pigmies which made up the rest of American enterprise, by 1950 they would control three-quarters of the nations incorporated wealth and by 1975 they could, like the feudal principalities which once ran the economic life of Europe, rule the economic life of the United States. These fears were not entirely groundless for in 1950 the two hundred and fifty biggest corporations did turn out goods equal in value to the entire output of the economy before the war. But competition was not dead for despite the growth of giant corporations they did not control three-quarters of the economy. Instead, a million new businesses had entered the field, and the trend to domination of the

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83. Max Eastman, "The 'Flop' of a Century," *U. S. News & World Report*, (1 April 1955), p. 128.

84. Heilbroner, *op. cit.*, p. 234.

giants had to be measured in decimal points. While the big companies grew bigger, the economy grew bigger as well; consequently, as long as the economy as a whole is expanding, there is room for big industry to grow without crowding out the rest of business. Besides, a degree of monopoly, by sheltering the businessman from the pitiless pressures of the market, can allow him to improve the social advantages of his workers in contradiction to Marx's thesis that capital had to exploit labor if it was going to stay in business.

That Marx should not have foreseen this new social structure is understandable, actually as Heilbroner says:[85]

> "The result has been a Marxist impossibility. Here is a capitalist government that actually prosecutes monopolies! Here is a nation in which almost no one thinks of himself as a proletarian; upper-class American has sometimes kicked its lower classes around, but it has not *despised* them. Here is a business community in which 'public relations' have come to be a paramount concern—in which, that is, business is engaged in explaining and justifying its place in society...It is in these attitudes that the answer to Marxian analysis lies. Marx was not so much 'wrong' in his economic vision as he was wrong in assuming that his psychological and sociological preconceptions were fixed and unalterable. The laws of motion which his model of capitalism revealed may still be visible in American capitalism...*but they are faced with a set of remedies which spring from social attitudes quite beyond his imagination*..." (Italics - Heilbroner; underscoring supplied)

Other Unitary Patterns of History

Confronted by the ageless inquiry of man into the mystery of his humanity, into the history that made him what he is and seeking answers to such questions as: Where does history come from? Where does it lead? What does it mean? Many historians have tried to make a unified over-all view of history. They studied the factual cycles of civilization and saw (with Hegel) in their development and decline the concept of a single pattern with all the diversities in their place. One such universal view of history is the concept of integrated cultures. These develop from mere primitive existence like organism, independent life-forms having a beginning

85. *Ibid.*, p. 159.

and an end, being of no concern to one another but capable of meeting and interfering with each other. Spengler recognized eight such historical organisms, Toynbee twenty-one. Spengler gave each a life-span of one thousand years, Toynbee an indefinite one. Both employ morphological explanations of growth and decay. While Spengler saw the need for a mysterious total process of youth, vigorous middle age, senility and dissolution to be accomplished by any given culture-organism, Toynbee undertakes a multiple causal analysis from sociological points of view. Beyond that he finds room for the free decisions of individuals, but in such a way that the whole appears in the guise of a necessary process. Both make predictions for the future on the basis of their over-all concepts.[86]

Professor Toynbee

It has been said that all those who oppose historical materialism ought to welcome Toynbee's *Study of History*.[87] This view has been challenged by professional historians who identify in Toynbee's well-known rout-rally-rout view of history a dialectic materialism of precisely the same order as that of Marx, and based like Marx' on Hegelianism.[88] Nevertheless the opinion of such an eminent author of the most widely known work of contemporary history is informative, if not authoritative. In D. C. Somervell's abridgement of the *first* six volumes of *A Study of History*,[89] Toynbee claimed that even if communism were to spread over the face of the planet it would not mean the triumph of an alien culture, e.g., communism over capitalism, since communism, unlike Islam, is derived from a Western source, being a reaction from and a criticism of the Western Capitalism that it combats. He sees in the adoption of this Western doctrine as the revolutionary creed of modern Russia, not the signal that Western culture is in jeopardy, but its potency. In explaining that it was

86. Karl Jaspers, *The Origin and Goal of History*, (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1953), p. xiv.

87. Prof. O. Halecki, Book Review, *Toynbee and History*, *America*, June 30, 1956, p. 327.

88. Linus Walker, O. P. Toynbee and Religion, A Catholic View, an essay in Ashley Montagu's volume *Toynbee and History*, p. 338.

89. Arnold J. Toynbee, *A Study of History*, (London: Oxford University Press, 1947), Abridgement of Vol. I-VI by D. C. Somervell.

the negative and not the positive elements in the Marxian creed that made it congenial to a Russian revolutionary mind, Toynbee wrote:[90]

> "This is borne out by the metamorphosis which this Marxian philosophy appears to be undergoing in the Russian atmosphere, where we see Marxism being converted into an emotional and intellectual substitute for Orthodox Christianity, with Marx for its Moses and Lenin for its Messiah and their collected works for the scriptures of this new atheistic church militant. But the phenomena take on a different aspect when we turn our attention from faith to works and examine what Lenin and his successors have actually been doing to the Russian people.
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> "When we ask ourselves what is the significance of Stalin's Five Year Plan, we can only answer that it was an effort to mechanize peasants into a nation of mechanics, to transform the old Russia into a new America...The present rulers of Russia are working with demonic energy to ensure the triumph in Russia of the very civilization that they are denouncing in the world at large...In this tug of war which we are witnessing in Russia between the ideals of Lenin and the methods of Ford we may look forward to seeing the ascendancy of the Western over the Russian Civilization paradoxically confirmed."

Toynbee's view of history is universal, comprising all known ages and places on earth. His aim is to throw some light on the mysterious unfolding of human life through time-space. For him the smallest intelligible unit of history is a whole civilization, not a national state like England. Toynbee's key to the riddle of history is his hypothesis of challenge and response. According to this theory, the rise and fall of civilisations result from the successful or unsuccessful response of a society to a physical or moral challenge, usually physical, coming from the geographical environment. This is followed by Growth, in which material obstacles are overcome and there is progress in meeting spiritual challenges. Then Breakdown, which is caused by failure to meet a moral challenge and finally Disintegration. The last is characterized by three conflicting classes: a dominant minority, which establishes a universal state, like the Roman Empire; an internal proletariat; and external proletariat or barbarian war bands which attack the dying civilization from without. There is a rhythm of dissolution in a dying civilization, but he found that race and environment inadequate

90. *Ibid.*, p. 204.

explanations of the rise and fall of civilizations and Spengler's theory too rigid and deterministic. Although he does not claim to have discovered any absolute, universal laws of history, Toynbee does find some constant patterns according to which men freely work out their destiny. The most universal is challenge and response. In evaluating this philosophy of history, Father Walker states:[91]

> "Toynbee's challenge and response are closely related to Hegel's thesis and antithesis. He considers Hegel's account of creation an 'academic abstract of the living truth,' which 'makes nonsense of it' by reducing it to the purely logical process of the absolute intellect... Hegel's philosophy is pantheistic because the absolute spirit (Hegel's God) is in each and all things. It is idealistic because this evolutionary process is the purely logical workings of the absolute spirit! ...Toynbee, in asserting the reality of matter and spirit, drops the idealism of Hegel, and denies the pantheism, though he seems unable to avoid it entirely. He keeps the dialectic evolution but rejects the determinism of Hegel, for the will of man is free, being determinable by the infinite number of possible objects. All progress results from a static condition (a thesis in Hegelian terms) being challenged by some condition (antithesis). The resulting response gives genesis and growth (synthesis, becoming). Such was the beginning, for example, of the Egyptian Civilization, which resulted from a double challenge and response: 1) There was a static condition when primitive men lived in the grasslands of North Africa. Then there was a challenge when these lands became a desert at the end of the ice age. Men responded by moving. 2) Some moved to the Nile delta, were challenged again by the marshy land there and responded by draining it and founding a great civilization."

In his treatise on *Historical Inevitability*, Isaiah Berlin [92] argues against the doctrine of determinism according to which we are helplessly caught in the grip of a movement proceeding from all that has gone before, noting that:[93]

> "One of the deepest of human desires is to find a unitary pattern in which the whole of experience, past, present and future, actual, possible and unfulfilled, is symmetrically ordered. From the days of Herder and Saint-Simon, Hegel and Marx, to those of Toynbee and Spengler...claims have

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91. Linus Walker, O. P., *op. cit.*, p. 338–339.

92. Isaiah Berlin, *Historical Inevitability*, (London: Oxford University Press, 1954),

93. *Ibid.*, p. 69.

> been made...to be able to trace a structure of history (always a priori for all protests to the contrary), to discover the one and only true pattern into which alone all facts will be found to fit. But this is not, and never can be accepted by any serious historian who wishes to establish the truth as it is understood by the best critics of his time, working by the standards accepted as realistic by his most scrupulous and enlightened fellow workers."

In reappraising his analysis of the first six volumes upon the publication of the last four, another eminent historian, Pieter Geyl, Professor of Modern History in the University of Utrecht points out his earlier criticism is strengthened by careful analysis of the 2500 closely printed pages which terminate twenty-seven years of Toynbee's unflagging energy. He illustrates three glaring errors in the last series of volumes, one being the development of trade-unions in Western civilization which were, according to Toynbee, an outcome of the spirit of Freedom, intended to resist the regimentation consequent upon the new industrial conditions. Unfortunately the trade-unions defeated their purpose since they led to the workers regimenting themselves.

Describing this as 'political clap-trap,' Professor Geyl brings Toynbee to task for not recognizing the improvement of material conditions among the workers or the building up of political power in preference to condemning the present state of Western civilization.

Another example is the extermination of the Jews by the National-Socialist regime which, while abhorring, Toynbee places on a par with the policy of evicting Palestinian Arabs resorted to by Israel in 1948—three million lives against nine hundred thousand. In answering his question why did Toynbee say:

> "on the Day of Judgment the gravest crime standing to their (National-Socialist Germans) account might be, not that they had exterminated a majority of the Western Jews, but that they had caused the surviving remnant of Jews to stumble."[94]

Professor Geyl bluntly accuses Toynbee of an amazing outburst against the Jews based not on a scientific survey of the world's history as a whole, but "his hatred against nationalism in every shape and form... because...to him nationalism is merely a stumbling block on the road to his idolized

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94. Pieter Geyl, *Debates with Historians*, (New York: Philosophical Library, 1955), p. 160.

unity."[95] Finally, Professor Geyl disputes the dismal view of Western civilization wherein Hitler's failure was not due to his thesis that the World was ripe for conquest, (a fate which Mankind's patently increasing defeatism and submissiveness had provocatively invited) but to an accidental combination of incidental errors. In Geyl's opinion this is a gratuitous assertion with the facts marshalled in accordance with the writer's preconceived conclusion. In defense of his profession, Geyl points out that historians would not care if Toynbee wrote as a prophet but feel that the best traditions of their profession are insulted when the prophet poses as an historian:[96]

> "Once one has grasped the spirit and purpose of the last installment of the great work, one feels that demonstrations of fallacious arguments, of perversions of the significance of historical data, or of their complete irrelevance for the thesis, demonstrations which seemed worth attempting in connection with the first six volumes, have indeed become utterly superfluous...The historian should take an interest in his subject for its own sake, he should try to get into contact with things as they were, the men and their vicissitudes should mean something to him in themselves. I do not mean that the historian should not have a point of view...But when a man comes to the past with a compelling vision, a principle, or dogma, of such magnitude and emotional potence as Toynbee's... with a system which causes him to reduce the multitudinous movement of history to one single, divinely inspired current, and to judge civilizations and generations by one single criterion, rejecting most of them, and incidentally his own, as unimportant; that man can write a work full of colour and striking theories, glowing with conviction and eloquence, but no history. The Study of History is no history. The Student of History, as Toynbee calls himself, may know more of history than I shall ever do, but he is no historian. He is a prophet."

In the years during World War II when work on *A Study of History* was interrupted, Professor Toynbee reviewed the first six volumes, equating them with further discoveries in the field of archeology, the work of psychologists and atomic physicists as well as the impact on history of an Einstein, Freud, Jung, Gandhi, Stalin, Hitler, Churchill and Roosevelt who had been changing the face of the Macrocosm. These reflections

95. *Ibid.*, p. 161.

96. *Ibid.*, p. 170–171.

had the effect of changing the significance of his system of civilizations as previously deduced by Geyl in reviewing the last four volumes. This conviction was further established by a series of radio lectures given by Toynbee in 1953 and published under the title of *The World and the West*.[97] He viewed the present world crisis as a result of a response by the rest of the world (Russia and the Orient) to the challenge of continued Western aggression. Drawing a parallel between Western and the declining Roman Civilization, he thought it likely that the West would be converted to a new religion coming from the East, as Rome had been converted to Christianity.

> "The Russians' recent success in capturing the initiative from us...does not, of course, mean that Communism is destined to prevail...All the same, Communism's success, so far as it has gone, looks like a portent of things to come. What it does tell us is that the present encounter between the world and the West is now moving off the technological plane on to the spiritual plane."[98]

Mr. Douglas Jerrold, an English Catholic historian, responded to Professor Toynbee's challenge.[99] His first response was to challenge Toynbee's facts. The West has not been continually aggressive. On the contrary, it was on the defensive for a thousand years against the Northmen, the Magyars, and against Islam. The East has been aggressive too. Islam was a threat to Christendom from 700–1600 A. D. The Russian hegemony has steadily expanded from 1480 to the present, except for a brief setback in 1918. This is corroborated by Sir Edward Creasy in his book *Fifteen Decisive Battles of the World* published in 1851:[100]

> "The acquisitions which Russia has made within the last 64 years (since 1775) are equal in extent and importance to the whole empire she had in Europe before that time; the acquisitions she has made from Sweden are greater than what remains of that ancient kingdom; her acquisitions from

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97. Arnold J. Toynbee, *The World and the West*, (New York: Oxford University Press, 1953).

98. Douglas Jerrold, *The Lie About the West*, (New York: Sheed and Ward, 1954), pp. 68–71.

99. *Ibid.*, p. 11–21.

100. Sir Edward Creasy, *Fifteen Decisive Battles of the World*, (Harrisburg: Military Service, 1943).

> Poland are large as the whole Austrian empire; * * * In sixty four years (Russia) has advanced her frontier eight hundred and fifty miles toward Vienna, Berlin...Paris."

Mr. Jerrold also challenges Toynbee's logic. Because of his dialectical theory of history, Jerrold thinks he too often forces historical facts into preconceived patterns. He created an entity, "the West" which is not clearly defined, then treats it as though it were a real unity, like one man or one government, with a continual life and consistent policy. He makes it appear to have such a policy by identifying any single aggressive Western power with the entire West for example, Germany in 1918 and 1941. But in both wars the other Western powers were on Russia's side. Jerrold finally accuses Toynbee of treason against the faith of the West. By questioning the unique value of our Christian faith, our political institutions, our economic freedom, our independent families, Toynbee spreads doubt against all the basic values which the West has derived from Graeco-Roman civilization and from Christianity—and by spreading doubt he promotes the downfall of our world:[101]

> "Our deep and passionate quarrel with the Communist society, as with the National Socialist society, is not, and never has been, political; it concerns precisely those things born of Christian which are still recognized by all men of goodwill as necessary to the good life and the healthy society. Christian civilization is not just one among many; it is, and the world today provides overwhelming evidence of the fact, the only civilization built on the rights of the human personality, rights which derive from the belief in the immortality of the soul of man. So wholly is our thought, our tradition, and our language Christian, that we tend to take for granted what in fact is a revolutionary conception...Thus was brought into the world the principle of secular authority subject to the moral law, a principle which proclaimed each man to belong to two states: a terrestrial state whose end is the common temporal good, and the universal state of the Church, whose end is eternal life...To the claim of the State to omnicompetence, only the Christian religion which Professor Toynbee tells us we have jettisoned has ever provided an answer."

The resultant change in the system of challenge and response caused by observations of the world's vicissitudes during the last twenty years

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101. *Ibid.*, pp. 79–80.

caused Toynbee himself to brush aside the labour devoted to his first six volumes. Professor Geyl probes this paradox of Toynbee's escaping into a non-existing world unity as a prideful and sinful ostentation of detach from his own heritage:[102]

> "Often one cannot help suspecting the detachment of being spite masquerading as detachment, so incredibly biased is his treatment of Western civilization when he comes to discuss its prospects. Every sign of crisis or of decadence, every flaw, every incidental infidelity to its professed principles, is by him eagerly displayed as evidence of its approaching dissolution. On the other hand there is hardly more than a grudging word, now and then, about its positive achievements. The great European thinkers and poets and artists and scholars serve Toynbee to decorate his pages or to strengthen his ideas; but as far as his estimation of Western civilization is concerned they might as well as never have existed...The great advance made during that period in the countries of our civilization in the matter of social security and material prosperity (which also have their importance when it comes to 'spiritual opportunities'), in humanity coupled with more stable order and more equitable law, it weighs as nothing in his scales. The deficiencies in these respects of the centuries when civilization had in Toynbee's view a more real significance are ignored or condoned. The study of history is not to concern itself with men as they lived and strove. The system requires that it should all be viewed and 'assayed' by the one test...discovered a few years ago: religion."

Limited research of the criticism of professional historians reveals no explanation for the about-face of Toynbee, after empirically investigating the Genesis, Growth, Breakdown and Disintegration of all known civilizations in an attempt to supply laws of mankind's historic life and forecast the future, wherein the original judgment of communism as militant atheism is metamorphosized into a dogma with a "Western spiritual weapon" which it wields so well in the present encounter between Russia and the West that, "the spiritual initiative... has now passed, *at any rate for the moment*, from the Western to the Russian side."[103] It is not as if Toynbee did not have the opposite point of view suggested—he availed himself to the comments of Mr. Martin Wight who read the chapter on

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102. Geyl, *op. cit.*, pp. 167–168.

103. Jerrold, *op. cit.*, p. 66.

Universal Churches (Vol VII, 728) before publication and whose piercing criticism is printed as an Annex in the Book:[104]

> "Your description of Christianity is philosophical rather than historic-theological, 'Hellenic' rather than 'Hebraic.' You define Christianity in terms of the assertion that 'God is Love,' (p. 428) or as 'unique in revealing God to Man as Man's father and brother!' But this is only true as far as it goes, and it does not go far enough. The central declaration of Christianity is not that God is something, but that God has done something...God has done something in history; He has acted in history to show the meaning of history. If the Gospels say anything they say this; and since it is the common theme of St. John, perhaps the greatest modern Anglican commentary on St. John's Gospel may be quoted on the point (Hoskyns, Edwyn Clement: The Fourth Gospel, edited by F. N. Davey, London, 1947, p. 58)
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> 'Modern study of the Fourth Gospel has pressed upon the Church the problem of historicity; the author of the Fourth Gospel, however...presses upon his readers the far more important, far more disturbing, problem of History itself and of its meaning. Confronted by the flesh of Jesus, the son of man, he demands that men should remember what He said (XIV, 26), nay more, that they should eat His flesh and drink His blood (VI 52–6)...It is difficult to imagine language that fixes attention more steadily upon the importance of history...' 'It is the spirit that quickeneth, the flesh profiteth nothing' (VIII 43). It therefore follows necessarily that His words, His actual words, require for their understanding the interpretation that the Spirit of Truth alone is able to provide (XIV 26)...And His words and actions, if they be thought of merely as historical episodes, are trivial and meaningless (VIII 6–18). This is the Witness of the author of the Fourth Gospel: a witness thrust like a dagger straight into the heart of the 'World' insofar as the World is regarded as existing of itself and in its own right; plunged like a dagger into the heart of History, if History contains within itself, its own evident, analyzable, and describable meaning..."

To have seen as Toynbee must have the absolute corruption which comes from the absolute power of the State; to have seen the absolute dependence and abasement which is the lot of men who allow the family to be subordinated to the State and themselves to become functions of the machine and not to recognize that the dignity that came to man with the Christian revelation, has gone from him in those societies which have

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104. Martin Wight, Annex to Toynbee's *A Study of History*, Vol. VII, pp. 728–739.

turned their backs on Christianity is inexplicable. Further, in the face of Toynbee's abandonment of his own system of civilizations and the twisted torturing of facts to accommodate a concept of Western aggression against Russia, the only logical position to assume is to challenge his whole philosophy of history on the same grounds as we have challenged Marx'—that the dialectic synthesis depends on what the historian believes to be the challenge and response. When preconceived ideas, prejudices and fetishes such as World Unity or universalist solidarism are inserted with arbitrarily selected events of history into a faulty system of reasoning such as the dialectic only untruth can result. Perhaps it is best to say with Geyl:[105]

> "This is a good deal more than a question of 'technique.' If the historical foundations, which Toynbee assures us securely support his theories about the destinies of civilizations, are proved to be unsound, as I believe that I have proved them to be, the whole imposing structure becomes a dream-like fantasy –."

Sir Flinders Petrie

The human mind has an insatiable desire for truth, which may be called an insuppressible curiosity. This is what drives men to read newspapers and books, to spend years or a whole life time in study, to rejoice in every bit of knowledge that is acquired. But the most important kind of knowledge that the human mind seeks to acquire is that which concerns the nature, the destiny, the obligations and responsibilities of man himself. Every human recognizes in himself a need and desire to know why he was born, to what end he should aspire, how he should live and die. This need was ably expressed by one of the first scientifically trained observers of the human scene, Sir Flinders Petrie who begins his little study (131 pages) published in 1911, as follows:

> "The meaning of Life has in all ages been the goal of human thought. The search for the causes and effects of the changes that man has undergone has laid the foundations of his religion and his philosophy."

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105. Geyl, *op. cit.*, p. 176.

Sir Petrie, in tracing the past of man in continuous history for over seven thousand years, noted the curiously repetitive pattern displayed by the civilizations of the West, the classical civilizations, the late Egyptian, the Egyptian Middle Kingdom, and the Egypt of the pyramids. While his cyclical theory of history created little attention it merits our scrutiny because the method used differs from Marx and Toynbee in that it is an empiric examination of artifacts, i.e., art (sculpture, painting, literature), architecture, mechanics, science, wealth, and forms of government. Amply illustrated with photographs of examples of the three stages of each of the civilizations considered, the early (archaic), middle (best) and late (decadent) he reached the following conclusions of import:[106]

> "1. P. 108 Thus the Eastern phase, on the whole keeps about 3 1/2 centuries in advance of the Mediterranean (phase)... The impression that civilization always comes from the East is due to the East being a few centuries ahead of the West in its phase...If Mesopotamia and Europe were in the same phase, there would be a balance of power, as there is around the Mediterranean, when even a political ascendancy does not involve a change in population...Yet, on the whole, the West more usually controls the East, because from the time of its maximum, during the gradual decline of each period, it is always on a higher plane than the East. (Comparing) the period of civilizations (we find the duration to be)
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> Mediterranean, average 1,330 years
> Mesopotamia, average 1,520 "
> India, one period 1,800 "
> Mexico, " " about 1,500 "
>
> It is evident, therefore, that the length of period is practically alike in different parts of the globe suggesting that it is due to the human constitution rather than to external causes.
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> "2. P. 114...every civilization of a settled population tends to incessant decay from its *maximum* condition; and this decay continues until it is too weak to initiate anything, when a fresh race comes in, and utilizes the old stock to graft on, both in blood and culture. As soon as the mixture is well started, it rapidly grows on the old soil, and produces a new wave of civilization.
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> "3. P. 120 The striking feature is the much wider spread of the phases as the periods descend. This means that there are lesser intervals of barbarism

106. W. M. Flinders Petrie, *The Revolutions of Civilization*, (London: Harper and Brothers, 1912), pp. 108–130.

between the civilizations, and that the civilization phase in each period is longer at each recurrence. This is in accord with the common idea that the world is getting more civilized as the ages go on, in spite of the crushing fact that in many kinds of civilization the successive recurrences show no improvement...Thus, while the best work in art is no better in successive periods, the total amount of civilization is greater, because it is longer. The gain is in quantity and not quality.

"4. P. 123 Stages of Government—At every invasion by a new people...there must be a strong personal rule. The holding together of the invaders, the decisive subjection of the invaded, the strife of the fusion of peoples, all require an autocracy...This period lasts during four to six centuries. The next stage is an oligarchy, when leadership is still essential, but the unity of the country can be maintained by law instead of by autocracy. This stage varies in length; in Greece and Rome it was about four centuries, in Mediaeval Europe about five or six centuries.

Then gradually the transformation to a democracy takes place...During this time—of about four centuries—wealth—that is the accumulated capital of facilities—continues to increase. When democracy has attained full power, the majority without capital necessarily eat up the capital of the minority, and the civilization steadily decays until the inferior population is swept away to make room for a fitter people...

"5. P. 125 There is no advance without strife. Man must strive with Nature or with man, if he is not to fall back and degenerate. The harder a nation strives, the more capable it will be... So soon as each subject loses its archaism and reaches full freedom of expression, there is no more strife with difficulties and uncertainties of mode; then, strife being ended, decay sets in shortly after. Further the accumulation of the facilities of life, or capital in every form, diminishes the need for striving... Hence, the easier life is rendered, the more easy is decay and degradation. The maximum of wealth must inevitably lead to the downfall."

The striking comparison with Toynbee can easily be seen in this empiric analysis of the remains of civilizations—primarily in the central theme of challenge and response. But two questions remain—can civilizations really be considered as units and do comparisons with other civilizations provide valid understanding of current history as well as predictions of future history? With reference to the first point, Geyl says:[107]

107. Geyl, *op. cit.*, p. 147.

> "This question is never really examined by Toynbee, no more than it was by Spengler. When one tries to visualize his twenty-one civilizations, one is at once struck by the enormous differences between them in size, in structure. Take our western civilization, for instance. I shall not deny the reality of its unitary character, but the composite structure is certainly very marked...Toynbee does not waste any words over this problem...he never faces up to it. He takes his data from national histories as if they were indisputably relevant to the history of Western civilization, and he takes them from each part as they suit his argument concerning the whole."

Two authorities cast serious doubt on any important contribution, except wisdom and understanding, from historical analogies; first Geyl:[108]

> "...generally speaking, parallels in history, however indispensable and frequently instructive, are never wholly satisfactory, because each phenomenon is embedded in its own circumstances, never to be repeated, from which it cannot be completely detached. This warning must be especially taken to heart by anyone setting out to compare this civilization of ours with other and older civilizations. The circumstances have in many ways undergone so profound a change that we seem to be living in another world from the ancient Egyptians, or the ancient Chinese, or Iranians, or whatever peoples provide Professor Toynbee with his rules and laws, in another world also from that of the Hellenized Romans, whose decline and fall have obviously strongly influenced his mind in the construction of his system."

In his Auguste Comte Memorial Trust Lecture delivered in 1954, Isaiah Berlin points out that the father of sociology, Comte, believed in the application of scientific rules of explanation in all fields of study and saw no reason why they could not apply to relations of human beings as well as things. The notion that men were objects in Nature—that human history could be turned into a natural science by the extension to human beings of a kind of sociological zoology, analogous to the study of bees and beavers, while not fully accepted was implied in his obstinate craving for unity and symmetry at the expense of experience—the desire for one complete and all-embracing pyramid of scientific knowledge; one method; one truth; one scale of rational, 'scientific values.' With that basic theme Berlin dissects the notion that one can discover large patterns or regularities in

108. *Ibid.*, p. 125.

historical events, a process running on from one inevitable conclusion to another, down to the outcome, hidden from the actors in the drama but known to the historian, as no more than constructions in the historians mind, to which the unfathomable and unruly past has, by arbitrary selection, been made to conform. In the process Mr. Berlin establishes the theories of Hegel, Marx, Spengler and Toynbee not only as fallacious, but dangerous and concludes with a striking analysis of the appeal of this dangerous fallacy of a determinist interpretation of history:[109]

> "There is a cluster of views (to which the progress of the natural sciences has given a great and growing prestige) according to which all explanations in terms of human intentions rest on a mixture of vanity and stubborn ignorance. These views rest on the assumption that belief in the importance of the motives is delusive; that the behaviour of men is in fact made what it is by factors largely beyond the control of individuals; for instance, by the influence of physical factors, or of environment, or of custom; or by the 'natural' growth of some larger unit—a race, a nation, a class, a biological species; or by ... a Hegelian World Spirit... Thus nations or cultures or civilizations for Hegel (and Spengler; and one is inclined, though somewhat hesitantly, to add Professor Arnold Toynbee) are certainly not merely convenient collective terms for individuals possessing certain characteristics in common; but are more 'real' and more 'concrete' than the individuals who compose them. Individuals remain 'abstract' precisely because they are mere 'elements' ...artificially abstracted for AD HOC purposes, and literally without existence...apart from the wholes of which they form a part. Marx and the Marxists are more ambiguous. We cannot be quite sure what to make of such a category as a social 'class' whose emergence and struggles, victories and defeats, condition the lives of individuals, sometimes against, and most often independently of, such individuals' conscious or expressed purposes...Yet to seek to explain, or put a moral or political value on the actions of individuals by examining such individuals one by one, even to the limited extent to which such examination is possible, is considered by Marxists to be merely impracticable and time-wasting, but absurd in a more fundamental sense—because the 'true' causes of human behaviour lie not in the specific circumstances of an individual life or in the individual's thoughts or volitions... but in a pervasive interrelationship between a vast variety of such lives with their natural and man-made environment. Men do as they do, and think as they think, largely as a 'function of' the

109. Berlin, *op. cit.*, pp. 5–13.

> inevitable evolution of the 'class' as a whole—from which it follows that the history and development of classes can be studied independently of the biographies of their component individuals. It is the 'structure' and the 'evolution' of the class alone that (causally) matters in the end. This is, *mutatis mutandis*, similar to the attitude taken by those who identify race with culture....
>
> "For Hegel, for Marx, for Spengler...this reality takes on the form of an objective 'march of history' ...Some view subjective aberrations with compassion...others gloat...over the inevitable doom of those who misinterpret...the inexorable march of events. But whether the tone is charitable or sardonic...this attitude rests on the belief that everything is caused to appear as it does by the machinery of history itself—by the impersonal forces of class, race, culture, History, The Life Force, Progress... To blame or praise individuals or groups of individuals for acting rightly or wrongly, so far as this entails a suggestion that they are in some sense genuinely free to choose between alternatives...is a vast blunder. (We are told it is foolish to judge Charlemagne or Napoleon, or Genghis Khan or Hitler or Stalin for their massacres). For if such choices were real, the determined world structure which alone, on this view, makes possible complete explanation... could not exist."

Mr. Berlin takes this determinism applied to history and shows that if the affairs of mankind are indeed subject to laws and evolve in a closely knitted order in which every human action and thought are determined and in its turn determining, it is only omniscience that will be able to discern the pattern and to assign to each human particle its place in it. Mr. Berlin adjudges the historian's knowledge as far removed indeed from omniscience, and even were every relevant fact within the reach of his investigating powers, the multitude and complexity would surpass his powers of comprehension. But one of the most interesting points made by Mr. Berlin is that the fallacy of historical determinism appears from its utter inconsistency with the common sense and every-day way of looking at human affairs, which is so ingrained in our whole habit of thought that even the determinists cannot help using the language belonging to it:[110]

> "There is a class of expressions, which we constantly use (and can scarcely do without) like 'you should not (or need not) have done this'; 'why did

110. *Ibid.*, pp. 31–34.

> you make this terrible mistake;' 'I could do it, but I would rather not;' 'must the Commander in Chief be quite so stupid?' Expressions of this type plainly involve the notion of more than the merely logical possibility of ... alternatives...For no one will wish to deny that we do often argue about the best among the possible courses of action open to human beings in the present and past and future...and that this is the sole and obvious reason why accidents,—being by definition unavoidable—are necessarily outside the category of responsibility and consequently beyond the bounds of criticism, or the attribution of praise and blame ...All this seems too self-evident to argue...If determinism were a valid theory of human behaviour, these distinctions would be as inappropriate as the attribution of moral responsibility to the planetary system or the tissues of a living cell...If the belief in freedom—which rests on the assumption that human beings do occasionally choose, and that their choices are not wholly accounted for by the kind of causal explanations which are accepted in, say, physics or biology—if this is a necessary illusion, it is so deep and so pervasive that it is not felt as such...My submission is that to make a serious attempt to adapt our thoughts and words to the hypothesis of determinism is scarcely feasible as things are now, and have been within recorded history...; we cannot begin to think out in real terms; to which behaviour and speech would correspond, what the universe of the genuine determinist would be like, any more than we can think out...what it would be like to be in a timeless world, or one with a seventeen-dimensional space."

Determinism as a historical method, then, is a fallacy. Common sense alone shows that the inevitability of a demonstration in algebra is not applicable to human affairs. But why dangerous?

Mr. Berlin replies that it instills acquiescence and passive subjection to the uncontrollable forces conjured up for the awed public as the masters of their destiny sapping their sense of individual responsibility:[111]

> "Agonizing doubts about the conduct of individuals caught in the historical crises and the feelings of hope and despair, guilt, pride, and remorse, which accompany such reflections, are taken from us. Like soldiers in an army driven by forces too great to resist, we lose those neuroses which depend on the fear of having to choose among alternatives. Where there is no choice, there is no anxiety; and a happy release from responsibility. Some human beings have always preferred the peace of imprisonment, a contented sense of security, a sense of having at last found one's proper place in the cosmos,

111. *Ibid.*, p. 73.

> to the painful conflicts and perplexities of the disordered freedom of the world beyond the walls."

Already implicit is Mr. Berlin's opinion as to the attraction of the fallacy of a determinist interpretation of history which he confirms in his conclusion:[112]

> "Principally it seems to me to spring from a desire to resign our responsibility, to cease from judging provided we be not judged ourselves and, above all, are not compelled to judge ourselves; from a desire to flee for refuge to some vast amoral, impersonal, monolithic whole, nature or history, or class, or race, or 'the harsh realities of our time,' or 'the irresistible evolution of the social structure'...This is an image which has often appeared in the history of mankind, always at moments of confusion and inner weakness."

While we can agree with Mr. Berlin's keen analysis and conclusion, of the paralyzing effect and blessed sense of relief that many people find in acquiescence, the events in Russia should have impressed him with the fanaticizing effect that a determinist theory can have. The historical process conceived as an impersonal, irresistible, inevitable current may induce the feeling of passively floating along, but when the concept is reduced to some rigid system, this feeling may yield to one of being supported or driven, and an inhuman and amoral energy be imparted unimpeded by doubts of success or by moral scruples.

The application of the materialist conception of history in Russia and China is very different from apathy or weakness and challenges the West to cultivate its own traditions of belief in the value of personality, free discussion, criticism and the true scientific spirit to vindicate a true concept of history.

Human Nature

A view of life including social polity, philosophy and economics, which cannot be harmonized with the requirements of man's struggle with nature for the means of survival cannot itself survive, for the men who hold the view will not survive. In testing the validity of an idea we saw that to be

112. *Ibid.*, pp. 77–78.

valid, a concept must correctly read its whole social and natural environment. Similarly, we noted that the current method of evaluating history is to subject it to the perpetual countercheck of facts. Fundamentally, Marx's theory of history constitutes a philosophy of human nature which he postulates as irrecoverably intertwined with the modes of production in the genesis, development and future of human society. We have already examined and refuted Marx's historical derivation of current society, let us now examine briefly the results when his theory is applied as in the Soviet Union and determine if the nature of communism fits the nature of man.

A vital principle in Marx's system is that man is sufficient for himself. The success of the classless society is bound up with the principle that if the economic order is rightly arranged, all human needs can be met. Thus man needs no succor that man cannot provide for himself. By this principle, the Marxian vision must stand or fall. But as Mr. Sheed has so ably pointed out in *Communism and Man*, the most obvious fact about man is that he is born dependent; and as he grows to maturity he only loses certain forms of dependence to acquire others:[113]

> "Dependence upon his fellow man is inescapably necessary...And just as he has needs which he cannot supply in isolation from others, so he has powers (to love, to procreate, to teach) which he can express only in relation to his fellow man. Thus both by way of his needs and by way of his powers, certain relations with his fellow men are grounded in his very nature. The social relations are as much part of his nature as man, and as necessary to the completeness of our understanding of man, as his body and his mind...These relations—expressive of his nature as a social being—can be expressed in an amazing diversity of ways. But two sets of social relations exceed all others in the natural order and provide a natural framework of life in which the others must find their place. These two are the Family and Society."

Sheed continues his reasoning on Man the Social Animal by showing that the life of man is conditioned at its very root by two apparent contradictions. The race has to be propagated, children have to be born and brought to maturity, and this requires order and tranquillity as a condition of success. Yet the production of children is dependent upon the

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113. Sheed, *op. cit.*, p. 104.

sexual instinct, which is the most violent and disorderly of all the instincts of man. The problem is how can the violently unruly instinct be brought into that service which of all things requires order and stability. Nature's answer is the Family, where the power of sex, is brought to run with a single channel in the service of life. The family, then, is the most natural of the fixed social relations; it is closest to the race's fundamental need for continuance. It is not simply a device man has invented for his own convenience; it is the answer to something which is grounded in man's nature, and is therefore grounded in nature itself. Just as the individual cannot meet his own needs or express his own powers by himself, but requires the family, so families cannot in isolation meet all the needs of their members or give scope for the development of all the powers of their members. Families, therefore, are united in Society. This being the reason for the existence of society, it too is grounded in man's nature and is, therefore, natural. In Sheed's view:[114]

> "Rousseau's idea of a social contract by which men arbitrarily decided to come together in society is not true. Society is a requisite of human, not so primary as the family, but a real requisite all the same. Man cannot attain the fullness of his stature as man save in society, save by a co-operation with great masses of his fellows, a co-operation on a wider scale than the family allows."

Just as the family has certain natural functions and hence certain responsibilities and certain rights which are grounded in the nature of man, so society, too, has rights which are grounded in man's nature. Since the co-operation of men in complex society wherein human minds and human wills are involved is required to save it from chaos and bring it into order, some sort of authority is necessary. Authority in society is therefore natural, since it is required by the nature of man. As Sheed says:[115]

> "This means that authority is not conferred upon society by its members: since social authority is demanded by man's nature, men can no more confer authority upon society than they confer their nature upon themselves. The members of society may use all the powers of their intellect to perfect the social order and to decide upon the best organs for the expression of

114. *Ibid.*, p. 108.

115. *Ibid.*, p. 109.

> this authority; but the authority itself is not of their creation. Whatever power gave man his nature gives society its authority. But if man is not the source of authority in society, human nature is the purpose for whose service this authority exists; therefore it is by studying human nature that we shall arrive at an understanding of the scope and limitations of society's authority over its members. This is obviously the logical order. To construct a society, as Marx did, with the object of producing a social structure harmonious with itself and then to proceed to fit human nature into it willy-nilly, is not intelligent."

The purpose of human society is to act that part in the proper development of life on earth which neither the individual nor the family can act for itself. Its primary concern is with the life of man upon the earth. This does not mean mere economic prosperity, but an all-round human development of the intellect, moral virtues, the arts, and in general of all that goes to make a properly human life. Society is concerned with the earthly life of men, but in its arrangements for this life it must never forget what men are or that this earthly life itself has a further goal. For instance, Society can never in any circumstances or under any pressure act in contradiction to the nature of man with an eternal destiny, as by denying his right to worship God, or by calling upon him to lie or commit a crime for as Sheed says:

> "If you treat men as what they are not, and if you treat any beings at all—cows or cannon-balls for instance—as what they are not, you sin against reality and make failure certain."[116]

The nature of society depends upon the question of the value to be attached to individual person. What is the value of the individual? It is clear that for Marx the question never arises because the individual man is to him scarcely a man at all, and his one value is for the perfection of society. The personal value of man is closely bound up with the Christian revelation. Before the coming of Christ, men were valued as kings or generals or rich men or poets, but not as men. The notion that a man was valuable simply because he was a man may have occurred to an occasional philosopher, but had not penetrated into the mind of society at large. It was the Christian message that man, every man, was not only a being of

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116. *Ibid.*, p. 110.

value, but a being of eternal value, and this message revolutionized the world. According to Sheed, as against the Christian concept of the value of the individual.[117]

> "Materialism can provide no principle of personal value. It insists upon man's materiality and on his transience. Born of matter for no special reason, held briefly above the surface of inanimate matter for no special reason, merged again into the great mass of unliving matter, man is no more than a material accident. No mind conceived him or endowed him with a purpose. To see man thus is to see him as nothing. All men are equal, and all are equal to nothing. It is to the credit of Marx's consistency that he made no effort to give the human person any value as distinct from the collective, any rights against the collective. Man was nothing: body and soul, he belonged to Society and Society totally possessing him might do with him as it willed."

In probing further into the relations of men with one another, Sheed notes that communism is based upon a doctrine of human equality, in fact, passes beyond that into the warmer concept of brotherhood. While all men have something in common that entitles them to the name of man, they are not equal in strength or intelligence or courage or virtue or energy or any kind of effectiveness. Yet communism insists upon some kind of fundamental equality in men which is to be the basis of a society in which special privilege is to be abolished—unless men be fundamentally equal, where is the injustice of special privilege? But while Communists and Christians can by their own unaided efforts discover the inequality of man, the Christian bases this equality upon the Word of God, who is the author of Man, whereas communism, having rejected God, can base it upon nothing at all. Yet their system requires it; but if there be no God, it is only a fiction, and a fiction is no foundation. Regarding brotherhood of man, Sheed says:[118]

> "That the brotherhood of man is the only possible basis upon which society can be constructed is becoming clearer and clearer. 'Communism is the incarnation of the brotherhood of all men,' wrote Nicholas Bukharin in the columns of *Pravda*. Yet unless there be a God brotherhood is even more obviously a fiction than equality. Brotherhood is not simply a word capable of arousing a generous emotion; it is a fact. Brothers are sons of one

117. *Ibid.*, p. 137.

118. *Ibid.*, p. 141.

> father, and to that common father brotherhood as a fact is to be referred. Men are only brothers if men have a common father; and if there is no God, who is the common father upon whom brotherhood may be based? Communism, denying God, is in the position of telling men that they must act like brothers and in the next breath adding, 'But, of course, you are not.' "

It is in the enigma of individuals acting as brothers with justice and love that communism is badly lacking in realism. There is a curious idea that love of our fellowmen is easy. A man will say that he is satisfied to practise the golden rule, to do unto others as he would have them do to him—all he wants is that men should love one another. But he fails to see that to treat others as you would have them treat you is not the first step in a good life; it is the distant, enormously difficult, seldom totally achieved result of a lifetime of conquering one's own selfishness with all the aids that God can give for that purpose. A man who talks of treating others as himself has never tried it. It is easy to love the lovable; it is possible to persuade oneself that one loves the average, provided there is not too frequent or too close contact with them; but to love the unlovable, those who act hatefully, is a task of immense self-conquest. There is only one possible reason which could stimulate us to make the effort to do something so repellent and contrary to every instinct as loving the unlovable, and that is the certain knowledge that we are all creatures of God and that God is love. The most cursory examination of the whole of history—or of any section of it, particularly in Marx's time, would reveal that the evils from which society suffers at the hands of men, arise from human selfishness. In big enterprises or small, men tend to go for what they want, with varying degrees of disregard for others. Human selfishness or self-interest is therefore a universal principle of social evil and one must ask what is to be done about it in the classless society. Sheed is particularly penetrating in his evaluation of this defeat:[119]

> "So obvious is this difficulty that one wonders why Marx did not see it. With all his boast of looking to history for the laws that govern history, it was certainly not in history that he found his proletariat, or even the embryo of his proletariat, but in his own mind. And this indeed brings

119. *Ibid.*, pp. 87–90.

us to his greatest weakness. He saw the defects inherent in the Capitalist system and because they were in a *system* he took them seriously, they were real to him, and he gave the whole weight of his thoughts to remedying them; he saw the defects in man too, but they were not real to him, he paid no great attention to them, he assumed they would remedy themselves...If he had taken some of that time which he spent with books in the British Museum and devoted it to speaking from a platform in Hyde Park, he might (so great was his genius) have produced a sociology greater than any man has yet produced...He simply did not know the poor. Dickens had as much pity for the poor and sense of injustice and hardness of their lives as Marx. It would never have occurred to Dickens to think that the poor were less wrought upon by our common human sinfulness than their exploiters. Dickens could show us poor men raised to riches and developing every vice of the hereditary rich; he could show us poor men remaining poor men and exploiting their still poorer fellows with a viciousness and venomousness that no rich man could have bettered...Marx's failure to look at the poor was only part of his general failure to look at men. And he did not look at men because fundamentally he was not interested in men, but only in systems...This failure to consider the nature of man led him to overrate and underrate it...The obvious criticism that would occur to anyone approaching Marx's Classless Society without prejudice would be that he makes no allowance at all for the imperfections of man. After all, why should the Classless Society work. Even in the Classless Society there would be nice jobs and nasty jobs, hard jobs and easy jobs. A human society is not a beehive. In a beehive there are only two or three kinds of jobs all told, and bees are so constructed that each kind of bee can only do his own kind of job. There is no question, therefore, of some bureaucratic class of bees who apportion the work to be done. But in a society of men the jobs must be apportioned. And the apportioners will have quite enormous powers...Even if by some incredible chance the men who did the apportioning were totally disinterested, the human beings who would get the jobs are not...Men are lazy and easily convinced that they have done enough, and that others are doing less than they; History shows men as subject in varying measures to the two grand human instincts of sloth and self-importance...and apart from these, there are profounder elements in humanity—cruelty, lusts natural and unnatural—which can disrupt any society. Not only would all these human qualities exist as problems requiring continuous solution in the Classless Society; they would be present in the proletarian state to prevent it ever developing into the Classless Society...in a different way he underrated man even more grievously. The theory of the Classless Society depends upon this, that man will be happy in it

> because all his needs are economic and only require for their satisfaction a society properly organized for production. What appears so monstrous in this theory is the notion that all men's needs are to be satisfied by economic adjustment...Man's looking beyond this world never has been simply a matter of economic needs unsatisfied. It corresponds to something deeper in his nature than the mere vicissitudes of his material well-being can reach. Indeed, it is precisely when man has most satisfactorily adjusted himself to the material circumstances of life that the last veil between himself and the sheer emptiness of living is torn away. There is a fundamental unease at the heart of man: while material circumstances are against him he can explain his unease by them. It is only when these are properly adjusted that he knows that the unease is still there and arises from some cause deeper than they... Thus communism, abandoning God, leaves the individual nothing to love, no principle to make fraternity a reality, no basis for the equality of man, and thus no principle of conduct save self-interest."

We have examined the fundamental elements of communism in relation to elements similarly fundamental in the nature of man and have discovered that they do not complement each other. In constructing his theory of history Marx ignored the question of human nature and its value; it follows that the failure to consider such a fundamental factor will have its revenge by bringing to collapse any system of society that ignores it.

While admitting that communism could hardly have chosen a worse testing ground than Russia where it has been largely abandoned for a system of state capitalism, it is worth-while to glance at the conditions of a country that started on the road to Marxian communism forty years ago.

As Edward Crankshaw and other observers of the Russian scene have noted,[120] the Communist regime under Stalin waged implacable war against every individual of character and intellect who would not submit to it absolutely. Generation after generation lost its most brilliant ornaments in this way, but equally, generation after generation produced more individuals who were prepared to accept in general terms the only regime they knew. They came up from the peasant masses, most via industry. Now nearly half the population of formerly agricultural Russia works in towns, in the new factories built under the Five Year Plans. The town

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120. Edward Crankshaw, *Russia Without Stalin*, (New York: The Viking Press, 1956), also: Philip E. Mosely, "Russia Revisited," *Foreign Affairs*, (October 1956), pp. 72–83.

workers have been absorbed into the system; but the peasants, collectivization notwithstanding, still stand outside it. Above both stands a new elite, in effect a new governing caste, now impressively large which has a vested interest in the system: the Party Chieftains, the factory managers, the higher civil servants, the Army officers and the Soviet intelligentsia, consisting of writers, artists, musicians, etc. Despite these changes, according to Crankshaw;

> "The leaders of the Soviet System are certainly Marxists, and lately, while amending certain basic teachings of Lenin, have been at pains to emphasize their continued faith in the ultimate doom of the bourgeois world and the ultimate triumph of global communism."[121]

As if to confirm this impression Khrushchev reminded the world recently that Soviet Russia will abandon the Marxist-Leninist concept of the victory of the proletariat only "when the shrimp in the sea learns to whistle."[122] In trying to explain the Utopian view of the West on the possibility of a gradual transformation in Soviet aggressiveness, Crankshaw says:[123]

> "...the East and West have very different ideas of the real meaning of communism...in the West communism stands above all for egalitarianism and the withering away of the State—Lenin in his innocence, for a time believed that all the administrative offices could be filled by butchers and bakers...The retreat from the position, the exaltation of the apparatus of the State and the development of a stratified society with very great and planned, income differentials, has been such that the foreign observer too easily concludes that the Soviet Communists now a total cynic, that the whole, noble, if farfetched, ideal that inspired the early Bolsheviks has been thrown overboard. Inside the Soviet Union the ideal has not been abandoned; it has simply, over the years, shifted its emphasis...Although the pure doctrine has been betrayed, the spirit (of Lenin's revolution) is very much alive...The spirit, which still dominates the minds of countless Soviet citizens, including the most active, says that by taking thought and projecting thought into action mankind can so improve his own material

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121. Crankshaw, *op. cit.*, pp. 27–28.

122. Marshall D. Shulman, "Is the Soviet Union Changing?" *The Problems of Communism*, Vol. V, No. 3, (May-June 1956), p. 18.

123. Crankshaw, *op. cit.*, pp. 53–54.

> condition as to produce a new world, richer and more solidly based than anything dreamed up by the Utopians, because rooted in the historic truths proclaimed by Karl Marx..."

Nevertheless there exist inner contradictions and tensions within Soviet Russia as described by the U. S. Library of Congress in its report on "Tensions with the Soviet Union:"[124]

> "Public enemy No. 1 of the Politburo is, however—and has been since the establishment of the Soviet regime in Russia—the nature of man himself, with all his inborn instincts and desires for well-being, personal property, moral freedom, and spiritual independence. The Bolsheviks themselves are the first to admit in their own party publications—incidentally insufficiently studied abroad—the severe difficulties they encounter in their efforts to impose communism on the Soviet masses. The following naked relation of the true state of affairs within the Soviet Union is offered by S. Kovalev, 33 years after the Communist revolution occurred in Russia. It appears in the October 1950 issue of the leading party magazine Bolshevik and deserves the full attention of the West:
>
> " '...the supremacy of the socialist ideology does not mean that we have already completely done away with the survivals of the old bourgeois and petty bourgeois ideology, with the old views, manners, and habits...The Bolshevist Party has managed to bring about a radical alteration in the views of Soviet people concerning labor...At the same time, a segment of Soviet citizens still retains a backward uncommunistic attitude toward work...nonfulfillment of quotas, in poor quality of work, in output of inferior quality...there is encountered conservatism, antimechanization, and unwillingness to introduce new technology. There are still officials in industry and agriculture who do not wish to translate into reality the Socialist principles of remuneration of labor and practice petty bourgeois leveling of wages.' "

In fascinating chapters on the means adopted by the Soviet people to accommodate their lives to the totally planned economy of the Communist State both Crankshaw and David Dallin describe some of the aberrations evident in Soviet society, for instance Blat which stands for an extremely elaborate system of granting favors in the hope, the expectation

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124. "Tensions Within the Soviet Union," U. S. Library of Congress Legislative Reference Service, presented by Mr. Wiley, (Washington: U. S. Govt. Print. Off., 1951), p. 3.

of favors to come. Everyone, including the most ardent Party members, deals in it; but let Crankshaw describe it:[125]

> "Blat—a significant monosyllable which stands for something stronger than 'pull' and rather less than 'graft'...Nobody would believe, (a traveller to U.S.S.R. while Stalin was alive) that the whole of the Soviet Union was one vast black market...It is now an open struggle... The papers are full of disgraceful and anti-social happenings...When the whole population of a great country is forced for survival onto the black market, the habit of mind...is going to take a great deal of getting rid of ...If you have a friend who is a trade union official he will probably have blocks of tickets to dispose to his flock for everything under the sun, from theatres to football games...With Blat, enough of it, you can get anything; a ticket for a sanitorium at Yalta; a seat on the Trans-Siberian; length of first quality cloth to have a suit made to measure; spares for your television set ... caviar when there is no caviar in the shops; nylons... everything you can conceivably want, and pay for, in a land where scarcities in all but the absolute necessities of life are general...and the people with the most Blat of all are, as would be expected, those who need it least; Party and government officials to say nothing of the political police...
>
> "It is essentially the product of an under-the-counter mentality which causes friends and acquaintances to combine together to defeat the shortages and the unlimited obstructive entangling red tape of the bureaucratic machine. The motive is self-defense; and the most incorruptible individuals deal in it freely."

In substantiating the many compromises with moral standards and family life which the Communist system has cultivated among its people, Crankshaw provides in the Appendix to his book a wide variety of pictures, cartoons and sermons on Soviet society from the Soviet controlled press. Among others, Beggars are deplored; Drunkenness decried:

> ("A Most Evil Vice - Literary Gazette, 29 July 1954 A generation has matured which does not know capitalist oppression. But individualistic passions and low proclivities are influencing this generation, too, like a congenital disease...In many places so-called religious festivals are celebrated, people—whole collective farms at a time—drinking for weeks on end;")

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125. Crankshaw, *op. cit.*, pp. 58–61; and Appendix pp. 221–256; See also David J. Dallin, *The New Soviet Empire*, (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1951), Chapter 7.

Stilyagi are chided—and zoot-suited male and disgracefully attired female offspring of the "intelligentsia" who live only for jazz, wild parties, affecting odious foreign mannerisms and speech. Beyond the Stilyagi are the Hooligans, constantly deplored in the Soviet press, who gang together in frenzies of destruction of government property and delight in rude, noisy, and hazardous disruption of everyday life. In analyzing this blot on the Soviet landscape, Crankshaw finds:[126]

> "The Government still denies the root causes... the continued priority for heavy industrial development at the expense of civilized living conditions; second, the deliberate killing of mental and spiritual life by the forced imposition of total orthodoxy...The sub causes, housing shortage...segregation of youth in hostels... substitution of inane political lectures for honest and speculative discussions...are recognized by the Government with a ceaseless outcry against everything but the system—the considered policy of the Communist Party and the government...to sacrifice everything to a heavy industry that battens on the living people, and the dissemination of an ideology which year by year is left farther behind by the realities of life."

In an interview with Dr. Vladimir Poremsky, a leader of Russia's underground, the Editors of the *U. S. News & World Report* found that signs of revolt were cropping up everywhere even before the October revolution in the satellites, i.e., 1 June 1956. After recounting eighteen riots and revolts against Soviet Rule during the period 1948 to 1956, the following exchange took place:[127]

> "Q. Is there evidence that any other riots have taken place in addition to those reported in the press—in Tiflis and in various concentration camps? Have your people had evidence to that effect?
>
> "A. We will probably continue for some time to be late in receiving news of developments in concentration camps and other outlying spots. In the larger centers, with which communication is more readily possible, there were no serious happenings lately outside Tiflis and Erivan. But such events become more and more possible every day.
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> "From the people we are in contact with, we know that this mood of unrest is growing stronger and stronger, which makes possible a major upheaval at practically any time.

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126. *Ibid.*, p. 105.

127. Dr. Vladimir Poremsky, "Fanning the Flames of Revolution in Soviet Russia," *U. S. News & World Report*, (June 1956), pp. 74–82.

> "Q. Do you have any indications where the weak spots or potential trouble spots are in the Soviet Union, aside from concentration camps?
>
> "A. Centers where there are many students or large numbers of workers, Industrial regions around Moscow, Leningrad, in the Donets Basin, etc.
>
> "Q. Does this mean that by educating their people the Communists have sown the seeds of their own destruction?
>
> "A. Yes, in a sense. Previously, the Communists were not afraid of other competing ideological systems, because they had faith in the appeal of their own system. But gradually, as the system proved itself incapable of solving problems *and of creating a new society and a new man, the Communists began to suppress all rival ideas* because they feared competition more and more. Thereby, they antagonized the students..." (underscoring supplied)

It would seem to the casual observer of the Soviet scene that if the system was so good, so inevitable that other nations should accept it on its merits why doesn't it give its own peoples and those of the satellites where it has had forty years on the one hand and a decade on the other an equitable opportunity to retain it on its merits? If communism can win on its merits, under conditions of genuine freedom of choice, why do not its proponents demonstrate that where communism now prevails? There is something basically wrong about a system that has never been accepted voluntarily by any people and which the Soviet leaders are unwilling to submit to a verdict of the peoples who know it best. Secretary of State, John Foster Dulles, has this to say about why the U.S.S.R. fears to permit peoples to make a choice between systems:[128]

> "Of course, dictatorship seems to offer some short-range advantages. It permits of opportunism. It makes possible a flexibility of action which is denied to democratically based governments. Despots can go in one direction one day and then in another direction the next day without need to explain or justify their zigs and zags. They are not bound by parliamentary directives or budgets. They can channel the education of their people in accordance with the dictates of expediency and they can compel persons of their choice to perform government tasks at home and abroad. Also, Communist dictatorships, being atheistic and materialistic, can and do treat human labor as a commodity to be used for the glorification of the state.

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128. John Foster Dulles, "Secretary Dulles States the Case of U. S. Vs. Russia," *U. S. News & World Report*, (29 June 1956), p. 81.

> "Many of the despotic societies of the past have created notable monuments—pyramids, coliseums, palaces and temples—built by slave labor to glorify kings and potentates who personified the state. The Soviet state has comparable achievements to its credit. By the ruthless use of forced labor, the dictators have created modern monuments in the form of industrial plants, power developments and the like.
>
> "I shall not attempt here to catalogue all of the many evils of Soviet Communist despotism. I do wish, however, to call attention to the revelations recently made by Mr. Khrushchev, in his initially secret speech before the Twentieth Party Congress of the Soviet Communist Party. It is the most damning indictment of despotism ever made by a despot...he said that the man who for many years headed the Soviet Communist Party and Soviet state, who was portrayed as a demigod and whose writings were treated as authoritative by international communism the world over, was, as regards doctrine, a 'deviationist;' was, as head of state, so blind to the dangers to his nation as to be almost a traitor; and was, as a man, so brutal and sadistic in character as to rival one of the most evil of the Roman emperors, Caligula. Furthermore—and this is the main point—Mr. Khrushchev exposes the inability of the Soviet Communist system to liquidate its own evil leadership, because it was the evil leader who had the supreme power to liquidate others."

While the attacks on Stalin and Stalinism during 1956 indicate the possibility of a profound change evolving in the character of the Soviet regime, it is more probable that the attacks suggest the existence of dissension among the rulers of the U.S.S.R. and the need to ameliorate the unbearable tensions among their people as a condition precedent to taking an alternative route to a dominant world position. As if to prove that the Soviet Union and its colonial empire were in an increasingly sad state, one small country—a people without an army, an air force, a government of its own, a people without nuclear weapons—stood up to the power of the nation possessing the world's largest ground army and air force, plus a great collection of atomic and hydrogen bombs, when Hungary revolted against Soviet Russia. As the Editors of *America* so eloquently expressed the heart-torn sentiments of the West:[129]

> "We have no words to describe the courage and agony of the Hungarian people. We have no words to describe the bestial cruelty of their Soviet

129. Editorial, *America*, (17 November 1956), Vol. XCVI, No. 7, p. 191.

> oppressors. So long as the light of freedom burns anywhere, the gallant rising of the Hungarians against the soul-destroying rule of communism will thrill human hearts. So long as the light of freedom burns, the brutal perfidy of Soviet Russia will be remembered with unspeakable loathing and disgust. To such depths of barbarism can man made in God's own image fall. To such heights of heroism can he soar."

As in Hungary, where students set the first flare to revolution, students in Moscow's skyscraper university, show place of the regime, started making trouble when the new leaders of their country denounced the terror and brutality of the dead Stalin and proclaimed the greater freedom of their regime. The students took heart, began to organize discussion groups which the Communists, at first, saw as an escape valve for their pent up feelings. Students were encouraged to ask questions about gaps in production, even about minor officials who were not doing their jobs. Then came the Hungarian revolt. In sight of the Kremlin walls, students began discussing the Soviet attitude in Hungary. Among them were students from satellite countries, from Red China, called to the seat of empire for study. Eventually students' criticism centered on the leaders of Soviet Russia itself and the secret police of the new rulers cracked down. *The U. S. News & World Report* observes:[130]

> "Hundreds of students, most of them Russians already have been arrested and packed off, Stalin style, into the oblivion of prison camps or police cells. For Moscow's students this was a revelation of the true character of the very leaders who denounced Stalin. Ferment within the Soviet universities is on the rise, despite repression. Soviet youth now alerted, is restive."

It is clear therefore, that despite the exertion of tremendous energy in ideological indoctrination of all ages of society, but particularly the youth, communism in practice has not only failed to eliminate the basic defects of human nature but has magnified them; far from meeting the needs of human nature, communism aroused it to hopeless revolt.

In summary, this chapter serves to focus not only professional historic evaluation on Hegel and Marx but to place their philosophies of history in proper perspective with other creditable unified or deterministic theories of history. The controversy over Toynbee's concept of challenge and

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130. "The Revolt That Will Crack an Empire," *U. S. News & World Report*, (21 December 1956), p. 29.

response prompted so many extraordinarily painstaking critiques that the paucity of similar frontal attacks on Marx's theory is unbelievable. Nevertheless we can obtain a degree of satisfaction in the realization that if such an erudite, brilliant and accomplished historian receives such harsh treatment for a well-buttressed theory of history, how much worse would Marx have suffered under the same scrutiny? Finally, we applied the test of human nature to determine if the materialist conception of history met the fundamental requirement of reading correctly the needs of man's nature. Since it did not, the opportunity to explore the theory in practice, as a countercheck to the doctrine, revealed not the blissful classless society so positively predicted but increasing tensions, pressures and revolts among the peoples it rules. So much for the fate of the victorious proletariat; but what of the Capitalists? Will capitalism die from inner weakness and contradiction despite the absence of an enraged proletariat. This final prophecy of Marx's materialistic conception of history will be treated in the next chapter.

CHAPTER VI

Is Democratic Capitalism Doomed to Failure?

> "The present Soviet leaders believe quite sincerely, I think, that the capitalist system is an episode in world history; that it cannot last; that it contains within it contradictions and weaknesses which will eventually prove its undoing; that it must sooner or later make place for a new order, which they call Socialism..."
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> —George F. Kennan, 1956.[131]

To traverse the ideological jungle of Marxism with its monstrous denizens of the collective, the planned economy, the slave labor, the Supreme State, terroristic police, stifling bureaucracy and individuals devoid of God and rights onto the American scene is a blinding experience. One hesitates and asks in humility, "Can any more than the merest beginning, perhaps only an introduction of this wondrous view be presented in one short chapter?" But to hesitate is to be lost—let us get on with it. In evaluating democratic capitalism we will look first at the form of government and then at the economic system to determine if they suit the nature of man and society and if they contain "the seeds of their own destruction."

The essence of the American Government can be understood only against the long religious history of mankind that preceded its formulation. Man first discovered the fatherhood of God, then the brotherhood of all men in Christ; and as he grew in spiritual understanding, he was

131. George F. Kennan, "Overdue Changes in Our Foreign Policy," (*Harpers*, August 1956)

released in the custody of his own conscience, to seek good and shun evil according to the guides given by Christ. Man carries within him something that the merely animal does not have, the divine spark, since man was created in the "image" of God. Since every man is thus of God, every man is equal, in the sense, as we saw in the last chapter, that no man can claim he is more important to God than any other man. The human individual thus has a special status with regard to all things and beings on earth: he must live, and must be entitled to live, by the laws of God, not just by the laws and directives of men. According to the Editors of *Fortune Magazine* in their book, *U.S.A. The Permanent Revolution*:[132]

> "...This special status of the individual is couched in certain Rights with which everyone is endowed. It is specifically stated in the Declaration of Independence that man is endowed with these Rights *by his Creator*; the Rights, therefore, are not man-made but God-made. They are 'unalienable,' grounded in the universe itself, reflecting universal laws of nature: that is to say, they are natural, not merely political, Rights. The human individual is clothed with them and no other man or group of men is entitled by God's law to strip them from him. The three natural rights mentioned in the Declaration of Independence are Life, Liberty, and the Pursuit of Happiness... among others...The thesis can be sustained that in the last analysis American history has been a struggle to define and implement these Rights, and that this struggle is still going on. The great social issues of our time, for example, can be construed as attempts to redefine the Right to Life in terms of an industrialized society. From the Right of Liberty, on the other hand there spring all the *political* safeguards that Americans have created to protect the individual. And the Right to the Pursuit of Happiness...opens up for the individual the opportunity to develop himself according to his own cultural and spiritual lights."

What inspiration prompted the Founding Fathers of our Country to insure the Rights of American citizens and what means did they use? The men who framed the American Constitution were, by fortunate chance, familiar with the history of government and tyranny. They knew that liberty is impossible without government, but they knew also that throughout history government has been the greatest enemy of liberty. In addition;

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132. Fortune, *U. S. A. The Permanent Revolution*, (New York: Prentice-Hall, 1951), pp. 34–35.

> "they were great and talented men...who happened to face an unparalleled historical opportunity and made the most of it. They did so by...mastering everything...about...political philosophy...They came out of their quest knowing more about this subject...than any men of their time."[133]

They knew that the unsolved problem of society was the erection of a government having all the powers necessary to guard the peace and the liberties of the people while at the same time being itself without the means of using those powers to impair or destroy the people's rights and freedom. How did they solve the problem? As John T. Flynn explains in his ominous book, *Decline of the American Republic*,[134] one of the best devices for guarding the citizens from the Government is suffrage where laws are made and administered by officials elected by the people. When this system was established on a limited scale in England, its citizens began to enjoy a degree of freedom unknown up to then. They established their right to name their officials and managed, in a long series of struggles against the crown and the nobles, to set up with the force of institutional law a whole series of guarantees generally enumerated in our Bill of Rights. But this did not go far enough. In England there was but one government—the central government which possessed the power of making the laws and policy not merely for the nation as a whole, but for every division, sector and community. Actually, the Parliament, with the cabinet, now has in its hands total authority over every sector of British life, subject only to the right of the citizens to change their representatives in Parliament. Once in office, the vast powers of the State can be used by the Administration to purchase or intimidate the electorate. The greater the power it has, the greater will its ability to control the electorate. The obvious answer was not to commit all the powers of government into one set of hands, but to divide government into several groupings, each group entrusted with a separate set of functions. Great controversy and long debate on this point between Adams, Jefferson, Hamilton and Madison resulted in setting up a federal republican government in which there were checks and balances over thirteen sovereign states. Today the government consists of forty-nine republics, the forty-eight states and the central government. The

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133. *Ibid.*, p. 40.

134. John T. Flynn, *The Decline of the American Republic*, (New York: The Devin-Adair Company, 1955).

individual state is a recognized republic endowed with all the authority of government except such faculties as it has deliberately delegated to the central government. Its powers are great, but limited geographically. The federal government, on the other hand, has limited powers but they extend over the entire nation. This limited power is not all entrusted to one set of hands. The Constitution provides for a Congress to make the laws which are administered, not by a parliamentary ministry subject to it as in England, but by an independent executive who gets his power directly from the Constitution. Both these branches of the government are constrained to act within the Constitution by the third branch, the Judicial, which is empowered under the Constitution to "interpret" the meaning of the Constitution where questions of judicial differences appear. James Madison describes the concept as follows:[135]

> "The powers delegated...to the federal government are few and defined. Those which are to remain in the state governments are numerous and indefinite. The former will be exercised principally on external objects, as war, peace, negotiation and foreign commerce...The powers which are reserved to the several states will extend to all the objects which, in the ordinary course of affairs, concern the lives, liberties, and properties of the people, and the internal order, improvement and prosperity of the state."

Thus the vast powers of government are deposited in 48 separate states and one central government. In each of these states, the government is split into three sectors—legislative, executive and judicial—all operating on specifically blueprinted powers, and all chosen by separate electorates. By associating small republics, each retaining power over its own people, while surrendering to the central republic only such powers as were essential to the liberties and rights of all as defined in the Constitution, the Founding Fathers created an experiment unique in history guaranteed to protect the Rights of citizens from the power of the state to exploit or enslave.

The essential principles of the American government are contained in the words Liberty, Equality and Constitutionalism. The priority of Liberty was adopted from John Locke and had been expressed in the Declaration of Independence as: all governments derive their just powers from

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135. *Ibid.*, p. 33.

the consent of the governed. This theory of consent has spread throughout the Western World, so that no respectable country, particularly among the democracies, dares profess any other. Although the Constitution as written in Jefferson's absence gave the government no power to infringe the rights of citizens Jefferson insisted that a Bill of Rights was necessary to reinforce "fences" around liberty, "which the governing powers have ever shown a disposition to weaken and remove."[136] Jefferson felt that universal liberty was not synonymous with universal virtue, but it was certainly prior to it, for only a free agent is capable of a morally valid choice between evil and good. Hence liberty is the first step on the road to perfectibility, and science and education will help us on the way. "So we shall go on," wrote Jefferson, "puzzled and prospering beyond example in the history of man."[137] What he and his pessimistic adversaries agreed on was the absolute priority of liberty, and the need to protect it against all foes, even the citizens themselves. With regard to Equality, one area of agreement between Adams and Jefferson was in the vital concept that all men are created equal: they are born to equal rights. No amount of economic interpretation can conceal the fact that the greatest crisis of the Constitution was precipitated by the equal rights issue which forced slavery to yield. In all the crises involving equality of rights including the reforms of Theodore Roosevelt, the income tax, the direct election of Senators, women's suffrage, prohibition, and New Deal, when the rights of individuals were ranged against property rights, equality usually won the eventual compromise. When a more abstract right was disputed, as in prohibition, the individual right eventually won. Constitutionalism, as we have seen, is the principle of limitation whose negative aspect keeps the central government out of the hands of any one group of people whose common interest, whether economic, sectional, or ideological, might prove too strong for the liberties of the rest, and whose positive aspect, leaves to the initiative of the people the creative work of self-government, the work that involves the spotting of any inequity or an opportunity, thinking about it, and proposing or performing a reaction to it.

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136. Fortune, *op. cit.*, p. 45.

137. *Ibid.*, p. 47.

Constitutionalism, in short, not only protects liberty, but relies on it to be the motor force for the actual organization and improvement of a living society.

Traditionally the most essential freedoms identified with democracy have been the civil and political liberties of ideas, speech, the press, assembly, and artistic and intellectual endeavors as well as freedom from arbitrary arrest and trial. Democracy stands for the free conflict of ideas and leaders, from among which the electorate makes a choice in free popular elections conducted with a universal adult franchise. Its method is unique in that the people are free to choose and dismiss a government under three limitations: First, people must be free to criticize the government, have a real chance to organize, to secure information and to gain support in public opinion; second, the opposition must in its turn obey the laws of the land even though advocating their change; and third, the opposition must also abide by the rules and announce beforehand that it too, will allow the same liberties should it be successful. Involved in democracy, then, is an element of freedom under which choice may be exercised—in fact, harking back to the moral concept of the individual, it is generally agreed that moral action is impossible without that freedom of choice which exists only if alternative courses of action are advocated and discussed. As De Tocqueville saw over one hundred years ago;

> "Democracy attaches all possible value to each man; Socialism makes each man a mere agent, a mere number. Democracy extends the sphere of individual freedom; socialism rejects it."[138]

We have seen that the American form of government is firmly rooted in the basically Christian doctrine of the sacredness—and hence the equality—of natural rights of the individual as expounded by the Founding Fathers. Further the Governmental institutions, balanced, restricted and subject to the will of the people, aim to make these fundamental moral principles a part of actual life on this earth.

Let us look at the economic system as it evolved in the United States. Political democracy, when regarded as a superior ideology, as a method only, assumes that the substance of a democratic society would take care of itself. But it gradually became evident that a let-alone attitude permitted

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138. De Tocqueville, ???

many abuses. The result of an ingenious variety of monopolistic practices against which the state is compelled to proceed caused competition to be policed, and enforced in its own interest. In a similar way, a "hands off" policy toward civil and political liberties favored the strong and discriminated against the weak. We found that to maintain freedoms, whether civil or economic, required an elaborate framework of law.

> "Slowly, with many a longing, lingering look behind, all the democracies have been moving toward what is known as the 'positive' state, that is, a state which mixes itself deeply in social and economic affairs. Movements toward the 'positive' state are not the result of conspiracy or alien activities, but spring naturally from the soil of a complex industrialized society, and from the wishes of the electorate."[139]

As the Editors of *Fortune* so well point out, not all industrialists needed the prodding of government to recognize the responsibility of business for the welfare of its employees. They see our individualism "coming of age." No longer is there the mad scramble of cutthroat competition. Our corporations are responsible social bodies which make for ordinary Americans the right to life and the right to the pursuit of happiness something more than abstractions. Even our labor unions are coming of age; no longer engaged in a simple battle to wrest the most they can out of employers, they show more and more signs of a willingness to work together with ownership and managership to make more and better things for more and better people.

The result has been an expanding economy over the last 30 years despite depressions, two world wars and the necessity to bolster the economies of half the Free World. Today we produce goods and services (GNP) at an annual rate of $400 billion compared with $97 billion in 1926. Allowing for the sharp price rise in most goods since that time, we find that the current production is considerably more than double 1926's output. Population increase from 117,000,000 to 167,000,000 over these years is one reason for growth. It is because our ability to produce has exceeded population growth that wealth and living standards have continued to rise. The ability to produce while based on a growing labor force rests more importantly on the ability of that labor force to turn out more for

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139. Mayo, *op. cit.*, p. 271.

every hour worked as years go by. This, in turn, is the result of advances in research and technology, translated by business investment into new plant and equipment. Business spending for plant and equipment to keep pace with competition in growing markets has proceeded at an expanding rate. Companies that hope to keep competitively abreast realize they must be willing to carry out substantial programs of modernization and those which are successful do so. Not only is the wealth produced by this country much greater than it was 30 years ago, but the bigger pie is much more evenly sliced among all our citizens. We are no longer a nation of a few extremely rich people with the remaining millions in moderate to poor circumstances; rather we have become a nation the bulk of whose citizens are well off. Today about two-thirds of the families in the United States enjoy incomes between $3,000 and $10,000 a year. In 1929, only one-third of the families had such incomes measured in dollars that would buy the same goods. In commenting on "Our People's Capitalism," Sylvia Porter reports:[140]

> "...When Eugene Varga, the Soviet Union's top economist, lets go with a slashing attack on the American economic system and ridicules as fantastic our boast that we are developing a unique people's capitalism, it means: We in this country are achieving a way of life that the Russian bosses are afraid strikes at the heart of their doctrines; We have hit a propaganda note that they fear could have a great appeal to men and women everywhere...
>
> "Says Varga: a capitalist is one who owns the means of production and 'exploits workers.' Because millions of Americans hold savings deposits doesn't make these millions capitalists. What's more, says he, most of the savings are held by a tiny percentage of the upper-upper classes. The fact is that 72 percent of all American families now hold liquid assets in addition to actual cash...The fact is that the average holding of liquid assets is $2,700. If a capitalist is only the person who owns a business and exploits workers, not many of us are capitalists. But millions of us certainly are sharing the wealth—which is what is meant by a people's capitalism.... Says Varga: the boast that workers are becoming capitalists by buying stocks is 'clamorous propaganda'...The fact is the latest census shows 8.6 million of us own stocks, a new peak and a gain of 33 percent in just four years. The fact is two-thirds of all shareholders have incomes of under $7,500 a year—a

140. Sylvia Porter, "Your Money's Worth," *The Evening Star*, (Washington: 27 August 1956).

> stunning reflection of our middle-class Americans... My conclusion is that Varga's slashing attack is a measure of our achievement and the success of our propaganda. We've moved closer to 'income equality' in America than any other nation anywhere—including Russia. Our developing 'people's capitalism' has virtues that deserves to win that battle for men's minds."

But despite the growth and expansion of both its economy and the well-being of its citizens, the United States has not been free of criticism, warnings and omens of doom. One of these is proclaimed by John T. Flynn, the author of *The Decline of the American Republic*, who foresees the eventual slide of the nation unresisting down the slippery grade into socialism without any Socialist or Communist Parties being implicated. His belief is based on the delegation to the central government of unlimited powers of taxation and right to interfere in affairs formerly intended for the exclusive domain of the separate state governments. He places the blame on the politician who, if he is to remain in power, must:[141]

> "Coalesce all these minorities into a majority, and with government funds or government favors buy the votes of farmers, or workers, or business leaders. It is not because they want socialism that these people acquiesce in such betrayals. They just do not realize that each of these adventures inflicts another wound on the free society. The system of free enterprise cannot sustain these huge tolls. It is impossible to collect enough taxes to pay the bills. Hence the politicians who run the show turn to borrowing money from the citizens, from industry and from the banks. This creates a spurious prosperity which can last only until the taxing power and the debt-paying power of the government is exhausted, when the whole degenerate structure will sink down in disaster."

This sentiment is shared by the Editors of *Fortune* who see the greatest danger threatening us as the one to which so much of Western Europe has shown signs of succumbing—state capitalism. But they see the optimistic side in the basic distrust of the American business community, both labor and management, toward government interference which, when combined with the coming of age of American individualism displayed in voluntary solution of economic problems between management and labor without reference to government agencies, augurs well for the continuance of an expanding, dynamic democratic capitalism.

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141. Flynn, *op. cit.*, pp. 124–125.

As former President Herbert Hoover summed up recently:[142]

"During the last score of years our American way of life has been deluged with criticism. It comes from our own people who deplore our faults and genuinely wish to remedy them. Among these I myself have joined because of my anxieties over mistaken policies and especially the influence of Karl Marx on our way of life...Altogether, if we look at the criticism alone, we seem to be in a very, very bad way and engaged in our decline and fall...We should occasionally mention something good about ourselves. We could point out that our American way of life has perfected the greatest productivity of any nation on earth; that our standard of living is the highest in the world. We could point to our constantly improving physical health and lengthening span of life. We could point out that the mechanical genius of our people has, by millions of labor-saving machines, taken sweat from the back of most of our people.

"In the governmental field, we could suggest that our supposedly decadent people still rely upon the ballot and the legislative hall to settle their differences without a secret police with slave camps.

"In the cultural field, we could point out that, with only about 6 percent of the world's population, we have more youth in our institutions of higher learning than all the rest of the world put together. We could probably enumerate more libraries and more printed serious words than all other 94 percent of the earth put together.

"On the moral and spiritual side, we have more hospitals and charitable institutions than all of them. And we could suggest that we alone, of all nations, fought in two world wars and asked no indemnities, no acquisition of territory, no domination over other nations.

"We could point to our advancement of the spirit of compassion. We could prove it by the billions of dollars we have made as gifts to save millions from famine and governments from collapse.

"Despite the lag in giving an equal chance to our Negro population, yet I cannot refrain from mentioning that our 14 million Negroes own more automobiles than all the 200 million Russians or the 200 million Negroes in Africa.

"All this is not boasting, but just fact. And we could say a good deal more. What does all this mean? *It means that freedom of mind, of spirit and of initiative still lives in America... Here alone are the open windows through which pours the sunlight of the human spirit. Here alone, even with all its*

142. Herbert Hoover, "Saying Something Good About Ourselves," *U. S. News & World Report*, (19 August 1955), p. 62.

defects, is human dignity not a dream but an accomplishment. These ideals of freedom and religious faith guarantee there will be no decline and fall of American civilization." (underscoring supplied)

CHAPTER VII

Conclusions and Recommendations

PURSUANT TO the requirement of scientific research to understand the theory and apply it to facts, we have, in this paper, examined in detail Marx's theory of history with particular emphasis on his theme of inevitability, compared the concept to the facts of history, seeking the opinions of professional historians in the process, and finally tested it in the laboratory of Communist and Capitalist countries of our day and time. Having given special consideration to facts which are at odds with the hypothesis, we must now decide whether to abandon the hypothesis in view of unaccommodating facts or to specify its limitations.

Marx's theory of history is indorsed by extant Communists as "scientific" and despite the necessity to "help it along" by world-wide conspiracy, remains a source of dynamism and strength to the U.S.S.R.

Marx's theory of history, including the inevitability feature, is erroneous and must be abandoned for the following reasons:

a. It is based on the dialectical process no longer accepted by philosophers or historians as a valid method of reasoning or research since it employs *a priori* rather than empiric methods.

b. The facts of history disprove Marx's Four Era's of civilization. His thesis that the same mode of production results in the same institutional constellation fails to correlate with the fundamental differences in the institutions of the United States and Russia which employ the same modes of production.

c. The Marxian concept of an economically determined human nature deprives man of the one feature which distinguishes him from animals, his immortal soul. The expectation that "classless society" will somehow magically renovate the many faults of humans, purge the proletariat of inspired hatred, and evolve into true brotherhood is unfounded.

d. Marx's economic analysis, while extraordinarily accurate in isolating the defects of 19th Century capitalism, failed to credit mankind with the good judgment and common sense thus far exhibited in curbing the glaring injustices which he expected to cause its ultimate demise. Marx erred in projecting deplorable conditions indefinitely into the future.

e. In operation, Marxism has inspired passive and at times violent reaction among the people despite many years of acclimatizing. It produces more and more refugees who abandon their homeland rather than endure communism. Tensions and rebellious attitudes necessitate greater and greater relaxation of tight controls on freedom of expression, criticism and information, awarding more consumer goods and reducing police terror.

f. Democratic capitalism, on the other hand, has evolved in a manner not dreamed by Marx, providing its citizens with greater and greater productivity, increasing standards of living and the spirit of mutual co-operation so necessary to true brotherhood.

The conclusion is logical that communism as a system of government does not fit the nature of man and is inevitably bound to decay.

The corollary conclusion that democratic capitalism is destined to continue throughout the rest of history is equally unfounded. It is a man-made institution and man himself and all his works are transient. But so long as it does last, it will best serve the inherent rights of mankind by permitting human nature to develop in freedom and dignity.

It is recommended that the United States Government interest recognized historians to convene a symposium on Karl Marx's theory of history with particular reference to the inevitability theme, for the purpose of discussing its accuracy and validity. The results, since they have an

industrial-economic reference, should be published in all scientific and technical journals for eventual perusal within the Soviet Union. In view of the faith of current Soviet leaders in Marx's scientific analysis of history, we will have scored a smashing victory with a truly "Ideological Offensive."

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> "One would think that past experience would have made us immune to Communist tactical maneuvers. Strange to say, even in a country, which boasts of its means of information, it has become embarrassingly clear that the American people do not yet know enough about the adversary who threatens our way of life."

The committee of fifty leaders from all walks of life were praised for promoting a many-pronged information in high schools and colleges to further knowledge of the ideological conflict between democracy and communism.

Editorial, *The Commonweal*, Vol. 60, (August 6, 1954), pp. 427–28.

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zero point. Nevertheless, insight into the sources of Soviet irrationality reveals deep contradictions in the Soviet system, and just as they have for many years exploited what they consider "internal contradictions in capitalist society, we should just as systematically take advantage of their inner contradictions."

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This family edition was set in EB Garamond, Georg Duffner's revival of the types of Claude Garamont, and composed with LaTeX. Printed and bound in 2026.